KAYAK

SECTOR OUTLOOK FY26 · BANKING AND CREDIT

# Sector Outlook FY26: credit moves to the middle

India's mid-market companies now borrow from a wider set of lenders than at any time in the last decade. That widens choice and lowers cost, and it moves risk into places boards watch less closely.

With the KSA Design & Visual Guidelines Manual, version 1.0, in ten chapters.

OCTOBER 2026 · KAYAK STRATEGIC ADVISORS · MUMBAI, NEW DELHI, BENGALURU

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20 October 2026
Our ref: KSA/SD/2026/0412

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STRICTLY PRIVATE AND CONFIDENTIAL

Dear [Name],

**Sector Outlook FY26: credit moves to the middle**

Thank you for your time at the risk committee on 9 October. As promised, I enclose our Sector Outlook FY26 on mid-market credit, together with the KSA Design & Visual Guidelines that govern how we present our work to you.

The outlook makes one argument. Mid-market companies now borrow from a wider set of lenders than at any time in the last decade. That lowers the cost of credit, and it moves risk into related parties, third parties and shared providers, which standard credit reviews see less clearly.

The last section sets out five questions we suggest your audit and risk committee asks before the next lender review. We would be glad to take the committee through them, and to test the answers against your own supplier, distributor and third-party data.

Please treat the enclosed as confidential. The figures are illustrative for this edition.

Yours sincerely,

**[Partner name]**
Partner, Strategy & Deals

Enclosures: Sector Outlook FY26; KSA Design & Visual Guidelines, version 1.0

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PART A · SECTOR OUTLOOK FY26

# Credit moves to the middle

India's mid-market companies now borrow from a wider set of lenders than at any time in the last decade. That widens choice and lowers cost, and it moves risk into places boards watch less closely.

## The shift in one paragraph

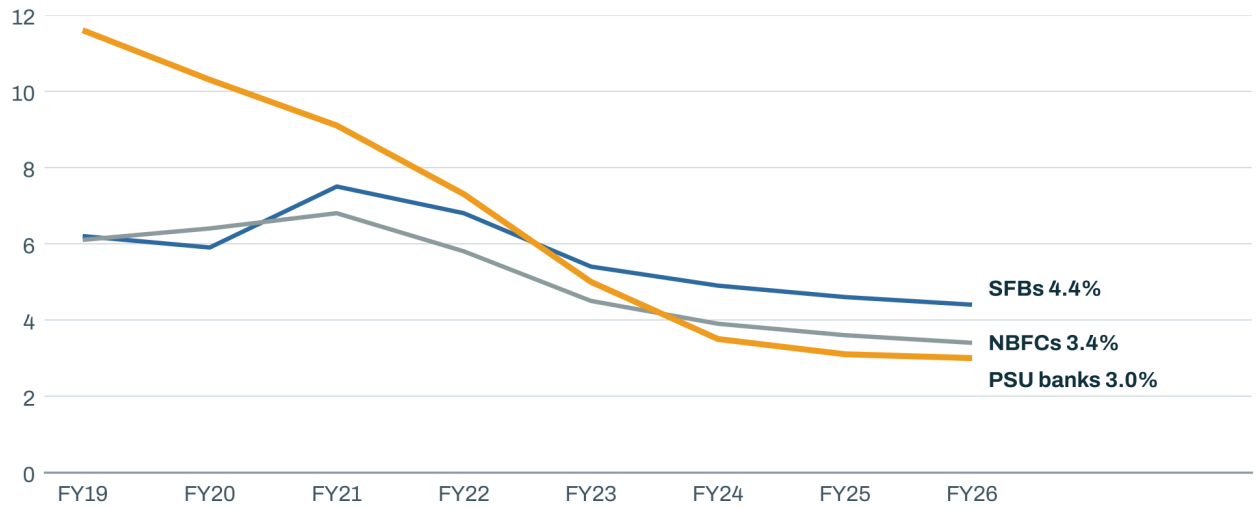
Companies with revenue between ₹100 crore and ₹1,000 crore used to borrow mainly from their relationship bank. By our estimate, that bank now provides a little over half of their incremental credit.[1] Non-bank lenders, co-lending arrangements and private credit funds provide the rest. Asset quality across lender types has converged: on our reading of the published data, public-sector banks now report gross non-performing assets close to those of non-bank lenders (Exhibit 2).[2]

For a borrower this is good news. More lenders compete for the same balance sheet, so pricing and covenants improve. For a board it changes the questions to ask, because the cheapest lender is often the one that diligences the least.

EXHIBIT 2

### Public-sector banks now report gross NPAs close to non-bank lenders

Gross NPA ratio by lender type, % of gross advances, FY19 to FY26




Source: RBI Financial Stability Reports; FY26 is the September 2026 position; KSA analysis. Figures are illustrative for this edition.

## Three forces behind the move

First, balance sheets repaired. Banks and large non-bank lenders cleaned up their books after FY19, and capital adequacy is comfortable across the system. Lenders are looking for growth, and the mid-market is where growth is.

[1] KSA estimate from bureau and GST data for 1,850 borrowers with revenue between ₹100 crore and ₹1,000 crore, FY24 to FY26. Illustrative for this edition.

[2] Gross NPA ratios as reported by each lender type. They are not adjusted for differences in write-off and restructuring policy.

Second, data improved. GST returns, account aggregator consents[3] and bureau data let a lender underwrite a ₹300 crore company in days. A decade ago that took weeks and a branch relationship.

Third, regulation set clearer rules for partnerships. Co-lending, outsourcing and digital lending now have specific frameworks.[4] Lenders can work together inside them, and they now carry explicit duties for the third parties they rely on.

> *"The cheapest lender is often the one that diligences the least."*
>
> [PARTNER NAME], PARTNER, STRATEGY & DEALS

## Where the risk now sits

Risk has not left the system. It has moved to three places that standard credit reviews see less clearly.

Related parties. In our diligence work, one mid-market borrower in five[5] has a supplier, distributor or service provider linked to a promoter or a senior employee. These links are rarely disclosed and often sit outside the lender's view.

Third parties of the lender. Collection agencies, fintech partners and data processors now touch the borrower directly. Each one is an operational and data-protection exposure, and the DPDP Act makes the lender answerable for its processors.[6]

Concentration in shared providers. Many lenders and borrowers depend on the same few cloud, payments and collections providers. A failure at one of them would reach many balance sheets at once.

## What boards should ask

We suggest five questions for the next audit or risk committee:

1. Which of our top 50 suppliers and distributors are linked to a promoter, director or approver, and who approved each one?
2. Which third parties hold our customer data, and when did we last test their controls?
3. Which providers do we share with our lenders, and what happens if one fails for a week?
4. Do our covenants and information rights still match the lenders we now have?
5. Who owns the answer to each of these questions, and when do they report back?

## The KSA view

Credit moving to the middle is a structural change, and it will continue. Companies that can show clean related-party records, tested third-party controls and a clear view of concentration will borrow more cheaply, because they cost a lender less to diligence. Exhibits 7 and 8 show what that evidence looks like for a typical mid-market borrower.

[3] The account aggregator framework lets a borrower share financial data with a lender through a consent-based intermediary regulated by the RBI.

[4] RBI directions on co-lending arrangements, outsourcing of financial services and digital lending, as amended. Readers should rely on the current text of each direction.

[5] Based on 140 KSA due-diligence engagements on mid-market borrowers, 2023 to 2026. This is a practice observation, not a statistical sample.

[6] Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023. The data fiduciary remains responsible for processing carried out on its behalf by a data processor.

*"Companies that can show clean related-party records will borrow more cheaply, because they cost a lender less to diligence."*

[PARTNER NAME], PARTNER, CRISIS & RESILIENCE

EXHIBIT 7

## Margin expands to 15.4% in FY26E on the management case

Consolidated P&L of an illustrative mid-market borrower, FY23 to FY26E, ₹ crore

| ₹ crore | FY23 | FY24 | FY25 | FY26E |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Revenue | 2,410 | 2,684 | 2,990 | 3,320 |
| Gross profit | 868 | 980 | 1,121 | 1,262 |
| Employee costs | (214) | (236) | (258) | (281) |
| Other operating costs | (342) | (385) | (412) | (469) |
| EBITDA | 312 | 359 | 451 | 512 |
| **EBITDA margin, %** | **12.9** | **13.4** | **15.1** | **15.4** |
| Depreciation | (64) | (71) | (79) | (86) |
| Finance costs | (42) | (38) | (31) | (26) |
| Profit after tax | 151 | 186 | 253 | 297 |

Source: Audited statements FY23-FY25; management budget FY26E; KSA analysis. Negative figures in brackets.

EXHIBIT 8

## Two of eight controls need work before signing

Control readiness scorecard. Status is shown by shape and word as well as colour.

| Status | Control | Owner | Evidence |
|---|---|---|---|
| ● On track | Related-party approval policy | CFO | Board-approved in August; first annual attestations received |
| ● On track | Vendor master clean-up | CPO | 1,240 duplicate or dormant vendors closed |
| ▲ At risk | ERP access reviews | CIO | Two plants still on legacy access model; fix due November |
| ● On track | Revenue recognition | Controller | No exceptions in Q2 testing |
| ◆ Off track | DPDP consent notices | DPO | Three of seven business units without updated notices |
| ● On track | Whistleblower line | CCO | Independent operator appointed; 14 reports in Q2 |
| ▲ At risk | Plant inventory counts | COO | Count differences above 0.5% at one depot |
| ● On track | Treasury dual control | Treasurer | Maker-checker enforced on all payments above ₹10 lakh |

Source: KSA control testing, October 2026.

PART B

# KSA Design & Visual Guidelines Manual

**Kayak Strategic Advisors · Version 1.0 · October 2026**

*Precision on open water. Two paddlers. One course.*

This manual sets out the complete visual system of Kayak Strategic Advisors (KSA) in ten chapters. It covers the principles and ingredients of the brand, the geometry measured from the KAYAK wordmark, layout, imagery, graphic assets, data visualisation, interface design, applications, physical brand assets and digital media. Every value in it is a working specification: colours to the hex, type to the point, angles to the degree. The companion generator, `kayak_master_suite_generator.py`, builds the presentation, document and token assets that apply these rules.


| Chapter | Title |
|---|---|
| 01 | Principles and ingredients |
| 02 | Shape grammar and logo geometry |
| 03 | Layout rhythm and the 8-point system |
| 04 | Visual approach: imagery, surfaces and depth |
| 05 | Graphic assets: patterns, badges, dividers, navigator's marks and illustration |
| 06 | Data visualisation and consulting exhibits |
| 07 | UI assets, design tokens, web and mobile apps, and motion |
| 08 | Applications: corporate presentations and thought-leadership reports |
| 09 | Brand assets: stationery, gifting, inventory register and interiors |
| 10 | Digital media, Confluence magazine and the 24-point quality checklist |

CHAPTER 01

# Principles and ingredients

This chapter sets out what every Kayak Strategic Advisors (KSA) design should feel like and the parts it is built from. It starts with the design idea, "Precision on open water", and the three numbers that carry it: the 58° paddle angle, the 4% split and one saffron accent per view. It then gives the five design principles and the test every piece must pass before it leaves the studio. The second half lists the ten core visual ingredients, shows how colour is spent in proportion across light and dark pages, and sets the typographic hierarchy for a typeset A4 report spread. Read this chapter, and chapters 02 and 03, before designing anything. The rest of the manual is reference.

## 1.1 The design idea

### 1.1.1 Precision on open water

Two paddlers in a kayak cross rough water by keeping a disciplined rhythm and a shared heading. Every design decision at Kayak should feel the same way: calm, exact and moving with intent.

We are a boutique, so our work should feel considered rather than produced. That means:

- fewer elements on each page;
- finer detail in the elements that remain;
- generous space around them;
- one point of saffron where the client should look.

### 1.1.2 Two paddlers, one course

The brand idea comes from the Brand Manual. A kayak is a disciplined, agile craft. It moves through changing conditions by balance, direction and purposeful navigation. That is how we help clients move through complex business, regulatory, operational, technological and risk environments: with clarity, resilience and practical guidance.

"Strategic Advisors" names what we do: independent, structured and forward-looking advice, analysis and implementation support across corporate strategy, transactions, risk and investigations, brand and intellectual-property protection, technology and data, human resources, compliance, tax and finance. Together, the name stands for a partnership that helps clients set direction, manage complexity and carry out sound, sustainable decisions, like two kayakers working as one through stormy water.

### 1.1.3 The three brand pillars

| Pillar | What it means | How it shows in design |
|---|---|---|
| Balance | A steady core that keeps every engagement upright, whatever the conditions. | A firm grid, even margins, one clear order of reading. Dense pages still feel unhurried. |
| Clarity | Reading the water as it really is: facts, risks and what lies beneath the surface. | Honest charts, direct labels, sources on every exhibit, plain words. |
| Direction | A clear heading, and the conviction to act on it together with the client. | One saffron beacon that says where to look. Headlines that state the finding. |

### 1.1.4 The three anchors

Three numbers from the logo carry the idea into every layout. Learn them first.

| Anchor | Value | Where it comes from | What it governs |
|---|---|---|---|
| The paddle angle | 58° | The arm of the K: rise 38.7 over run 24 in logo units. atan(38.7 / 24) = atan(1.6125) = 58.19°. | Every diagonal we draw: K-lattice pattern, diagonal crops, annotation leaders. |
| The split | 4% | The 4-unit gap between the two blades of the Confluence Y, on a cap height of 100 units. 4 / 100 = 4%. | The gap that keeps two strokes distinct: paired rules, pinstripes, converging forms. |
| One beacon | 1 | Beacon Saffron, the right blade of the Y. | One saffron accent per view: the key figure, the action or the turning point. |

Chapter 02 gives the full geometry behind these numbers.

### 1.1.5 What the identifier says

The Confluence Y sits at the centre of KAYAK and tells the story on its own.

| Part | Colour | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| Left blade | Open Water | Clarity: understanding the client's waters. |
| Right blade | Beacon Saffron | Direction: the heading we help set. |
| Stem | Deep Current | One course: a sound decision, carried through. |
| The gaps | (space) | Discipline: each partner holds a clear line until they meet. |

## 1.2 Design principles

Boutique, premium, strategically thought: five principles turn those words into decisions you can check. Each principle below has a statement, the directives that put it into practice, and a check you can run on a finished page.

### 1.2.1 The five principles

| No. | Principle | Statement |
|---|---|---|
| 01 | Calm before clever | Start with space and a clear hierarchy. Remove an element before adding one. A page should feel unhurried even when it is dense with data. |
| 02 | One beacon | Each view has one point of Beacon Saffron, the thing we want the client to see first: the key number, the action, the turning point. |
| 03 | Drawn from the craft | Angles, splits and blades come from the logo. Never import shapes, icons or textures that do not share its geometry. |
| 04 | Exact, then expressive | Grid, baseline and alignment come first. Expression lives in the details: a blade, a saffron rule, a finely set number. |
| 05 | Evidence on show | We advise on facts. Show the source, the scale and the method. Data is drawn honestly and labelled in plain words. |

### 1.2.2 Principle 01: Calm before clever

Directives:

- Set the spacing from the 8-point scale (chapter 03). No ad hoc gaps.
- Leave bigger gaps between groups than within them.
- Use four or five of the ten ingredients on a page, never all ten.
- When a page feels busy, delete first. Shrinking type or gutters is not a fix.
- One pattern per spread or screen.

Check: squint at the page. You should see one headline, one block of evidence and one point of focus. If you see more than three competing masses, remove something.

### 1.2.3 Principle 02: One beacon

Directives:

- One Beacon Saffron accent per view. A view is a slide, a page, a spread, a screen or a social tile.
- Saffron marks the key figure, the action or the turning point. It never decorates.
- Target 3% of a composition in saffron. Never go above 5%.
- As type, saffron lives only on Deep Current (6.27:1). Never set saffron text on white (2.25:1).
- In charts, the highlight series or bar is the beacon. Everything else is ink, teal or tint.

Check: count the saffron marks. The answer is one. If the logo's right blade is on the page, it is part of the logo and does not count as the view's beacon.

### 1.2.4 Principle 03: Drawn from the craft

Directives:

- Use only angles from the set: 53°, 55°, 58°, 62° and 73°, plus 0° and 90°.
- Use only the eight shape primitives (chapter 02).
- Cut every end flat. No round caps, bevels or tapered tips.
- Use KSA icons only (48 service icons and 2,160 industry icons on one 24 px grid). Never mix in other libraries.
- No curves, except the S current from the monogram and data lines in charts.

Check: put a protractor on every diagonal. If any edge sits outside the set (45° is the usual offender), redraw it.

### 1.2.5 Principle 04: Exact, then expressive

Directives:

- Snap text to the baseline (24 px on screen, 12 pt in print) and everything else to the 8-unit sub-grid.
- Snap text and exhibits to columns. Only images bleed.
- Left align, ragged right. Never justify.
- Add expression only once the grid holds: a blade at a chapter opener, a split rule under a headline, a figure set in Archivo Expanded.

Check: turn on the grid. Every left edge lands on a column line and every baseline lands on the baseline grid.

### 1.2.6 Principle 05: Evidence on show

Directives:

- Every exhibit carries a source line ("Source: ...; KSA analysis") and its unit.
- Bars start at zero. No pies, 3D or dual axes.
- Label series directly. Never rely on colour alone.
- Headlines state the finding as a full sentence.
- Spell out RBI, SEBI and MCA on first use on each page.

Check: cover the headline and read only the exhibit. A board member should still be able to say what was measured, in what unit, from what source.

### 1.2.7 The senior partner test

Before anything leaves the studio, ask one question:

> *Would a senior partner be proud to put it in front of a board?*

If the answer is anything other than a clear yes, the piece goes back. The test covers the whole object: the argument, the evidence, the type, the spacing and the print or screen quality. Use the five checks above to find what is wrong.

## 1.3 Core visual ingredients

Ten ingredients make every Kayak piece. Most layouts use four or five of them. None uses all ten at once.

### 1.3.1 The ten ingredients

| No. | Ingredient | What it is | Specification in brief | Detail in |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | Logo and identifier | The KAYAK wordmark and the Confluence Y. | The identifier signs off every layout: page, slide and screen. | Chapter 02 |
| 02 | Monogram | KSA. | For seals, favicons, avatars and premium moments. Never a first impression. | Chapter 02 |
| 03 | Colour | Deep Current and Sea Mist carry the page; Open Water leads; saffron points. | Four primary, six secondary and twelve tertiary colours. | Section 1.4 |
| 04 | Typography | Archivo for structure and numbers; Source Serif 4 for the voice. | Three weights at most: 400, 600, 700. | Section 1.5 |
| 05 | Shape grammar | Blades, splits, chevrons and 58° diagonals, all taken from the logo. | Eight primitives; angles 53°, 55°, 58°, 62°, 73°, plus 0° and 90°. | Chapter 02 |
| 06 | Patterns | Eleven tiling patterns from the identifier, monogram and favicon. | Three families, six colourways, three strengths. One pattern per spread or screen. | Chapter 05 |
| 07 | Iconography | 48 service icons and 2,160 industry icons on one 24 px grid. | 2 px strokes, flat-cut ends, one saffron accent at most. | Chapter 05 |

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 08 | Data and UI | A chart and interface system with one saffron highlight. | Tokens, components, exhibits and states. | Chapters 06 and 07 |
| 09 | Navigator's marks | Twelve marks: waypoints, routes and soundings to annotate and guide. | Three marks per view at most, including the beacon. | Chapter 05 |
| 10 | Imagery | Natural light, real work, water as metaphor, treated with restraint. | Six treatments; never more than two on one image. | Chapter 04 |

### 1.3.2 The ingredient cap

Use four or five ingredients per layout. The cap keeps pages calm and stops the system turning into a kit of parts.

- Colour and typography appear on every layout, so they count toward the cap.
- The identifier appears on every layout as the sign-off, so it counts too.
- That leaves one or two choices from the remaining seven for any given page.

### 1.3.3 Typical selections

The table shows how the cap works in practice. It is a guide; the count is the rule.

| Layout | Ingredients used | Count |
|---|---|---|
| Report cover | Logo, colour, typography, pattern (or imagery), shape grammar (blade) | 5 |
| Chapter opener | Identifier, colour, typography, shape grammar (section numeral, split rule) | 4 |
| Analysis page (Current archetype) | Identifier, colour, typography, data and UI | 4 |
| Exhibit with annotation | Identifier, colour, typography, data and UI, navigator's marks | 5 |
| Service card or social tile | Identifier or monogram, colour, typography, iconography | 4 |
| Case study opener | Identifier, colour, typography, imagery (blade crop) | 4 |
| Seal or stamp | Monogram, colour, shape grammar | 3 |

## 1.4 Colour in proportion

A Kayak page is mostly quiet: paper, mist and ink. Teal leads the eye, and one small point of saffron says where to look.

### 1.4.1 Primary colours

Four colours tell the story of the water we navigate with our clients. Paper White is the reading surface they sit on.

| Colour | Meaning | HEX | RGB | CMYK | Use |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Deep Current | The depth of expertise below the surface. Our anchor. | #0E2F3C | 14 47 60 | 77 22 0 76 | Wordmark, headings, dark grounds |
| Open Water | Clarity and steady progress. | #17807E | 23 128 126 | 82 0 2 50 | Left blade, links, charts, panels |
| Beacon Saffron | Direction and decisive guidance. | #EE9B1E | 238 155 30 | 0 35 87 7 | Right blade, highlights. Accent only |
| Sea Mist | Room to think. | #EEF4F1 | 238 244 241 | 2 0 1 4 | Page backgrounds and panels |
| Paper White | The default reading surface. | #FFFFFF | 255 255 255 | 0 0 0 0 | Pages, cards, print stock, type on Deep Current |

CMYK values are calculated starting points. Before a print run, confirm each colour against a printed proof on the chosen paper stock.

### 1.4.2 Secondary colours

Secondary colours mark the conditions we work in. Use them for cluster coding, categories and states, in small areas only. They are never the lead colour of a page.

| Colour | HEX | RGB | CMYK | Brand Manual use |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Storm Slate | #3E5563 | 62 85 99 | 37 14 0 61 | Body text, risk |

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Tidewater Blue | #2D6A9F | 45 106 159 | 72 33 0 38 | Technology and data |
| Kelp Green | #4B7A4E | 75 122 78 | 39 0 36 52 | People, ESG |
| Estuary Sand | #D8C5A1 | 216 197 161 | 0 9 25 15 | Warm panels, print |
| Red Clay | #B4472F | 180 71 47 | 0 61 74 29 | Risk flags, alerts |
| Riverstone | #8B9A9C | 139 154 156 | 11 1 0 39 | Rules, dividers |

### 1.4.3 Tertiary colours

Tertiary tints and shades are for scales, heat maps and UI states. Use them inside charts, tables and UI only.

| Colour | HEX | RGB | CMYK | Typical role |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Deep Lagoon | #0B5654 | 11 86 84 | 87 0 2 66 | Links on white and Sea Mist, primary hover |
| Shallows | #5DB2AB | 93 178 171 | 48 0 4 30 | Sequential ramp, hover on dark |
| Spray | #CDE8E3 | 205 232 227 | 12 0 2 9 | Secondary type on Deep Current, light ramp end |
| Burnished Gold | #9C630E | 156 99 14 | 0 37 91 39 | Warning text on light, Tax and Regulatory cluster |
| Dawn | #F5C46D | 245 196 109 | 0 20 56 4 | Warning text on dark, warm ramp |
| Haze | #FBEBCD | 251 235 205 | 0 6 18 2 | Highlight rows, warning surfaces |
| Undertow | #1F4B5F | 31 75 95 | 67 21 0 63 | Raised surfaces on Deep Current |
| Drizzle | #7A96A3 | 122 150 163 | 25 8 0 36 | Muted meta text, control outlines |
| Fog | #D4DEE2 | 212 222 226 | 6 2 0 11 | Hairlines, gridlines, card borders |
| Dusk Plum | #5E4B78 | 94 75 120 | 22 37 0 53 | International Desk cluster, categorical 6 |
| Lichen | #9AAD5A | 154 173 90 | 11 0 48 32 | Positive delta on dark, categorical 8 |
| Coral Flare | #E2735C | 226 115 92 | 0 49 59 11 | Error and negative delta on dark |

One further value appears in the reversed logo and the dark UI theme: Open Water on dark, #3FB0A9 (RGB 63 176 169). It replaces Open Water wherever teal must read on Deep Current (5.36:1). It is a screen value; its calculated CMYK starting point, by the same method as the palette, is 64 0 4 31. Proof it before any print use.

### 1.4.4 Service cluster colours

Six service clusters each own one colour. Cluster colours mark the clusters only.

| Cluster | Colour | HEX |
|---|---|---|
| Strategy and Deals | Open Water | #17807E |
| Tax and Regulatory | Burnished Gold | #9C630E |
| Crisis and Resilience | Storm Slate | #3E5563 |
| Technology and AI | Tidewater Blue | #2D6A9F |
| Managed Services | Kelp Green | #4B7A4E |
| International Desk | Dusk Plum | #5E4B78 |

### 1.4.5 Proportion: the light composition

Use the light composition for reports, proposals, web and most slides.

| Share | Colour | Role |
|---|---|---|
| 60% | White + Sea Mist | Paper and panels. The quiet that makes the page premium. |
| 22% | Deep Current | Headings, body ink, dark bands. |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 10% | Open Water | The lead colour: links, eyebrows, primary data, panels. |
| 5% | Supporting (secondary and tertiary) | Categories, states, rules. |
| 3% | Beacon Saffron | The one beacon. |
| 100% | | |

The Brand Manual states the same balance in four colours: White and Sea Mist 60%, Deep Current 25%, Open Water 10%, Beacon Saffron 5%. Layouts use the finer split above. Read 3% as the saffron target for a layout and 5% as the ceiling.

### 1.4.6 Proportion: the dark composition

Use the dark composition for openers, covers, keynotes and dark UI.

| Share | Colour | Role |
|---|---|---|
| 62% | Deep Current | The ground. |
| 15% | Undertow | Raised bands, sidebars, panels. |
| 12% | White type | Headlines and body copy. |
| 8% | Teal on dark (#3FB0A9, Spray, Shallows) | Data, secondary type, rules. |
| 3% | Beacon Saffron | The one beacon. |
| 100% | | |

### 1.4.7 Three moods

| Mood | Ground | Default use |
|---|---|---|
| Light | Paper White, Sea Mist panels | Default for reading: reports, proposals, web, most slides |
| Sea Mist | Sea Mist page, white cards | Dashboards, appendices, data-heavy reference |
| Dark | Deep Current, Undertow bands | Openers and covers, keynotes, dark UI |

A document opens on dark, reads on light and closes on dark (chapter 03).

### 1.4.8 The saffron rule

One beacon per view: the key figure, the action or the turning point.

- Never body text on white. Saffron on white is 2.25:1 and fails.
- As type, saffron lives only on Deep Current, where it reaches 6.27:1 (AA).
- On a saffron panel, set text in Deep Current (6.27:1).
- Saffron is a signal. It is never a page or card surface, a text colour on light grounds, or decoration. Small saffron chips and seals are allowed, with Deep Current text.

Example: on a Deep Current card, "₹412 cr" in saffron with the label "EBITDA FY25" and the context line "+18% year on year" in White or Spray.

### 1.4.9 Approved pairings

WCAG 2.1 contrast. Text needs 4.5:1 (AA). Large text (24 px or 18 pt and above) and graphics need 3:1. Ratios below are calculated from the hex values.

| Text | Ground | Ratio | Rating | Use |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Deep Current | White | 14.09:1 | AAA | Headings, body, labels |
| Storm Slate | White | 7.82:1 | AAA | Body copy and captions |
| Open Water | White | 4.75:1 | AA | Links, eyebrows, figures |
| White | Deep Current | 14.09:1 | AAA | Type on dark pages |
| Spray | Deep Current | 10.90:1 | AAA | Secondary type on dark |
| Beacon Saffron | Deep Current | 6.27:1 | AA | The beacon figure or word |
| White | Open Water | 4.75:1 | AA | Primary buttons, tags |
| Deep Current | Beacon Saffron | 6.27:1 | AA | Highlight chips, seals |
| Deep Current | Sea Mist | 12.64:1 | AAA | Panels, callouts, tables |
| Open Water | Sea Mist | 4.26:1 | AA large | 24 px and larger only |
| Riverstone | White | 2.92:1 | Graphics only | Gridlines only, never text |
| Beacon Saffron | White | 2.25:1 | Fail | Never: fails as text |

### 1.4.10 Readability rules

1. Set body text in Deep Current or Storm Slate on White, Sea Mist, Spray or Haze.
2. On Deep Current, set text in White or Spray.
3. Saffron is a signal, never text on light grounds. On a saffron panel, use Deep Current text.
4. Use Open Water for text only on White, or at 24 px / 18 pt and above. On Sea Mist, small text and links use Deep Lagoon (7.62:1).
5. Muted Drizzle text (3.13:1 on white) is for placeholders and meta only.
6. In charts, never rely on colour alone. Add labels, line styles or patterns.

### 1.4.11 Full readability matrix

Calculated contrast for every text colour against the main grounds. AAA is 7:1 and above (any text). AA is 4.5:1 (body text). Large is 3:1 (text 24 px / 18 pt and above only). Fail means never for text.

| Text | White | Sea Mist | Haze | Spray | Deep Current | Storm Slate | Undertow |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Deep Current | 14.09 AAA | 12.64 AAA | 11.99 AAA | 10.90 AAA | n/a | 1.80 Fail | 1.50 Fail |
| Storm Slate | 7.82 AAA | 7.02 AAA | 6.66 AA | 6.05 AA | 1.80 Fail | n/a | 1.20 Fail |
| Deep Lagoon | 8.49 AAA | 7.62 AAA | 7.22 AAA | 6.57 AA | 1.66 Fail | 1.09 Fail | 1.11 Fail |
| Open Water | 4.75 AA | 4.26 Large | 4.04 Large | 3.67 Large | 2.97 Fail | 1.65 Fail | 1.98 Fail |
| Tidewater Blue | 5.72 AA | 5.13 AA | 4.86 AA | 4.42 Large | 2.46 Fail | 1.37 Fail | 1.65 Fail |
| Kelp Green | 5.01 AA | 4.49 Large | 4.26 Large | 3.87 Large | 2.81 Fail | 1.56 Fail | 1.88 Fail |
| Red Clay | 5.41 AA | 4.85 AA | 4.60 AA | 4.18 Large | 2.61 Fail | 1.45 Fail | 1.74 Fail |
| Burnished Gold | 4.99 AA | 4.48 Large | 4.25 Large | 3.86 Large | 2.82 Fail | 1.57 Fail | 1.89 Fail |
| Beacon Saffron | 2.25 Fail | 2.02 Fail | 1.91 Fail | 1.74 Fail | 6.27 AA | 3.48 Large | 4.19 Large |
| White | n/a | 1.11 Fail | 1.18 Fail | 1.29 Fail | 14.09 AAA | 7.82 AAA | 9.42 AAA |
| Spray | 1.29 Fail | 1.16 Fail | 1.10 Fail | n/a | 10.90 AAA | 6.05 AA | 7.29 AAA |
| Open Water on dark #3FB0A9 | 2.63 Fail | 2.36 Fail | 2.23 Fail | 2.03 Fail | 5.36 AA | 2.98 Fail | 3.59 Large |

Two consequences matter most. Open Water passes as small text on white but not on Sea Mist, so links on Sea Mist use Deep Lagoon. Saffron passes only on Deep Current, so the saffron beacon on a light page is a shape, a bar or a rule, never a word.

## 1.5 Typography in layout

Archivo builds the structure and carries the numbers. Source Serif 4 carries the voice. One clear order of reading.

### 1.5.1 The two families

| Family | Role | Weights available | Use |
|---|---|---|---|
| Archivo (primary) | Structure and numbers | Regular 400, Medium 500, SemiBold 600, Bold 700, Expanded Bold 700 | Headlines, labels, tables, charts, slides and everything on screen. The same family sets STRATEGIC ADVISORS in the logo. Its width axis gives expanded headlines and compact text from one typeface. |
| Source Serif 4 (secondary) | The voice | Regular 400, Italic 400, SemiBold 600, Bold 700 | Standfirsts, quotations, essays, letters and long reading. It lends the authority and warmth of good editorial writing. |

- Licence: both families are under the SIL Open Font License, free for print, web and apps.
- Source: folder 05_Fonts of the KSA Logo Package, or Google Fonts.
- Fallbacks: where fonts cannot be installed, such as email, use Arial for Archivo and Georgia for Source Serif 4.
- Character set: both include ₹, $, €, %, &, @ and brackets. Archivo also carries the arrow →.

### 1.5.2 Pairing rules

- Archivo for structure: headings, labels, tables and every number.
- Source Serif 4 for the voice: standfirsts, quotes, essays.
- Expanded width only at 20 pt and above.
- Three weights at most per document: 400, 600, 700.

### 1.5.3 Editorial hierarchy: A4 report sizes

The typeset spread is "Sector Outlook FY26", pages 4–5. These nine levels set every A4 report and thought-leadership document.

| Level | Style | Typeface and weight | Size / leading | Width or tracking | Example |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Eyebrow | Archivo 600, capitals | 9/12 pt | Tracking +260 | SECTOR OUTLOOK · FY26 |
| 2 | Display | Archivo Expanded 700 | 44/46 pt | Width 125% | Credit moves to the middle |
| 3 | H1 | Archivo Expanded 700 | 28/32 pt | Width 118% | The mid-market |
| 4 | H2 | Archivo 700 | 18/24 pt | Normal | Where growth will come from |
| 5 | H3 | Archivo 700 | 12/16 pt | Normal | Three signals to watch in FY26 |
| 6 | Standfirst | Source Serif 4 400 | 15/22 pt | Normal | Lenders rediscover the middle. |
| 7 | Body | Archivo 400 | 10/15 pt | Normal | Non-bank lenders have spent three years building underwriting... |
| 8 | Caption | Archivo 400 | 8/11 pt | Normal | Source: RBI Database on Indian Economy; CIBIL MSME Pulse; KSA analysis |
| 9 | Figure | Archivo Expanded 700 | Set by layout | Unit at 40% of the figure | ₹2.4 lakh cr |

On the spread, the levels read in this order: eyebrow, display headline, standfirst, H2 with its body column, the exhibit (H3 title, figure "₹2.4 lakh cr", context "+21% on FY24", FY20 to FY25 bars), a pull quote, and the caption carrying the source. The folio line reads "KSA · Sector Outlook FY26" with page numbers 04 and 05.

### 1.5.4 Base hierarchy from the Brand Manual

The Brand Manual sets a base hierarchy for general documents such as letters and proposals. Print sizes are in points, screen sizes in pixels. Where it differs from the editorial hierarchy above, reports and thought leadership follow the editorial hierarchy.

| Style | Specification | Print | Screen |
|---|---|---|---|
| Display | Archivo Expanded Bold | 40 pt / 44 | 56 px |
| Heading 1 | Archivo SemiBold, 112% width | 26 pt / 32 | 36 px |
| Heading 2 | Archivo SemiBold | 17 pt / 22 | 24 px |
| Heading 3 | Archivo Bold | 12 pt / 16 | 17 px |
| Label | Archivo SemiBold capitals, tracking +300 | 8 pt | 12 px |
| Body, print | Source Serif 4 Regular | 10.5 pt / 16 | n/a |
| Body, screen | Archivo Regular | n/a | 16 px / 26; slides 18 pt minimum |
| Quote | Source Serif 4 Italic, Open Water | 18 pt / 26 | n/a |
| Caption | Archivo Regular, Storm Slate | 8.5 pt / 12 | 13 px |

Screen type for products follows the token scale in chapter 07 (Display 56/60, H1 40/48, H2 32/40, H3 24/32, Body 16/24, Caption 12/16, Overline 11/16 on web).

### 1.5.5 Numbers

- Set every number in Archivo.
- Use tabular figures in all tables and charts, so columns of figures align on the decimal: 1,118.4 / 904.0 / 2,022.4.
- Set the unit at 40% of the figure size: "₹4,280 cr", "₹2.4 lakh cr".
- Big figures use Archivo Expanded 700.
- Use Indian digit grouping with ₹ crore and lakh: ₹1,24,500.

### 1.5.6 Pull quotes

- Set pull quotes in Source Serif 4, at a size well above body. The Brand Manual quote style is Source Serif 4 Italic in Open Water, 18 pt / 26.
- Open with blade-pair marks in Open Water and close with saffron. Never use typed quotation marks as ornaments (chapter 05, dividers and rules).
- Attribute in Archivo SemiBold capitals with tracking, for example "KSA PARTNER, RISK".

Example: "Good risk work is quiet. You notice it only when it is missing."

### 1.5.7 Line length

- Keep 60–75 characters per line. A comfortable measure lets the eye find the next line without effort.
- Where the text area is wider, split the text into columns.

### 1.5.8 Alignment

- Left aligned, ragged right.
- Never justified. Justified text opens uneven word gaps that break the calm of the page.
- Centre only short display lines on covers.

### 1.5.9 Type checklist

| Check | Pass condition |
|---|---|
| Families | Archivo and Source Serif 4 only (Arial and Georgia as fallbacks) |
| Weights | No more than three per document: 400, 600, 700 |
| Expanded width | Used only at 20 pt and above |
| Numbers | Archivo, tabular in tables and charts, unit at 40% |
| Measure | 60–75 characters per line |
| Alignment | Left, ragged right; centred only for short cover lines |
| Baseline | Body text on the 12 pt (print) or 24 px (screen) baseline |
| Colour | Body in Deep Current or Storm Slate on light; White or Spray on Deep Current |

## 1.6 Chapter summary checks

Use this list before moving to chapter 02.

1. The page has one beacon of Beacon Saffron, and no saffron text on a light ground.
2. The light page is about 60% White and Sea Mist; the dark page is about 62% Deep Current.
3. Four or five ingredients are in use, never all ten.
4. Every diagonal comes from the angle set; every end is cut flat.
5. Type follows the editorial hierarchy, left aligned, with tabular figures.
6. Every exhibit shows its source, unit and method.
7. A senior partner would be proud to put it in front of a board.

CHAPTER 02

# Shape grammar and logo geometry

Every angle, gap and edge in our graphics comes from the logo. We did not invent a graphic language. We measured the one already in the wordmark and wrote it down. This chapter gives the construction of the logo from its master coordinates, the six logo versions, clear space, minimum sizes, background pairings and misuse rules. It then covers the KSA monogram, the table of geometric constants, the eight shape primitives and how they combine, and the grammar rules, corner radius scale and stroke weight scale that keep every shape speaking with one voice. Learn the geometry once and the whole system draws itself.

## 2.1 The logo

### 2.1.1 Anatomy

The logo is a wordmark with a built-in identifier. Always reproduce it from the master artwork in the KSA Logo Package. Never redraw, retype or recolour it.

| No. | Part | Description |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Wordmark | KAYAK in custom geometric capitals. The two A's are left open, like bows cutting through water, and the word reads the same in both directions: a quiet sign of balance. |
| 2 | Identifier | The Confluence Y. Two blades, Open Water and Beacon Saffron, converge into one Deep Current stem: two partners, one decision. |
| 3 | Descriptor | STRATEGIC ADVISORS in Archivo SemiBold, spaced to the full width of the wordmark. It is part of the artwork: never retype or reposition it. |

### 2.1.2 The unit system

All logo geometry is drawn on a cap height of 100 units. The master SVG uses y = 0 at the cap line (top) and y = 100 at the baseline (bottom). Angles in this manual are measured from the horizontal.

| Artwork | Width × height (units) | Master file |
|---|---|---|
| Full logo (wordmark + descriptor) | 416 × 134 | KSA_Logo_Full_*.svg |
| Wordmark only | 416 × 100 | KSA_Wordmark_*.svg |
| Identifier (Confluence Y) | 92 × 100 | KSA_Identifier_*.svg |
| Monogram (KSA) | 268 × 100 | KSA_Monogram_*.svg |
| App icon tile | 100 × 100 | KSA_AppIcon_DeepCurrent_Rounded.svg |

### 2.1.3 Letter positions

The wordmark is five forms set on one baseline. The two A's and the two K's use the same outlines; only their x position changes.

| Letter | x from | x to | Width | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| K (first) | 0 | 84 | 84 | Upright 0–28 |
| A (first) | 92 | 182 | 90 | Gap to K at the baseline: 8 units |
| Y (identifier) | 161 | 253 | 92 | Nests between the A shoulders |
| A (second) | 232 | 322 | 90 | Same outline as the first A |
| K (second) | 332 | 416 | 84 | Gap to A at the baseline: 10 units |

The Y's blades sit 10 units clear of each A shoulder at the cap line: the first A's top right corner is at x = 151 and the left blade starts at x = 161; the right blade ends at x = 253 and the second A's top left corner is at x = 263. The Y's centre axis is x = 207, which is the centre of the A–Y–A group and one unit left of the overall centre (208).

## 2.1.4 Construction of the K

Master path: `M0 0 H28 V38.7 L52 0 H82 L50.1 51.5 L84 100 H54 L36 74.2 L28 87.1 V100 H0 Z`

| Point | (x, y) | What it marks |
|---|---|---|
| Upright, top left | (0, 0) | Cap line |
| Upright, top right | (28, 0) | Upright width 28 = X |
| Arm junction | (28, 38.7) | Where the arm leaves the upright. "Arm 38.7" |
| Arm, top inner | (52, 0) | Arm meets the cap line |
| Arm, top outer | (82, 0) | Arm width at the cap line: 82 – 52 = 30 |
| Leg junction | (50.1, 51.5) | Where the arm turns into the leg |
| Leg, foot outer | (84, 100) | Baseline |
| Leg, foot inner | (54, 100) | Leg width at the baseline: 84 – 54 = 30 |
| Crotch | (36, 74.2) | Inner end of the leg |
| Crotch, upright side | (28, 87.1) | The cut returns to the upright |
| Upright, foot | (28, 100) to (0, 100) | Baseline |

Angles in the K:

| Edge | Rise : run | Formula | Exact | Constant |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Arm, inner edge (28, 38.7) → (52, 0) | 38.7 : 24 | atan(38.7 / 24) | 58.19° | 58° |
| Arm, outer edge (82, 0) → (50.1, 51.5) | 51.5 : 31.9 | atan(51.5 / 31.9) | 58.23° | 58° |
| Crotch cut (36, 74.2) → (28, 87.1) | 12.9 : 8 | atan(12.9 / 8) | 58.19° | 58° |
| Leg, outer edge (50.1, 51.5) → (84, 100) | 48.5 : 33.9 | atan(48.5 / 33.9) | 55.05° | 55° |
| Leg, inner edge (36, 74.2) → (54, 100) | 25.8 : 18 | atan(25.8 / 18) | 55.10° | 55° |

The crotch cut runs parallel to the arm, so the K carries the 58° paddle angle three times.

## 2.1.5 Construction of the A

Master path (local to each A): `M0 100 L31 0 L59 0 L90 100 L61 100 L45 44 L29 100 Z`

| Point (local) | (x, y) | What it marks |
|---|---|---|
| Left foot, outer | (0, 100) | Baseline |
| Apex, left | (31, 0) | Cap line |
| Apex, right | (59, 0) | Flat apex 59 – 31 = 28 = X |
| Right foot, outer | (90, 100) | Baseline |
| Right foot, inner | (61, 100) | Foot width 90 – 61 = 29 |
| Counter apex | (45, 44) | The open bow. No crossbar |
| Left foot, inner | (29, 100) | Foot width 29 – 0 = 29 |

| Edge | Rise : run | Formula | Exact | Constant |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Outer slopes (0, 100) → (31, 0) and (59, 0) → (90, 100) | 100 : 31 | atan(100 / 31) | 72.78° | 73° |
| Counter edges (29, 100) → (45, 44) and (45, 44) → (61, 100) | 56 : 16 | atan(56 / 16) | 74.05° | 73° family |

The outer slopes define the 73° constant. The counter is cut a little steeper so the bow narrows as it rises; it opens 32 units wide at the baseline (29 to 61) and closes at a point 44 units below the cap line. Use 73° for every graphic derived from the A.

## 2.1.6 Construction of the Confluence Y

Coordinates are local to the identifier (add 161 for the wordmark position).

| Part | Master path | Fill (full colour) |
|---|---|---|
| Left blade | `M0 0 L30 0 L44 26.25 L44 59.3 Z` | Open Water #17807E |
| Right blade | `M92 0 L62 0 L48 26.25 L48 59.3 Z` | Beacon Saffron #EE9B1E |
| Stem | `M32 51 L46 70 L60 51 L60 100 L32 100 Z` | Deep Current #0E2F3C |

Named guide lines on the identifier, measured down from the cap line:

| Guide | Depth below cap (y) | Height above baseline | What happens there |
|---|---|---|---|
| Cap | 0 | 100 | Blades start, flat cut, 30 units wide each |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Knee | 26.25 | 73.75 | Each blade's inner edge turns from 62° to vertical |
| Arm | 38.7 | 61.3 | Height of the K's arm junction, carried across the wordmark |
| Tip | 59.3 | 40.7 | Blade tips |
| Base | 100 | 0 | Baseline; foot of the stem |

Angles in the Y:

| Edge | Rise : run | Formula | Exact | Constant |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Blade inner edge (30, 0) → (44, 26.25) | 26.25 : 14 | atan(26.25 / 14) | 61.93° | 62° |
| Same ratio, reduced | 15 : 8 | atan(15 / 8) | 61.93° | 62° |
| Blade outer edge (0, 0) → (44, 59.3) | 59.3 : 44 | atan(59.3 / 44) | 53.42° | 53° |
| Stem notch (32, 51) → (46, 70) | 19 : 14 | atan(19 / 14) | 53.62° | 53° |

The inner edge ratio 14 : 26.25 reduces exactly to 8 : 15, because 14 / 26.25 = 0.5333 = 8 / 15. Use 8 : 15 when drawing 62° lines on a grid.

Key dimensions of the Y:

| Dimension | Value (units) | Derivation |
|---|---|---|
| The split | 4 | Left blade tip at x = 44, right blade tip at x = 48. 48 – 44 = 4 = 4% of the cap height |
| Split length | 33.05 | Parallel vertical edges from the knee (26.25) to the tip (59.3) |
| Opening at the cap line | 32 | Inner corners at x = 30 and x = 62 |
| Blade width at the cap line | 30 | 0 to 30, and 62 to 92 |
| Blade outer edge length | 73.84 | $\sqrt{(44^2 + 59.3^2)}$ |
| Blade inner edge length (cap to knee) | 29.75 | $\sqrt{(14^2 + 26.25^2)}$ |
| Stem width | 28 | 32 to 60. Equal to X |
| Stem notch depth | 19 | Notch shoulders at y = 51, apex at y = 70 |
| Notch apex | (46, 70) | On the centre axis of the split (44 + 4 / 2 = 46) |
| Blade to stem clearance | 4.69 to 4.77 | Measured square to the blade's outer edge. The notch runs parallel to the blade, so the three parts never touch |

## 2.1.7 The descriptor

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Text | STRATEGIC ADVISORS |
| Typeface | Archivo SemiBold, capitals |
| Width | Spaced to the full wordmark width, x = 0 to 416 |
| Cap height | About 10 units (y = 124.05 to 134.0) |
| Gap from wordmark baseline | About 24 units (y = 100 to 124.05) |
| Colour, full colour version | Storm Slate #3E5563 (7.82:1 on white) |
| Colour, reversed version | Spray #CDE8E3 (10.90:1 on Deep Current) |

The descriptor is outlined in the master artwork. Never retype, restyle or reposition it.

## 2.1.8 X recurs in the logo

X is 28 units, the width of the K upright. The same 28 units appear three more times:

| Where | Width |
|---|---|
| K upright | 28 |
| Flat apex of each A | 59 – 31 = 28 |
| Y stem | 60 – 32 = 28 |

This is why X works as the clear space unit for every version of the logo, including the identifier on its own, where the stem carries the same 28 units.

# 2.2 Logo versions

Use full colour wherever you can. The other versions exist for backgrounds and print methods where full colour will not hold.

### 2.2.1 The six versions

| No. | Version | Wordmark | Left blade | Right blade | Stem | Descriptor | Use |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Full colour | Deep Current #0E2F3C | Open Water #17807E | Beacon Saffron #EE9B1E | Deep Current | Storm Slate #3E5563 | The default. White and light backgrounds |
| 2 | Reversed | White #FFFFFF | Open Water on dark #3FB0A9 | Beacon Saffron #EE9B1E | White | Spray #CDE8E3 | Deep Current, Undertow and dark photography |
| 3 | One colour, Deep Current | #0E2F3C | #0E2F3C | #0E2F3C | #0E2F3C | #0E2F3C | Single-colour print, embossing, engraving and foil |
| 4 | One colour, White | #FFFFFF | #FFFFFF | #FFFFFF | #FFFFFF | #FFFFFF | Open Water and other mid-tone colours, and busy images |
| 5 | One colour, Black | #000000 | #000000 | #000000 | #000000 | #000000 | Newspapers, forms and black-only printing |
| 6 | Wordmark only | Full colour or reversed, as above | as 1 or 2 | as 1 or 2 | as 1 or 2 | None | Below 45 mm or 240 px wide, where the descriptor would be too small to read |

In the one-colour versions, the blades and the stem take the same colour. The 4-unit split and the 4.7-unit clearance between blades and stem keep the three parts readable.

### 2.2.2 Supporting artwork

| Artwork | Versions supplied | Use |
|---|---|---|
| Identifier | Full colour, Reversed (#3FB0A9 left blade, White stem), One colour White | App icon, social avatar, document marker, favicon, the sign-off on every layout |
| App icon | Deep Current tile, identifier at 56% of tile width, centred (offset 22 units left, 19.57 units top on a 100-unit tile); left blade #3FB0A9, right blade saffron, white stem | iOS and Android home screens. The 22-unit corner radius is the platform's mask; the artwork inside stays square |
| Monogram | See section 2.8 | Seals, avatars, footers, merchandise |

### 2.2.3 The step-down rule

Below the full-logo minimum, switch to the wordmark. Below the wordmark minimum, use the identifier.

# 2.3 Clear space

### 2.3.1 The rule

X is the width of the K's upright: 28 units. Keep a margin of at least 2X (56 units) clear on every side. No text, image, rule or page edge may enter it. The same 2X sets the minimum gap between the logo and any edge, rule or image.

| Measure | Units | As a share of logo width (416) |
|---|---|---|
| X | 28 | 6.73% |
| 2X clear space | 56 | 13.46% |
| Full logo plus clear space | 528 × 246 | n/a |
| Wordmark plus clear space | 528 × 212 | n/a |
| Identifier plus clear space | 204 × 212 | n/a |

### 2.3.2 Clear space at minimum sizes

| Version | Artwork units | Minimum width | 1 unit | X | 2X clear space | Height at minimum |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|

| | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Full logo | 416 × 134 | 45 mm | 0.108 mm | 3.03 mm | 6.06 mm | 14.50 mm |
| Full logo | 416 × 134 | 240 px | 0.577 px | 16.2 px | 32.3 px | 77.3 px |
| Wordmark only | 416 × 100 | 20 mm | 0.048 mm | 1.35 mm | 2.69 mm | 4.81 mm |
| Wordmark only | 416 × 100 | 100 px | 0.240 px | 6.7 px | 13.5 px | 24.0 px |
| Identifier | 92 × 100 | 6 mm | 0.065 mm | 1.83 mm | 3.65 mm | 6.52 mm |
| Identifier | 92 × 100 | 20 px | 0.217 px | 6.1 px | 12.2 px | 21.7 px |

Formula: 1 unit = minimum width ÷ artwork width in units. X = 28 × 1 unit. Clear space = 2X. Round clear space up, never down: for screens, to the next 4 px step; for print, to the next 0.5 mm.

### 2.3.3 Worked examples

The widths below are examples for the arithmetic. The application chapters set the actual sizes.

| Example placement | Example logo width | X | 2X |
|---|---|---|---|
| Slide footer identifier (1920 × 1080) | 32 px identifier | 9.7 px | 19.5 px, use 20 px |
| Website header | 240 px full logo | 16.2 px | 32.3 px, use 36 px |
| A4 report cover | 60 mm full logo | 4.04 mm | 8.08 mm, use 8.5 mm |
| Letterhead | 45 mm full logo | 3.03 mm | 6.06 mm, use 6.5 mm |

## 2.4 Minimum sizes

| Version | Print | Screen |
|---|---|---|
| Full logo | 45 mm wide | 240 px wide |
| Wordmark only | 20 mm wide | 100 px wide |
| Identifier | 6 mm wide | 20 px wide |
| Monogram | 12 mm wide | 48 px wide |

At 45 mm the descriptor's cap height is about 1.1 mm. Smaller than this it stops being legible, which is why the full logo steps down to the wordmark.

## 2.5 Backgrounds

Each brand background has one right version of the logo. Pick the version from the background, never the other way round.

### 2.5.1 Background pairings

| Background | HEX | Logo version | Wordmark contrast |
|---|---|---|---|
| White | #FFFFFF | Full colour | Deep Current 14.09:1 |
| Sea Mist | #EEF4F1 | Full colour | Deep Current 12.64:1 |
| Spray | #CDE8E3 | Full colour | Deep Current 10.90:1 |
| Haze | #FBEBCD | Full colour | Deep Current 11.99:1 |
| Deep Current | #0E2F3C | Reversed | White 14.09:1 |
| Undertow | #1F4B5F | Reversed | White 9.42:1 |
| Open Water | #17807E | One colour, White | White 4.75:1 |
| Beacon Saffron | #EE9B1E | One colour, Deep Current | Deep Current 6.27:1 |

Other mid-tone colours take the one-colour White version. For any other ground, including patterns at Display strength, move the logo onto a White or Deep Current panel.

### 2.5.2 On photographs

Place the logo over a calm, even part of the image: reversed on dark areas, full colour on light ones. If no calm area exists, set the logo on a solid Deep Current panel. The panel extends at least 2X beyond the logo on every side.

# 2.6 Misuse

The logo only works when it is left exactly as drawn. These are the most common ways it gets broken.

| No. | Don't | Why |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Stretch or squash it | Every angle in the system is measured from it. Scaling one axis breaks 58°, 62°, 53°, 55° and 73° at once |
| 2 | Rotate or tilt it | The blades converge on a vertical stem; the idea depends on it |
| 3 | Change its colours | The colours carry the meaning of each part |
| 4 | Swap the blade colours | Open Water is always left (clarity), Beacon Saffron always right (direction) |
| 5 | Add shadows, glows or bevels | Brand graphics have no effects. Depth comes from tone |
| 6 | Place full colour on mid-tone backgrounds | Use the version the background calls for (section 2.5) |
| 7 | Retype or restyle the descriptor | It is outlined artwork, set to the full width of the wordmark |
| 8 | Put it inside a badge or frame | The clear space is the frame. Seals use the monogram or identifier |
| 9 | Redraw or rebuild it | Always place the master files from the KSA Logo Package |
| 10 | Close the split or let the blades touch the stem | The gaps stand for discipline. Blades never touch |
| 11 | Enter the 2X clear space | No text, image, rule or page edge inside 2X |
| 12 | Use it below its minimum size | Step down: full logo, wordmark, identifier |
| 13 | Outline it or set it in a keyline | Shapes are solid, scaled whole |
| 14 | Put it on a busy image without a panel | Use a calm area or a solid Deep Current panel |

Rules 1 to 8 are the Brand Manual's misuse page. Rules 9 to 14 restate rules from the Brand Manual and this manual in the same form.

# 2.7 Where the identifier stands alone

The Y sits at the exact centre of KAYAK. It carries the whole story on its own, so it can stand in for the brand where the full logo will not fit.

| Placement | Version | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| App icon | Deep Current tile | Identifier at 56% of tile width |
| Social avatar | Full colour or reversed | Circle crops keep the identifier clear of the edge by 2X |
| Document marker | Full colour | The sign-off on every page, slide and screen; bottom right of exhibits |
| Favicon | Full colour or reversed | Rendered from the master files, never redrawn |

# 2.8 The KSA monogram

## 2.8.1 What it is

K and S are drawn in Deep Current, from the same geometry as the wordmark. The A rises as two blades, Open Water and Beacon Saffron, that meet at one peak. The Y in the logo shows two partners converging on a decision; the A shows them rising together to the summit.

## 2.8.2 Construction

The monogram artwork is 268 × 100 units on the same 100-unit cap height.

| Letter | x position | Construction | Colour (full colour) |
|---|---|---|---|
| K | 0–84 | The wordmark K, unchanged: upright 28 = X, arm at 58°, leg at 55° | Deep Current #0E2F3C |
| S | From x = 94 | One stroke 26 units wide on a curved centreline, filling the full cap height (centreline from y = 13 to y = 87, plus 13 units either side). Ends cut flat | Deep Current #0E2F3C |
| A, left blade | 178–221 | `M0 100 L31 0 L43 0 L43 51 L29 100 Z` (local) | Open Water #17807E |
| A, right blade | 225–268 | `M47 0 L59 0 L90 100 L61 100 L47 51 Z` (local) | Beacon Saffron #EE9B1E |

Geometry of the monogram A:

| Measure | Value | Derivation |
|---|---|---|

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Outer slopes | 73° | atan(100 / 31) = 72.78°, the wordmark A's slope |
| Split between the blades | 4 units | x = 43 to x = 47, from the cap line down to y = 51 |
| Peak width | 28 units = X | 31 to 59, divided 12 + 4 + 12 by the split |
| Inner flare below the split | 74.05° | atan(49 / 14), from (43, 51) to (29, 100) |
| Counter opening at the baseline | 32 units | 29 to 61, the same as the wordmark A |

The S is the only curve in the brand. It is the source of the Current pattern and the one exception to the no-curves rule.

### 2.8.3 Monogram versions

| Version | K and S | Left blade | Right blade | Ground |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Full colour | Deep Current | Open Water #17807E | Beacon Saffron | White or light |
| Reversed | White | #3FB0A9 | Beacon Saffron | Deep Current, Undertow |
| One colour, Deep Current | #0E2F3C | #0E2F3C | #0E2F3C | Embossing, foil, engraving |
| One colour, White | #FFFFFF | #FFFFFF | #FFFFFF | Mid-tones, images |
| One colour, Black | #000000 | #000000 | #000000 | Black-only print |
| Tile, Deep Current | White | #3FB0A9 | Beacon Saffron | Deep Current square tile |
| Tile, Deep Current rounded | White | #3FB0A9 | Beacon Saffron | Deep Current tile, 22% corner (platform mask) |
| Tile, White | Deep Current | Open Water | Beacon Saffron | White square tile |
| Tile, Open Water | White | White | White | Open Water square tile |

In every tile, the monogram spans 62% of the tile width and sits centred.

### 2.8.4 Size and clear space

| Measure | Print | Screen |
|---|---|---|
| Minimum width | 12 mm | 48 px |
| 1 unit at minimum | 0.045 mm | 0.179 px |
| Clear space X at minimum (28 units) | 1.25 mm | 5.0 px |
| Height at minimum | 4.48 mm | 17.9 px |

Clear space for the monogram is X (the width of the K's upright) on every side. This is half the logo's 2X, because the monogram is used in tight, already-framed places such as seals and avatars. The misuse rules in section 2.6 apply in full.

### 2.8.5 When to use it

Use the monogram where our name is already known or space is tight:

- social avatars;
- seals and stamps;
- document headers;
- slide footers;
- signage details;
- merchandise (for example the debossed A5 notebook, the tote bag and the tea tin).

It never replaces the full logo on a first impression: covers, the website header and the front of business cards.

## 2.9 Geometric constants

Every graphic in the system uses these constants and no others.

| Constant | Value | Source in the logo | Formula and check | Used for |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| K-arm angle (the paddle angle) | 58° | 24 : 38.7, the K's arms | atan(38.7 / 24) = 58.19° | K-lattice pattern, diagonal crops, annotation leaders |

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| K-leg angle | 55° | 33.9 : 48.5, the K's lower leg | atan(48.5 / 33.9) = 55.05° | Chevron dividers, waypoint arrows |
| Blade inner edge | 62° | 14 : 26.25 = 8 : 15 | atan(26.25 / 14) = 61.93° | Wake lines, hairline overlays, image crop masks |
| Blade outer edge | 53° | 44 : 59.3; repeated in the stem notch (14 : 19) | atan(59.3 / 44) = 53.42°; atan(19 / 14) = 53.62° | Chevron wake, badge cuts, blade crops |
| A slope | 73° | 31 : 100, both A diagonals | atan(100 / 31) = 72.78° | Delta pattern, trapezoid frames, cover bands |
| The split | 4 units | 4% of cap height, between the blades | 48 – 44 = 4; 4 / 100 = 4% | Paired rules, pinstripe, gaps between converging strokes |
| X unit | 28 units | Width of the K upright | 28 – 0 = 28 | Clear space 2X, logo margins, minimum gaps |
| Flat cut | 0° and 90° | Every terminal in the logo is cut flat | No round, bevelled or tapered ends exist in the master paths | Every stroke end, rule end and shape edge |
| Stroke scale | 0.5 · 1.5 · 2 · 3 | Hairline to bar, from print to screen | 0.5 pt hairline; 1.5, 2 and 3 px on screen | Pattern hairlines, rules, icons (2 px), emphasis bars |

### 2.9.1 The angle set

Use only these angles, plus 0° and 90°. Never rotate a shape onto a new angle.

| Angle | Name | Exact source value | Slope (rise per unit run) |
|---|---|---|---|
| 0° | Flat cut | Horizontal | 0 |
| 53° | Blade outer | 53.42° | 1.348 |
| 55° | K leg | 55.05° | 1.431 |
| 58° | K arm | 58.19° | 1.613 |
| 62° | Blade inner | 61.93° | 1.875 |
| 73° | A slope | 72.78° | 3.226 |
| 90° | Stem | Vertical | infinite |

When drawing in a tool that takes rise and run, use the logo ratios directly: 38.7 : 24 for 58°, 48.5 : 33.9 for 55°, 15 : 8 for 62°, 59.3 : 44 for 53°, 100 : 31 for 73°.

## 2.10 The shape vocabulary

Eight primitives, each cut from the logo. Everything we draw, from a seal to a loading state, is a sentence made of these words.

### 2.10.1 The eight primitives

| No. | Primitive | Definition | Geometry | Use |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | Blade | One arm of the Confluence Y. Edges at 53° and 62°, cut flat. | Polygon (0, 0), (30, 0), (44, 26.25), (44, 59.3) | Crops, cover bands, section markers |
| 02 | Chevron | Both blades as strokes: the confluence of two currents. | Two parallel-sided strokes on the 62° inner edge, mirrored, 4% split between them, flat cuts at both ends | Openers, progress, dividers |
| 03 | Stem | The Y's base with its 53° notch, cut square. | 28 × 49 units; notch 19 deep at 53°; square foot | Anchors, list markers, vertical rules |
| 04 | Split | The 4% gap between the blades, kept between any pair. | Gap = 4% of the shape's height | Paired rules, pinstripe, gutters |
| 05 | Delta | The A as a solid trapezoid on its 73° slopes. | Top 28 (X), base 90, height 100; no counter | Delta pattern, tabs, callouts |
| 06 | Wake line | A hairline on the blade's 62° inner edge. | 0.5 pt / 1 px line at 62° (8 : 15) | Overlays, textures, loading shimmer |
| 07 | Beacon | A saffron square with a hairline halo. One per view. | Solid Beacon Saffron square; 1 px saffron square halo 2.5 times its side, centred | Key figure, active state, waypoint |
| 08 | Frame | Four corner marks with flat ends. | L-shaped marks, 2 px or 1 pt, Deep Current, square corners | Figures, quotes, image focus |

### 2.10.2 Primitive notes

Blade. Keep both edge angles. A blade scaled to a cover band keeps its 53° outer edge and 62° inner edge; never straighten either one to fit a box.

Chevron. The two strokes are equal in width. Open Water on the left, saffron on the right when the chevron is the view's beacon; otherwise both strokes take Open Water or Deep Current.

Stem. Use it upright only. As a list marker it sits on the text's cap height; as a vertical rule it runs the height of the group it anchors.

Split. The gap scales with the shape: 4% of a 100 px rule pair is 4 px; 4% of a 24 px band is about 1 px. Never close it and never widen it for effect.

Delta. Use it upright or inverted. Inverted, it reads as a funnel; upright, as a pyramid tier or tab.

Wake line. Always a hairline, always at 62°. In overlays and textures, space lines evenly and accent one in six.

Beacon. One per view. If a page already has a saffron bar or figure, there is no beacon square.

Frame. The registration-marks divider in chapter 05 is the light print variant: 12 px arms, 1 px Deep Current, set 4 px outside the corner of the exhibit or photograph.

### 2.10.3 How they combine

Primitives build every pattern, badge and divider in chapter 05.

| Combination | Result | How it is built |
|---|---|---|
| Blade + split | Confluence pattern | The two blades, split kept open, repeated in a half-drop. Teal and saffron meet in every unit |
| Chevron + wake line | Chevron wake | Chevrons on the 62° edge, drawn as hairlines with the split at each point |
| Stem + split | Pinstripe | Vertical stems in pairs, each pair held apart by the split |
| Delta, upright + inverted | Delta pattern | The A's trapezoid alternating up and down, interlocking like a river delta |
| Frame + identifier | Badges and seals | The identifier set inside corner marks or a split frame |
| Split + chevron | Section divider | A rule that opens into a chevron at its centre, with the 4% split at the point |

### 2.10.4 Building rules for combinations

1. Combine primitives at the same scale, or at whole steps of the 8-point scale.
2. Keep each primitive's angles. Combination never creates a new angle.
3. Keep the split at 4% of the height of the shapes that converge.
4. One beacon per combination. A pattern tile may carry one saffron unit; cluster badges carry none (the icon reverses to white).
5. Combinations stay square-cornered and flat-ended.

## 2.11 Grammar rules

A short grammar keeps the shapes speaking with one voice. If a shape breaks a rule here, it is not a Kayak shape.

### 2.11.1 Combining shapes

| No. | Rule |
|---|---|
| 01 | Use only angles from the set (53°, 55°, 58°, 62°, 73°), plus 0° and 90°. Never rotate a shape onto a new angle. |
| 02 | No curves, except the S current (from the monogram) and data lines in charts. |
| 03 | Cut every end flat. No round caps, bevels or tapered tips. |
| 04 | Keep the split at 4% of the shape's height wherever two forms converge. |
| 05 | Scale shapes whole. Never stretch, skew, outline or add shadows. |
| 06 | One beacon per composition. Everything else is ink, teal or tint. |

### 2.11.2 Do and don't

| Do | Don't |
|---|---|

| | |
|---|---|
| Flat cuts on every end | Rounded or softened ends |
| Split held at 4% | Blades touching or overlapping |
| Hairlines on 62° | Angles outside the set (45° is the common error) |
| One beacon per view | Saffron used to decorate |

### 2.11.3 Corner radius

Radius is a UI property only. Brand shapes stay square at every size.

| Radius | Token | Applies to |
|---|---|---|
| 0 | none | Brand graphics, print, patterns, photographs, charts |
| 2 px | xs | Checkboxes |
| 4 px | sm | Buttons, inputs, tooltips, tags |
| 8 px | md | Cards and menus |
| 12 px | lg | Modals, sheets, mobile cards |
| 999 px | pill | Pills (chips) and avatars |

Notes:

- Badges, seals, stamps and content-type labels are brand graphics: radius 0. UI chips and tags in product use 4 px (tags) or 999 px (chips).
- App icon tiles take the platform's own corner mask. The artwork inside stays square.

### 2.11.4 Stroke weight scale

| Weight | Print | Screen | Use |
|---|---|---|---|
| Hairline | 0.5 pt | 1 px | Table rules, gridlines, wake lines, print frames |
| Fine | 1 pt | 1.5 px | Corner marks, dividers, benchmark lines in print |
| Regular | 1.5 pt | 2 px | Icons on the 24 grid, chart lines, focus rings |
| Strong | 2 pt | 3 px | Highlighted series, active navigation bar |

Rules:

- Three weights per exhibit, at most.
- Hairlines are never thinner than 0.1 mm in print or 0.5 px on screen.
- All strokes end flat (butt caps) and join with mitres.
- Icons use the Regular weight: 2 px on a 24 × 24 px grid with a 2 px safe margin.

### 2.11.5 Grammar checklist

| Check | Pass condition |
|---|---|
| Angles | Every diagonal is 53°, 55°, 58°, 62° or 73° |
| Curves | None, except the S current and chart data lines |
| Ends | Every end cut flat |
| Splits | 4% of height wherever forms converge |
| Scaling | Whole; no stretch, skew, outline or shadow |
| Beacon | One per composition |
| Radius | 0 on brand shapes; UI scale only in product |
| Strokes | From the four-step scale; three per exhibit at most |

CHAPTER 03

# Layout rhythm and the 8-point system

Calm takes deliberate work. This chapter sets the spacing unit, the grids and the pacing that give every Kayak page room to think. One 8-point unit sets every margin, gap and line, with a 4-point half-step for icons and dense UI. Seven formats, from a 1920 × 1080 slide to an A4 report and a 1080 × 1350 social post, each get a column grid with real numbers. Five composition archetypes cover almost every page we make, and two pacing maps show how to order them so that a set of pages becomes an argument. When spacing comes from a scale, pages feel calm without anyone noticing why.

## 3.1 The 8-point system

### 3.1.1 Base unit

| Measure | Value | Use |
|---|---|---|
| Base unit | 8 px | Every margin, gap, padding and line height on screen |
| Half-step | 4 px | Icons and dense UI only |
| Print unit | The same scale in points | Print spacing, on a 4 pt sub-grid |
| Screen baseline | 24 px (3 × 8) | Body text lines |
| Print baseline (A4) | 12 pt (3 × 4 pt) | Body text lines in reports |

### 3.1.2 The spacing scale

Nine steps. Use only these values. Code tokens use the form `space.1` to `space.9`.

| Token | px | pt (print) | mm equivalent | Use |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| space-1 | 4 | 4 | 1.41 | Icon to label, tight pairs |
| space-2 | 8 | 8 | 2.82 | Inside components |
| space-3 | 12 | 12 | 4.23 | Related items in a list |
| space-4 | 16 | 16 | 5.64 | Component padding, gutters |
| space-5 | 24 | 24 | 8.47 | Card padding, web gutters |
| space-6 | 32 | 32 | 11.29 | Between groups |
| space-7 | 48 | 48 | 16.93 | Between sections |
| space-8 | 64 | 64 | 22.58 | Section breaks on web |
| space-9 | 96 | 96 | 33.87 | Hero and opener space |

The mm column converts the point values (1 pt = 0.3528 mm). Where a format gives its own millimetre values (section 3.3), use those.

### 3.1.3 Rules

1. Every gap comes from the scale. No ad hoc values.
2. Bigger gaps between groups than within them.
3. The gap between sections is at least twice the gap within a section.
4. Larger formats scale the unit, never the ratios.
5. Space is the cheapest premium signal we have. When a page is crowded, cut content before cutting space.

# 3.2 Vertical rhythm

## 3.2.1 Baseline and sub-grid

Text sits on a 24 px baseline. Images, rules and headings snap to the 8 px sub-grid, so columns always line up. The shorthand is 24 / 8.

| Element | Snaps to | Screen | Print (A4) |
|---|---|---|---|
| Body text | Baseline | 24 px | 12 pt |
| Headings | Sub-grid | 8 px | 4 pt |
| Images and exhibits | Sub-grid | 8 px | 4 pt |
| Rules and dividers | Sub-grid | 8 px | 4 pt |
| Icons and dense UI | Half-step | 4 px | 4 pt |

In print, 12 pt is 4.23 mm. The A4 live area is 255 mm tall (297 − 20 top − 22 foot), which holds 60 lines of 12 pt baseline.

## 3.2.2 Worked example: a content card

The card "Vendor risk: five questions" shows the scale at work. Every gap is a scale step.

| Position | Element | Style | Space |
|---|---|---|---|
| Top padding | | | 24 (space-5) |
| 1 | Eyebrow "CRISIS & RESILIENCE" | Archivo 600, 10/12 px, tracking 0.2 em, Storm Slate | |
| Gap | | | 8 (space-2) |
| 2 | Title "Vendor risk: five questions" | Archivo 700, 18/22 px, Deep Current | |
| Gap | | | 12 (space-3) |
| 3 | Body "A short checklist for testing vendor exposure before the next audit cycle." | Archivo 400, 12/18 px, Storm Slate | |
| Gap | | | 16 (space-4) |
| 4 | Hairline | 1 px Fog | |
| Gap | | | 16 (space-4) |
| 5 | Metric "5 questions to ask" | Figure Archivo 700, 28/32 px, expanded; label Archivo 600, 12 px; Open Water | |
| Bottom padding | | | 24 (space-5) |
| Side padding | | | 24 (space-5) |

Notice the order: the tightest gap (8) binds the eyebrow to its title; wider gaps (12, 16) separate related parts; the padding (24) separates the card from everything else.

## 3.2.3 Proportion

- Clear space around the logo is 2X on every side, where X is the width of the K upright (28 units). The same 2X sets the minimum gap between the logo and any edge, rule or image (chapter 02).
- Space between groups is larger than space within them.
- Ad hoc gaps and crowded edges make a page feel anxious. Spacing from the scale makes it feel calm.

# 3.3 The scale across formats

Screen values in px; print in millimetres. Larger formats scale the unit, never the ratios.

| Role | Rule | Web 1440 | Mobile 390 | Slide 1920 | Print A4 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Page margin | Set by the grid | 64 | 20 | 128 | 15 mm |

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Gutter | Multiple of 8 | 24 | 16 | 40 | 4 mm |
| Card padding | space-5 on web | 24 | 16 | 48 | 6 mm |
| Between sections | 2× the gap within | 64 | 48 | 96 | 12 mm |

Reading the table:

- On a slide, the margin (128) and card padding (48) are twice the web values (64 and 24). The section gap (96) is 1.5 times the web value (64), and the gutter is 40.
- On mobile, the gutter and card padding drop to 16 and the margin to 20. Hierarchy holds because the section gap (48) stays three times the card padding.
- In print, the A4 values are fixed in millimetres for production. They sit on the same rhythm: the 4 mm gutter is about 11 pt, the 6 mm card padding about 17 pt, the 12 mm section gap about 34 pt.

# 3.4 Grids by format

One logic, seven canvases. Every format has a column grid with real numbers. Content snaps to columns, and only images bleed.

## 3.4.1 Grid specifications

| Format | Size | Margins | Columns | Gutter | Grid unit |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Slide 16:9 | 1920 × 1080 px | 128 sides · 96 top · 64 foot | 12 | 40 | 8 px |
| Web | 1440 px, content 1312 | 64 | 12 | 24 | 8 px |
| Web, smaller | 1024 · 768 px | 32 | 12 · 8 | 24 · 16 | 8 px |
| A4 report | 210 × 297 mm | 15 sides · 20 top · 22 foot | 12 | 4 mm | 12 pt baseline |
| Mobile | 390 × 844 px | 20 | 4 | 16 | 8 px |
| Social square | 1080 × 1080 px | 80 | 6 | 32 | 8 px |
| Social portrait | 1080 × 1350 px | 80 | 6 | 32 | 8 px |

## 3.4.2 Derived measurements

Column width = (live width − (columns − 1) × gutter) ÷ columns.

| Format | Live area (w × h) | Calculation | Column width |
|---|---|---|---|
| Slide 16:9 | 1664 × 920 px | (1664 − 11 × 40) ÷ 12 | 102 px |
| Web 1440 | 1312 px wide | (1312 − 11 × 24) ÷ 12 | 87.33 px |
| Web 1024 | 960 px wide | (960 − 11 × 24) ÷ 12 | 58 px |
| Web 768 | 704 px wide | (704 − 7 × 16) ÷ 8 | 74 px |
| A4 report | 180 × 255 mm | (180 − 11 × 4) ÷ 12 | 11.33 mm |
| Mobile 390 | 350 px wide | (350 − 3 × 16) ÷ 4 | 75.5 px |
| Social square | 920 × 920 px | (920 − 5 × 32) ÷ 6 | 126.67 px |
| Social portrait | 920 × 1190 px | (920 − 5 × 32) ÷ 6 | 126.67 px |

Live areas: slide 1920 − 2 × 128 = 1664 wide, 1080 − 96 − 64 = 920 tall. (Version 1.0 of the grids page printed an 80 px foot; the presentation system sets 64 px, and 64 px is the standard.) A4 210 − 2 × 15 = 180 wide, 297 − 20 − 22 = 255 tall. Social 1080 − 2 × 80 = 920 wide; 1080 − 160 = 920 and 1350 − 160 = 1190 tall.

## 3.4.3 Breakpoints for web and product

| Breakpoint | Columns | Gutter | Margin | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1440 desktop | 12 | 24 | 64 | Content caps at 1312 px |
| 1024 laptop | 12 | 24 | 32 | |
| 768 tablet | 8 | 16 | 32 | |
| 390 mobile | 4 | 16 | 20 | |

### 3.4.4 Common spans

Span width = (columns × column width) + ((columns − 1) × gutter).

| Span | Slide (px) | Web 1440 (px) | A4 (mm) |
|---|---|---|---|
| 3 columns (sidebar) | 386 | 310 | 42.0 |
| 4 columns | 528 | 421.33 | 57.33 |
| 5 columns | 670 | 532.67 | 72.67 |
| 6 columns (half) | 812 | 644 | 88.0 |
| 7 columns | 954 | 755.33 | 103.33 |
| 8 columns | 1096 | 866.67 | 118.67 |
| 9 columns | 1238 | 978 | 134.0 |
| 12 columns (full) | 1664 | 1312 | 180.0 |

Check: on a slide, 5 + 7 columns = 670 + 40 + 954 = 1664 px, the full live width. On A4, 72.67 + 4 + 103.33 = 180 mm.

### 3.4.5 Grid rules

1. Text and exhibits snap to columns. Images may bleed to the trim; text never does.
2. An exhibit on a slide spans at least 6 of 12 columns (812 px). A sidebar spans 3 (386 px).
3. Gutters never shrink to fit more content. Cut the content instead.
4. Margins hold on every page. Only images and full-bleed colour fields cross them.
5. On A4, body text runs on the 12 pt baseline; everything else sits on the 4 pt sub-grid.
6. On social formats, keep text inside the 80 px margin so platform crops never touch it.

## 3.5 Compositions

Five archetypes cover almost every page we make. The order we put them in is what turns a set of pages into an argument.

### 3.5.1 The five archetypes

| Archetype | Structure | For |
|---|---|---|
| Open Water | Generous space and one statement. The page breathes so the idea can land. | Covers, chapter claims, closing thoughts |
| Confluence | A 50/50 split: dark claim on one side, evidence on the other. | Before and after, problem and answer |
| Current | Text left on 5 columns, exhibit right on 7. Our working page. | Analysis, findings, most content |
| Beacon | One big number in Archivo Expanded, with context in a narrow column. | Headline metrics, impact, savings |
| Delta | Three equal modules on a 4-column rhythm. One may carry the beacon. | Options, pillars, service lines |

### 3.5.2 Archetype specifications

| Archetype | Columns (of 12) | Slide widths (px) | A4 widths (mm) | Ground | Beacon |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Open Water | One statement; the rest is space | Statement left aligned on the grid | Statement left aligned on the grid | White, or Deep Current on covers and closes | None needed; the statement is the focus |
| Confluence | 6 + 6 | 812 + 812 | 88 + 88 | Left half Deep Current, right half Sea Mist or White | The highlight bar or figure in the evidence half |
| Current | 5 + 7 | 670 + 954 | 72.67 + 103.33 | White, exhibit on a Sea Mist panel | The highlight in the exhibit |
| Beacon | Figure on the main span; context on the 3-column sidebar span | Context 386 | Context 42 | White | The figure or its marker |
| Delta | 4 + 4 + 4 | 528 × 3 | 57.33 × 3 | White, modules on Sea Mist | One module at most |

### 3.5.3 Using the archetypes

- Current is the default. If you are unsure, use Current.
- Use Confluence when the page has two halves of one idea. The dark side makes the claim; the light side proves it.
- Use Beacon for one number that the reader must remember. The figure is set in Archivo Expanded 700 with the unit at 40% of its size.
- Use Delta for three parallel things. The 4-column rhythm divides the 12 columns into exactly three modules. For two things, use Confluence.
- Use Open Water sparingly: covers, chapter claims and closing thoughts.

## 3.6 Pacing

### 3.6.1 Pacing rules

1. Open on dark, read on light, close on dark.
2. Three data pages in a row at most, then a beacon or a breather.
3. One opener per chapter. Chapters run three to five pages after the opener.
4. Change density every five to seven pages so attention resets.

### 3.6.2 Page types in a pacing map

| Type | What it is | Ground | Map key colour |
|---|---|---|---|
| Dark | Cover, chapter opener, close | Deep Current | Deep Current |
| Light content | Agenda, Current, Confluence, Delta pages | White or Sea Mist panels | Open Water |
| Data | A full exhibit page | White with a Sea Mist exhibit panel | Tidewater Blue |
| Beacon | A Beacon archetype page | White | Beacon Saffron |
| Breather | A quote or Open Water statement | Sea Mist | Shallows |

### 3.6.3 Pacing map: a 20-slide board deck

| Slide | Part | Archetype | Type |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Frame | Cover | Dark |
| 2 | Frame | Agenda | Light content |
| 3 | Frame | Current | Light content |
| 4 | Chapter 1 · Diagnosis | Opener | Dark |
| 5 | Chapter 1 · Diagnosis | Current | Light content |
| 6 | Chapter 1 · Diagnosis | Data | Data |
| 7 | Chapter 1 · Diagnosis | Data | Data |
| 8 | Chapter 1 · Diagnosis | Beacon | Beacon |
| 9 | Chapter 2 · Options | Opener | Dark |
| 10 | Chapter 2 · Options | Confluence | Light content |
| 11 | Chapter 2 · Options | Data | Data |
| 12 | Chapter 2 · Options | Delta | Light content |
| 13 | Chapter 2 · Options | Quote | Breather |
| 14 | Chapter 3 · Plan | Opener | Dark |
| 15 | Chapter 3 · Plan | Current | Light content |
| 16 | Chapter 3 · Plan | Data | Data |
| 17 | Chapter 3 · Plan | Beacon | Beacon |
| 18 | Chapter 3 · Plan | Delta | Light content |
| 19 | Close | Current | Light content |
| 20 | Close | Close | Dark |

How the deck meets the rules:

- It opens dark (1), reads on light and closes dark (20).
- The longest run of data slides is two (6 and 7), followed by a beacon (8).
- Each chapter has one opener (4, 9, 14) and four slides after it.

- Density changes within every five slides: data, beacon, breather and opener alternate.
- There are five dark slides in twenty: the cover, three openers and the close. Everything else is light.

### 3.6.4 Pacing map: a 16-page report

| Page | Part | Archetype | Type |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Front | Cover | Dark |
| 2 | Front | Quote | Breather |
| 3 | Front | Contents (agenda) | Light content |
| 4 | Part 1 · The market | Opener | Dark |
| 5 | Part 1 · The market | Current | Light content |
| 6 | Part 1 · The market | Data | Data |
| 7 | Part 1 · The market | Current | Light content |
| 8 | Part 1 · The market | Beacon | Beacon |
| 9 | Part 2 · The response | Opener | Dark |
| 10 | Part 2 · The response | Data | Data |
| 11 | Part 2 · The response | Delta | Light content |
| 12 | Part 2 · The response | Quote | Breather |
| 13 | Part 2 · The response | Current | Light content |
| 14 | Part 2 · The response | Data | Data |
| 15 | Back | List page (agenda layout) | Light content |
| 16 | Back | Close | Dark |

How the report meets the rules:

- It opens dark (1) and closes dark (16).
- No two data pages sit together.
- Part 1 runs four pages after its opener; Part 2 runs five.
- A breather appears at page 2 and page 12, and a beacon at page 8, so density changes every five to seven pages.

### 3.6.5 Scaling the pacing

The two maps are references. For other lengths, keep the ratios:

| Element | Board deck (20) | Report (16) | Rule to keep |
|---|---|---|---|
| Dark pages | 5 (cover, 3 openers, close) | 4 (cover, 2 openers, close) | Dark at the start, at each opener and at the end only |
| Data pages | 4 | 3 | Never more than three in a row |
| Beacon pages | 2 | 1 | For the figures the reader must remember; the maps use one per chapter at most |
| Breathers | 1 | 2 | After a run of data, or between parts |
| Pages per chapter after the opener | 4 | 4 and 5 | Three to five |

### 3.6.6 Pacing checklist

| Check | Pass condition |
|---|---|
| Ends | First and last pages are dark |
| Openers | One per chapter, on Deep Current |
| Data runs | Three in a row at most |
| Resets | A beacon, breather or opener at least every five to seven pages |
| Beacon pages | Each carries one figure only |
| Archetypes | Current is the default; Open Water is rare |

CHAPTER 04

# Visual approach: imagery, surfaces and depth

Real people, natural light and open water. This chapter covers how we choose, treat and layer images so they carry the argument quietly, and how we build depth on a page without special effects. It sets the imagery direction (four directions, six principles, seven subjects and the list of clichés to avoid), the rule for cropping into the blades, and six image treatments, each with what it is, when to use it and when never to. It then defines the four surfaces, how they layer on light and dark grounds, the UI elevation scale with its Deep Current tinted shadows, the only three gradients allowed, the three texture strengths and the paper and finishes for print. Depth is a quiet fact, never a special effect.

## 4.1 Imagery direction

Real work, natural light, open water. Our pictures feel observed and unstaged, and always leave room to think.

### 4.1.1 Four directions

| No. | Direction | What the picture shows | Why it fits KSA | Composition |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | High vantage | A river delta, a port, a city or a site seen from above | We show the whole system before the detail | Horizon high or absent; pattern of the ground does the work |
| 02 | Water as metaphor | A still lake at dawn, a river bend, a shoreline | Flow, clarity and passage: the water we navigate with clients | Calm surface, soft directional light, generous sky or water |
| 03 | Space for text | A small subject, such as a kayak, in a wide frame of open water | The page needs room for a headline | A third of the frame left open for type |
| 04 | Quiet confidence | A person at work by a window, reading, thinking, in conversation | We are calm under pressure; so are our clients | Candid, natural light, no eye contact with the camera needed |

The direction examples in the published guidelines are drawn as placeholders. Commission or license photography to this brief.

### 4.1.2 Principles

1. Real people at work in India: clients, teams, sites. Never models posing.
2. Natural light, soft and directional. No flash, no studio sweep.
3. Quiet confidence: calm faces, considered gestures, no thumbs-up.
4. Water and open country as metaphor for flow, clarity and passage.
5. High vantage points that show the whole system.
6. Leave a third of the frame open for type.

### 4.1.3 Subjects

| Subject | Brief | Typical use |
|---|---|---|
| Advisory at work | Small teams around documents, a whiteboard or a screen, shot candidly | Case studies, service pages, proposals |
| Sites and operations | Plants, warehouses, ports, construction and field work in India | Sector reports, operations and resilience work |
| Cities from above | Indian cities from a high vantage, where the place can be recognised | Market and sector openers |
| Rivers and deltas | River systems, confluences and deltas from the air | Covers, chapter openers, the Delta and Confluence themes |
| Coast and open water | Shorelines, open sea, still water with space | Covers, backgrounds behind type, closing pages |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Hands and documents | Hands turning pages, marking a chart, signing | Investigations, due diligence, compliance |
| Leaders, candid | Partners and clients in natural moments, never posed portraits | Thought leadership, events, profiles |

### 4.1.4 Balance across a document

Use one image of people for every two images of places, water or terrain. A 16-page report with six images, for example, carries two of people and four of places or water.

### 4.1.5 Space for text

- Leave a third of the frame open for type.
- The open third is calm and even: sky, water, a plain wall, an out-of-focus ground.
- Type on an image always sits on that open area. Where contrast is short, add a scrim (section 4.3, treatment 06).
- If a frame has no calm third, it is not a frame for type. Use it as a full image with the headline set beside it.

### 4.1.6 Avoid

| Avoid | Why |
|---|---|
| Handshakes, chess pieces, light bulbs and other clichés | They say "consulting" without saying anything about the client |
| Generic skylines that could be anywhere | Our work is in India; the place should be recognisable |
| Heavy filters, HDR, vignettes, lens flare | They fake drama; the brand is calm |
| Stock models, forced smiles, staged pointing at screens | They read as staged, and clients notice |
| Busy frames with no room for type | They fight the headline and fail the space-for-text rule |

### 4.1.7 Photography brief checklist

Give this list to any photographer or picture researcher.

| Check | Pass condition |
|---|---|
| People | Real clients, teams or sites in India; no models |
| Light | Natural, soft, directional; no flash or studio sweep |
| Mood | Calm and considered; no thumbs-up or forced smiles |
| Vantage | At least one high-vantage frame per set |
| Space | A third of the frame open for type |
| Finish | Light grade only; no filters, HDR, vignettes or flare |
| Balance | One people image for every two of places or water |
| Rights | Licensed for print, web and social for the life of the piece |

### 4.1.8 The logo on photographs

Place the logo over a calm, even part of the image: reversed on dark areas, full colour on light ones. If no calm area exists, set the logo on a solid Deep Current panel. The 2X clear space applies to the panel edge as it does to a page edge (chapter 02).

## 4.2 Crop with the blade

Covers and openers may crop an image into the two blades of the Confluence Y.

### 4.2.1 Geometry

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Mask shapes | The identifier's left and right blades, from the master paths |
| Scale | Blade height (59.3 units) spans the image frame height |
| Position | The split centred on the frame's vertical centre line, or on a column line |
| Edges | Outer edges at 53°, inner edges at 62°, flat cut at the top |
| Split | The identifier's 4 units, scaled with the blades. Never resize it separately |

| | |
|---|---|
| Ground | Sea Mist, White or Deep Current behind the mask |

### 4.2.2 Rules

1. Keep the 4% split open. The split is part of the shape. Never close it.
2. Keep faces clear of the cut. A blade edge never passes through a face.
3. One hero moment per document: cover, opener or social post.
4. Never more than one blade crop per spread.
5. Never mask with any other shape. Only a blade from the identifier, at its own angles.

## 4.3 Image treatment

One photograph, six treatments. Use the lightest one that does the job, and never stack more than two on a single image.

### 4.3.1 The six treatments

| No. | Treatment | What | When | Never |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | Original | Natural colour, lightly graded: lift shadows, cool highlights a touch. | Default for people, places and case studies. | Saturation boosts, HDR, heavy contrast. |
| 02 | Deep Current duotone | Deep Current shadows to Sea Mist highlights. | Covers, openers, and mixed sources that must match. | A saffron or third tone; duotone on small thumbnails. |
| 03 | Teal monotone | Deep Lagoon to Spray, one hue end to end. | Backgrounds behind data or interface; web heroes. | Under body text without a scrim. |
| 04 | Blade crop | The image masked into the two blades, split kept open. | One hero moment per document: cover, opener, social. | Crops through faces; more than one per spread. |
| 05 | Wake-line overlay | 62° white hairlines at 30% opacity, one in six at 60%. | Banners and openers; across up to half the frame. | Over faces or detail; lines thicker than 1 px. |
| 06 | Scrim for text | Deep Current, 0% to 80% across the text side. | Whenever type sits on an image. | Black scrims; more than 80%; centred text on busy areas. |

### 4.3.2 Treatment recipes

These are the reference recipes used to render the guideline examples. Production tools may differ. Match the result; the method may vary.

| Treatment | Recipe |
|---|---|
| 01 Original | Raise shadow detail slightly. Cool the highlights a touch. Leave saturation as shot. |
| 02 Deep Current duotone | Convert to luminance (weights 0.2126 R, 0.7152 G, 0.0722 B). Apply a gamma of 2.2 to deepen the mid-tones. Map black to Deep Current #0E2F3C and white to Sea Mist #EEF4F1. |
| 03 Teal monotone | Convert to luminance as above. Apply a gamma of 1.8. Map black to Deep Lagoon #0B5654 and white to Spray #CDE8E3. |
| 04 Blade crop | Clip the image with the two blade paths (section 4.2). Place Sea Mist, White or Deep Current behind. |
| 05 Wake-line overlay | Draw white lines at 62° (rise 15 : run 8), 1 px or thinner, evenly spaced. Set every line to 30% opacity and every sixth line to 60%. Clip the lines to one half of the frame or less. In the reference frame (400 × 240 px), lines sit 7 px apart at 0.8 px. |
| 06 Scrim for text | Linear gradient in Deep Current from 80% opacity at the text edge to 0% across the text side. In the reference frame the scrim reaches 0% at 62% of the width. |

### 4.3.3 Choosing a treatment

Work down the list and stop at the first treatment that does the job.

| Question | If yes |
|---|---|
| Does the image work as shot, with type beside it? | 01 Original |
| Does type sit on the image? | Add 06 Scrim |

| | |
|---|---|
| Must several images from mixed sources match? | 02 Duotone |
| Is the image a background behind data or interface? | 03 Teal monotone |
| Is this the one hero moment of the document? | 04 Blade crop |
| Does a banner or opener need movement in empty space? | 05 Wake-line overlay |

### 4.3.4 Stacking

Never stack more than two treatments on one image. These pairs work:

| Base | Second treatment | Use |
|---|---|---|
| 01 Original | 06 Scrim | Type over a natural-colour image |
| 02 Duotone | 06 Scrim | Cover headline over a matched image |
| 02 Duotone | 05 Wake-line overlay | Dark opener with texture in the empty half |
| 03 Teal monotone | 06 Scrim | Web hero with a headline |
| 04 Blade crop | 02 Duotone | Cover hero on Deep Current |

Never combine a wake-line overlay with a scrim on the same side of an image: the lines would sit under the type.

### 4.3.5 Image treatment checklist

| Check | Pass condition |
|---|---|
| Treatments | Two at most per image |
| Duotone | Deep Current to Sea Mist only; no saffron, no third tone; not on thumbnails |
| Monotone | Deep Lagoon to Spray; a scrim if any body text sits on it |
| Blade crop | One per document hero moment; split open; faces clear |
| Wake lines | 62°, 1 px or thinner, 30% and 60%; half the frame at most; no faces |
| Scrim | Deep Current, 80% at most; text left aligned on the calm side |

## 4.4 Surfaces

Four surfaces, built up by tone rather than shadow.

### 4.4.1 The surface palette

| Surface | HEX | RGB | CMYK | Use |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Paper White | #FFFFFF | 255 255 255 | 0 0 0 0 | Pages, cards, print stock |
| Sea Mist | #EEF4F1 | 238 244 241 | 2 0 1 4 | App canvas, panels, callouts |
| Deep Current | #0E2F3C | 14 47 60 | 77 22 0 76 | Covers, openers, dark UI |
| Undertow | #1F4B5F | 31 75 95 | 67 21 0 63 | Raised on dark: sidebars, bands |

### 4.4.2 Layering

Step one tone per level.

| Level | Light ground | Dark ground |
|---|---|---|
| 0 | Page: Sea Mist (app canvas) or White (print page) | Deep Current |
| 1 | Card: White, with a 1 px Fog hairline | Storm Slate #3E5563 (cards) or Undertow #1F4B5F (sidebars, bands) |
| 2 | Popover: White, radius 8, e2 shadow. UI only | n/a in brand graphics; in dark UI, popovers use the raised token (chapter 07) |

Rules:

1. Step one tone per level.
2. Never put white on white without a Fog hairline (#D4DEE2).
3. Never put two dark tones together without a step: Deep Current to Undertow or Storm Slate, never Deep Current next to a near match.
4. Level 2 exists in UI only. Print and brand graphics stop at level 1.

5. On dark grounds, depth comes from tone alone.

### 4.4.3 Tone steps measured

The steps are small by design. They read as layers.

| Pair | Contrast | Separation needed |
|---|---|---|
| Sea Mist page, White card | 1.11:1 | Fog hairline (White to Fog 1.37:1) |
| Deep Current page, Undertow band | 1.50:1 | None; the tone step is enough |
| Deep Current page, Storm Slate card | 1.80:1 | None; the tone step is enough |

# 4.5 Depth

### 4.5.1 Depth in print

No drop shadows in print or brand graphics. Separate with tone and a 0.5 pt hairline.

| Need | Print solution |
|---|---|
| A panel on a page | Sea Mist panel on White |
| A card on a panel | White card with a 0.5 pt Fog hairline |
| A dark band | Deep Current or Undertow, full width or bled |
| A frame around an exhibit | Registration marks: 12 px arms, 1 px Deep Current, 4 px outside the corner (chapter 05) |

### 4.5.2 UI elevation

Shadows are tinted with Deep Current, never black.

| Level | Spec | CSS | Use |
|---|---|---|---|
| e0 | None + 1 px Fog | `box-shadow: 0 0 0 1px #D4DEE2;` | Resting cards and tables |
| e1 | y 1 · blur 2 · 8% | `box-shadow: 0 1px 2px rgba(14, 47, 60, 0.08);` | Hover |
| e2 | y 6 · blur 16 · 10% | `box-shadow: 0 6px 16px rgba(14, 47, 60, 0.10);` | Menus, popovers, tooltips |
| e3 | y 16 · blur 40 · 18% | `box-shadow: 0 16px 40px rgba(14, 47, 60, 0.18);` | Modals and sheets |

Rules:

- The shadow colour is Deep Current, RGB 14 47 60, at the opacity shown. Never pure black.
- Offsets are vertical only (x = 0). Light comes from above.
- Shadows exist only in interactive product. They never appear on slides, documents, social posts or brand graphics.
- Chapter 07's token page lists e1 against cards. Resting cards sit at e0 and rise to e1 on hover.
- Elevation pairs with the radius scale: cards and menus at 8 px, modals and sheets at 12 px (chapter 02).

# 4.6 Gradients

Three gradients only. Nothing else in the system fades.

| Gradient | Spec | CSS | Use |
|---|---|---|---|
| Current depth | Deep Current #0E2F3C to Undertow #1F4B5F, linear at 160° | `linear-gradient(160deg, #0E2F3C, #1F4B5F)` | Dark covers and heroes |
| Water fade | Open Water at 12% opacity to 0%, top to bottom | `linear-gradient(180deg, rgba(23, 128, 126, 0.12), rgba(23, 128, 126, 0))` | Areas under chart lines |
| Scrim | Deep Current at 0% to 80% opacity, across the text side | `linear-gradient(90deg, rgba(14, 47, 60, 0.8), rgba(14, 47, 60, 0))` (text on the left) | Type on images |

Rules:

1. No other gradients: no rainbow fills, no saffron gradients, no radial glows.
2. No circles, blobs, fades or vignettes in patterns or backgrounds.
3. The water fade sits under a chart line only, never under bars.

4. The scrim never exceeds 80% and is never black.

# 4.7 Texture strength

Patterns from chapter 05 add texture. Pick the strength for the job first, then the colourway for the ground.

| Strength | Opacity | Where | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| Tonal | 6–16% | The default. Behind text and data, UI surfaces, charts | Base lines recede into the ground |
| Accent | 22%, with the one beacon unit at 90% | Margins, dividers, empty space | Base lines recede; the one saffron unit carries |
| Brand (Display) | 100% | Covers and openers only; also supergraphics, packaging, event walls | Full colour, full strength |

Rules:

1. Never put body text on a pattern above 10% strength.
2. One pattern per spread or screen. Never two patterns touching.
3. Never put a pattern on a photograph.
4. Crop patterns flat on the trim and bleed them off at least one edge.
5. Mask a pattern only with a blade from the identifier, at its own angle.
6. Hairlines in a pattern are never thinner than 0.1 mm in print or 0.5 px on screen.

# 4.8 Paper and finishes

## 4.8.1 Stock

| Item | Specification |
|---|---|
| Text pages | Uncoated stock, 120 gsm, FSC certified |
| Covers | Uncoated stock, 350 gsm, FSC certified |
| Letterhead and continuation | Uncoated wove, 120 gsm (chapter 09) |
| Business card | Cotton board, 700 gsm duplex (chapter 09) |

## 4.8.2 Finishes

| Finish | Where | Rule |
|---|---|---|
| Spot UV | The pattern on covers | Tone on tone: a tonal pattern on Deep Current, lifted by varnish only |
| Saffron foil | Seals only | The one saffron point on a printed cover or envelope |
| Blind deboss | Monogram on notebooks and leather | No ink |
| Saffron painted edge | Business card | The card's beacon (chapter 09) |

## 4.8.3 Reference cover

The "Sector Outlook FY26" cover shows the finishes together:

- Deep Current ground on 350 gsm uncoated board.
- The Chart contours pattern at tonal strength, printed as spot UV, tone on tone.
- The reversed wordmark at the top left.
- The title "Sector Outlook FY26" in Archivo Expanded 700, White.
- A saffron foil seal at the bottom right: the identifier inside a saffron keyline square. This is the cover's one beacon.

## 4.8.4 Print rules

- CMYK values are calculated starting points. Approve a wet proof on the chosen stock before every run.
- Uncoated stock darkens and softens colour. Check Deep Current and Open Water against the proof. The screen is not a reliable guide.

- No drop shadows, glows or gloss effects in print. Depth comes from tone, hairlines and finish.

## 4.9 Chapter checklist

| Check | Pass condition |
|---|---|
| Image choice | Real, natural light, India, calm; nothing from the avoid list |
| Balance | One people image for every two of places or water |
| Space | A calm third of the frame holds the type |
| Treatment | The lightest that works; two at most |
| Blade crop | One hero moment per document; split open; faces clear |
| Surfaces | One tone step per level; Fog hairline between white on white |
| Shadows | UI only, tinted Deep Current, e0 to e3 |
| Gradients | Current depth, water fade or scrim only |
| Texture | Tonal behind text; never body text on a pattern above 10% |
| Print | Uncoated FSC stock; spot UV tone on tone; saffron foil on seals only |

CHAPTER 05

# Graphic assets: patterns, badges, dividers, navigator's marks and illustration

This chapter covers the finishing tools of the KSA identity. Patterns, seals, rules, marks, illustrations and icons are all cut from the same geometry as the logo, so they give a page its finish without raising its voice. It sets out the eleven repeating patterns in three families, with their six colourways and three strengths; the badge, stamp and seal family; the ten dividers and rules; the twelve navigator's marks used to annotate charts and diagrams; the illustration style and its library; and the icon system of 48 service icons and 2,160 industry icons. Every asset here obeys three rules from the shape grammar in chapter 02: straight cuts on the logo's own angles (58°, 62°, 53°, 73°), the 4% split that keeps two forms apart, and one Beacon Saffron point per view.

## 5.1 How the graphic assets fit together

### 5.1.1 Built from the shape vocabulary

Every graphic asset is a sentence made from the eight primitives in chapter 02. The table shows which primitives build which asset.

| Primitives combined | What they build | Where it appears in this chapter |
|---|---|---|
| Blade + split | Confluence pattern | 5.3, pattern 01 |
| Chevron + wake line | Chevron wake | 5.4, pattern 06; divider 05 |
| Stem + split | Pinstripe | 5.4, pattern 08 |
| Delta, upright + inverted | Delta pattern | 5.3, pattern 03 |
| Frame + identifier | Badges and seals | 5.8 |
| Split + chevron | Section divider | 5.9 |

### 5.1.2 Geometry every asset uses

| Constant | Value | Source in the logo | Use in graphic assets |
|---|---|---|---|
| K-arm angle | 58° | 24 : 38.7, the K's arms | K-lattice pattern, illustration lattice, annotation leaders |
| K-leg angle | 55° | 33.9 : 48.5, the K's lower leg | Chevron dividers, waypoint arrows |
| Blade inner edge | 62° | 14 : 26.25 = 8 : 15 | Wake lines, badge and divider cuts, masks, leaders, wake underline |
| Blade outer edge | 53° | 44 : 59.3, repeated in the stem notch | Chevron wake geometry, badge cuts, blade crops |
| A slope | 73° | 31 : 100, both A diagonals | Delta pattern, trapezoid frames, cover bands |
| The split | 4 units (4% of cap height) | The gap between the blades | Paired rules, pinstripe, converging strokes that never touch |
| Stroke scale | 0.5 · 1.5 · 2 · 3 | Hairline to bar | Pattern hairlines, rules, icons (2 px), emphasis bars |

### 5.1.3 Restraint rules that apply to the whole chapter

- One pattern per spread, slide or screen.
- One label and one badge per card. One seal per document.
- A maximum of three navigator's marks per view, including the beacon.

- One illustration per page or card.
- One Beacon Saffron point per view, whether it sits in a pattern, a mark, an illustration or an icon.
- Use the lightest rule that does the job.
- Corners stay square. Ends are cut flat. Nothing is rotated, distressed, shadowed or blurred.

# 5.2 Pattern library

Eleven repeating patterns in three families, each cut from a real part of the identity. A pattern reads as Kayak even with no logo in sight.

## 5.2.1 The eleven patterns

| No. | Pattern | Family | Source mark | Construction | Tile (units) | Default width on screen | Print tile width | Screen tile width at 1× |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | Confluence | A Geometric | Identifier | Blade pair, half-drop | 120 × 84 | 50 px | 10–30 mm | 40–120 px |
| 02 | Paddle rhythm | A Geometric | Identifier | Blades, herringbone | 96 × 52 | 35 px | 8–24 mm | 32–96 px |
| 03 | Delta | A Geometric | Monogram | A trapezoid, interlock | 268 × 216 | 54 px | 12–40 mm | 48–160 px |
| 04 | Monogram canvas | A Geometric | Monogram | Monogram, half-drop | 720 × 440 | 86 px | 24–60 mm | 80–240 px |
| 05 | Wake lines | B Line | Favicon | Blade edge, 62° | 48 × 90 | 67 px | 10–24 mm | 48–120 px |
| 06 | Chevron wake | B Line | Favicon | The split, 62° | 32 × 8 | 48 px | 6–16 mm | 36–96 px |
| 07 | K-lattice | B Line | Wordmark | K arm, 58° | 40 × 64 | 30 px | 6–18 mm | 30–90 px |
| 08 | Pinstripe | B Line | Identifier | Stem + split | 96 × 8 | 96 px | 18–48 mm | 72–192 px |
| 09 | Current | C Atmospheric | Monogram | S stroke, flow | 160 × 48 | 144 px | 36–120 mm | 120–480 px |
| 10 | Soundings | C Atmospheric | Chart | Depth marks, hex | 48 × 41.57 | 41 px | 10–30 mm | 36–100 px |
| 11 | Chart contours | C Atmospheric | Chart | Bathymetry, tiling | 200 × 200 | 320 px | 60–200 mm | 240–960 px |

Screen sizes are at 1×. Double them for 2× and 4K files. Hairlines are never thinner than 0.1 mm in print or 0.5 px on screen.

## 5.2.2 The three families

| Family | Character | Patterns | Use for |
|---|---|---|---|
| A Geometric repeats | Solid shapes cut from the identifier and the monogram. Bold and ownable. | 01–04 | Brand moments: covers, banners, packaging, gifting |
| B Line patterns | Hairlines on the angles of the marks: the blade edge, the split and the stem of the Y, and the K arm. | 05–08 | Quiet texture: UI surfaces, margins, overlays |
| C Atmospheric | Soft fields of movement and depth from the monogram's S and the navigator's chart. | 09–11 | Large backdrops: reports, keynotes, dashboards |

Each family ships in six colourways. One pattern per spread or screen.

## 5.2.3 Choosing a pattern

1. Decide the job. A brand moment takes family A. A quiet surface behind UI or text takes family B. A large backdrop behind a title or dashboard takes family C.
2. Pick the strength for the job (display, accent or tonal, see 5.6).
3. Pick the colourway for the ground (dark or light).
4. Check the content rules: no logo on a family A repeat, no body text on a pattern above 10%, no pattern with a photograph.

# 5.3 Family A: geometric repeats

Solid shapes lifted from the marks. Each tile is built from one source shape, shown in colour in the master file; a dashed line marks the repeat.

## 5.3.1 The four geometric patterns

| Pattern | Tile and repeat | Shown in | Description | Best for |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 01 Confluence | 120 × 84, half-drop | Brand-dark | The identifier's two blades, repeated in a half-drop. Teal and saffron meet in every unit. | Social banners and profile headers; event backdrops and photo walls; deck section dividers (one per deck); motion, with blades gliding in on the paddle ease |
| 02 Paddle rhythm | 96 × 52, herringbone | Brand-light | Left and right blades stack in a herringbone, held apart by the identifier's split. A kinetic supergraphic for covers and banners. | Report and proposal covers; hoardings, banners and large-format print; small-scale print texture on stationery |
| 03 Delta | 268 × 216, interlock | Brand-dark | The A's trapezoid, upright and inverted, interlocks like a river delta. A structured texture for print and packaging. | Packaging, gift boxes and sleeves; envelope and folder linings; merchandise such as notebooks, totes and scarves |
| 04 Monogram canvas | 720 × 440, half-drop | Accent-dark | The KSA monogram and the identifier in a heritage half-drop. Reserved for premium moments. | Gifting, tissue and lining papers; event lanyards, passes and invitations |

## 5.3.2 Rules for geometric repeats

| No. | Rule | Detail |
|---|---|---|
| 01 | Scale, never distort | Resize tiles uniformly from the default. Never stretch, rotate or skew a repeat. |
| 02 | Keep the colour logic | Teal and saffron alternate as in the marks. No new colours inside a tile. |
| 03 | Crop on a clean edge | Where a repeat meets type or a panel, cut flat. Never fade or vignette it. |
| 04 | Logo on clear ground | Never place the logo on a geometric repeat. Give it a solid panel. |

# 5.4 Family B: line patterns from the favicon

Hairlines on the edges of the favicon (blade edge, split, stem) and the wordmark's K arm. These are the quietest textures in the system.

## 5.4.1 The four line patterns

| Pattern | Geometry | Construction | Saffron |
|---|---|---|---|
| 05 Wake lines | Blade edge, 8 : 15 (62°) | Every line runs on the blade angle. | One line in six is saffron. |
| 06 Chevron wake | The split, 4% | Paired strokes converge and never touch, like the Y's two blades. Two strokes, never touching. | None in tonal; one unit in accent |
| 07 K-lattice | K arm, 5 : 8 (58°) | Diagonals on the K's arm cross into a lattice. | Saffron nodes mark points of decision. |
| 08 Pinstripe | Stem + split | Line, gap, line: the stem's weight and the split's gap, tailored. 24-unit pitch. | None in tonal; one unit in accent |

Each line pattern is shown in the master file in tonal-light and accent-dark.

## 5.4.2 The subtle overlay

Line patterns are felt more than seen. They sit behind UI and text at 6–16% opacity.

| Opacity | Where | Example |
|---|---|---|
| 6% | Behind text | K-lattice behind a report standfirst |
| 8% | UI surface | Wake lines across a dashboard panel |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 10% | Text limit | The highest strength that may sit behind body copy |
| 16% | Panels and UI | Empty panels, margins, UI chrome with no body copy on it |

Rules:

- Above 10%, keep the pattern clear of body copy.
- Hairlines are 0.5–1 px on screen and never under 0.1 mm in print.
- Keep the angle. Never rotate a line pattern.

# 5.5 Family C: atmospheric patterns

Large, slow fields of movement and depth for covers, keynotes and dashboards. All three tile without a visible join, so they can be cropped anywhere.

| Pattern | Source | Description | In use | Rule |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 09 Current | Traced from the monogram's S | Flow lines for calm movement on large backgrounds and thought-leadership covers. | Report covers; thought-leadership and annual reports | Let the saffron line fall above or below the title, never through it. |
| 10 Soundings | Depth marks on a nautical chart | A field of soundings with one beacon in each field. Works behind data and dashboards. | Dashboard backgrounds | Behind data, use tonal only. Soundings keep a dark UI from feeling flat. |
| 11 Chart contours | Bathymetric chart, made to tile | Depth contours from a navigation chart, generated to repeat without a join. The signature backdrop for reports and keynotes. | Keynote title and section slides | Contours run edge to edge. Type sits on a calm area of the field. |

All three are shown in the master file in accent-dark.

# 5.6 Colourways and strength

Every pattern ships in six colourways at three strengths. Pick the strength for the job first, then the colourway for the ground.

## 5.6.1 The three strengths

| Strength | Opacity | Effect | Use for |
|---|---|---|---|
| Display | 100% | Full colour, both hues at full strength | Covers, supergraphics, packaging, event walls. Large type only. |
| Accent | 22% base + 90% beacon | Base lines recede; the one saffron unit carries. | Section openers, banners, social posts |
| Tonal | 6–16% | One colour, tone on tone | Backgrounds behind UI, charts and type |

The 10% limit: never place body text on a pattern stronger than 10%.

## 5.6.2 The six colourways

| Colourway | Strength | Ground | Base colour | Accent colour |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Brand-dark | Display | Deep Current #0E2F3C | Open Water #17807E (line patterns use teal on dark #3FB0A9) | Beacon Saffron #EE9B1E at 100% |
| Brand-light | Display | Sea Mist #EEF4F1 | Open Water #17807E | Beacon Saffron #EE9B1E at 100% |
| Accent-dark | Accent | Deep Current #0E2F3C | Shallows #5DB2AB at 22% | Beacon Saffron #EE9B1E, one unit |
| Accent-light | Accent | Paper white #FFFFFF | Open Water #17807E at 22% | Beacon Saffron #EE9B1E at 90%, one unit |
| Tonal-dark | Tonal | Deep Current #0E2F3C | Shallows #5DB2AB, tone on tone | None |
| Tonal-light | Tonal | Sea Mist #EEF4F1 | Open Water #17807E, tone on tone | None |

### 5.6.3 How the shipped files are tuned

The pattern files in KSA_Brand_Patterns are tuned per pattern, so a designer never needs to adjust opacity by hand.

- Line and atmospheric patterns ship in the tonal colourways at 16%. Solid (family A) patterns ship in tonal at 7% (light) and 9% (dark), because a filled shape reads stronger than a hairline.
- In the accent colourways, base shapes or lines sit at 10–22% and the one saffron unit at 85–90%.
- For a line pattern behind text, set the layer to about 60% (16% × 0.6 ≈ 10%) or choose a calmer pattern.
- Never lower the opacity of a brand-dark or brand-light file to fake a tonal one. Use the tonal file.
- Keep the colours as supplied. Do not recolour a pattern outside the six colourways.

### 5.6.4 Files supplied

Each pattern folder holds, for each colourway:

| File | Content | Use |
|---|---|---|
| KSA_Pattern_NN_Name_<colourway>_tile.svg | One repeat tile as vector | Pattern swatch in Illustrator, Figma, InDesign or CSS |
| KSA_Pattern_NN_Name_<colourway>_tile_1024.png | The same repeat as a 1024 px wide PNG | Tools that need a bitmap swatch |
| KSA_Pattern_NN_Name_<colourway>_1920x1080.svg | Full HD background at default scale, vector | Slides, web heroes |
| KSA_Pattern_NN_Name_<colourway>_1920x1080.png | Full HD background | Slides, video, web heroes |
| KSA_Pattern_NN_Name_<colourway>_3840x2160.png | 4K background at twice the default scale | 4K screens, so it looks the same as HD |

### 5.6.5 Scale, crop, mask and combine

| Topic | Rule |
|---|---|
| Scale | Use the tile widths in 5.2.1. Scale uniformly; never stretch, rotate or skew. |
| Crop | Crop flat on the trim and bleed off at least one edge. |
| Mask | Mask only with a blade from the identifier, at its own 62° angle. No circles, blobs, fades or vignettes. |
| Combine | One pattern, one panel. One pattern per spread or screen. |

Do not:

- let two patterns touch;
- place a pattern with a photograph;
- set body text on a pattern above 10%.

## 5.7 Patterns in use

One pattern per piece, held to its own panel or surface. Logos sit on clear ground or a quiet field, never on a geometric repeat.

| No. | Application | Pattern and colourway | Why it works |
|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | Report cover ("India Risk Outlook 2026, Board edition FY26") | Chart contours, accent-dark | Family C backdrop; title on a calm area of the field |
| 02 | Section divider ("Section 02, Project [Name]: Market entry, choosing the route") | Paddle rhythm, brand-dark | Display strength for a brand moment, one per deck |
| 03 | Website hero ("Clarity for the decisions that move a company") | Current, accent-dark | Calm movement behind a large headline and one CTA |
| 04 | Business cards | Monogram canvas, accent-dark | A premium moment; contact details kept off the repeat |
| 05 | LinkedIn banner | Confluence, brand-dark, blade-cut | Masked with a blade at its own 62° angle |
| 06 | Folder and notebook ("Client folder") | Pinstripe, tonal-light and accent-dark | Quiet line texture for stationery |
| 07 | App splash ("Kayak Client Room") | Wake lines, accent-dark | Logo on a quiet field |
| 08 | Gift box | Delta, brand-dark | Packaging texture; logo on a solid panel |

On the website each content type keeps one pattern for its thumbnail. See chapter 07.

| Content type | Thumbnail pattern |
|---|---|
| Report | Chart contours |
| Article | Wake lines |
| Podcast | Soundings |
| Case study | K-lattice |

# 5.8 Badges and seals

One family, cut from the identifier's grammar: square corners, flat ends on the 62° blade angle and the split between two strokes. Badges label and sort; seals sign off.

## 5.8.1 A. Content-type labels

Placed top left of covers, cards and tiles. The default label is a 22 px Deep Current block with white Archivo 600 capitals at 10 px, tracked 0.16em, led by a small Open Water blade. The left end is square; the right end is cut on the 62° blade angle.

| Label | Use |
|---|---|
| INSIGHT | Short articles and points of analysis |
| POINT OF VIEW | Opinion pieces with a firm position |
| CASE STUDY | Client work, anonymised as agreed |
| DATA BRIEF | Data-led notes and exhibits |
| WEBINAR | Recorded or live sessions |

Treatments:

| Treatment | Construction | Use on |
|---|---|---|
| Solid (default) | Deep Current fill, white text, Open Water blade | White and Sea Mist grounds |
| Keyline | White fill inside a 1 px Deep Current keyline, Deep Current text, Open Water blade | White grounds where a solid block would be too heavy |
| Tint | Spray #CDE8E3 fill, Deep Current text, Deep Lagoon blade | Light grounds, quieter cards |
| Reversed | White fill, Deep Current text, Open Water blade | Deep Current grounds |

## 5.8.2 B. Cluster badges

One badge colour per service cluster, fixed in every report. The cluster icon is reversed to white. There is no saffron inside a cluster badge.

| Cluster | Badge colour | Hex |
|---|---|---|
| Strategy & Deals (Strategy, Deal & Transactions) | Open Water | #17807E |
| Tax & Regulatory | Burnished Gold | #9C630E |
| Crisis & Resilience | Storm Slate | #3E5563 |
| Technology & AI | Tidewater Blue | #2D6A9F |
| Managed Services | Kelp Green | #4B7A4E |
| International Desk | Dusk Plum | #5E4B78 |

Cluster colours mark the six service clusters only. Do not use them to decorate other content.

## 5.8.3 C. Status stamps

Status stamps mark the state of a document. Place them top right of the page, outside the content grid. Stamps sit square: never rotated, never distressed.

| Stamp | Second line (example) | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| DRAFT | V0.3 · INTERNAL | Work in progress; not for the client |
| CONFIDENTIAL | CLIENT ONLY | Restricted circulation |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| CLIENT READY | QA · 14 OCT 2026 | Passed quality review; date of QA |
| FINAL | PARTNER SIGNED | Approved for release by the engagement partner |

### 5.8.4 D. Numbered markers

| Marker | Form | Example |
|---|---|---|
| Chapter, reversed | Large numeral in a solid block, white on Deep Current | 03 |
| Section, on light | Numeral on a light ground, Deep Current | 03 |
| Progress steps | A row of numbered steps | 01 02 03 04 |
| Exhibit number | Label plus number | EXHIBIT 3.2 |
| Source note | Small numerals keyed to notes | 1 2 3 |
| Annotation key | Letters keyed to annotations | A B |

Marker sizes are 40, 32 and 24 px.

### 5.8.5 E. Seals

Seals sign off a document. Use one seal per document. Saffron foil is reserved for seals in print (see chapter 04).

| Seal | Shape | Content |
|---|---|---|
| Edition seal | Octagon | INSIGHT SERIES · Nº 07 · FY26 |
| Advisor seal | Split frame | KAYAK · TRUSTED ADVISOR · EST. 2026 · INDIA |

### 5.8.6 F. UI chips and tags

Tags use radius 4. Chips use radius 999. These are the only rounded members of the badge family, because they live in software.

| Kind | Examples |
|---|---|
| Filter | Sector: BFSI · FY25 · Maharashtra |
| Status | On track · At risk · Overdue · In review |
| Topic | SEBI · RBI circular · Due diligence |
| Delta | +12.4% · –3.1% · NEW |

### 5.8.7 G. Sizes

| Element | Sizes |
|---|---|
| Label height | 28 px, 22 px, 18 px |
| Numbered markers | 40 px, 32 px, 24 px |

### 5.8.8 H. Rules

| Rule | Detail |
|---|---|
| Minimum | Label 18 px (6 mm). Badge tile 24 px. Seal 96 px (25 mm). |
| Colour | Deep Current, Open Water or white grounds. Cluster colours mark the six service clusters only. |
| One per view | One label and one badge per card. One seal per document. |
| Never | Round, rotate, shadow or outline a badge or seal (the keyline label is the one drawn outline). No title case in labels. |

## 5.9 Dividers and rules

Rules do the quiet work of structure. Ten elements, all drawn from the split and the blade, set the rhythm of every page. Use the lightest one that does the job.

### 5.9.1 The ten dividers and rules

| No. | Element | Purpose | Weight and spacing |
|---|---|---|---|

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | Hairline | Separates rows, groups and table bodies. | 1 px Fog #D4DEE2 · full column · 12 or 16 px above and below |
| 02 | Split rule | Sits under headlines and hero figures. | 2 px Deep Current + Open Water (Open Water takes ⅓ of the length) · gap 4% of length |
| 03 | Blade rule | Opens a chapter, cover or report section. | Blades 26 × 6 and 13 × 6 cut at 62° · 2 px split · Fog hairline to the edge |
| 04 | Confluence divider | Closes a section; marks a turn in the argument. | 1.5 px · arms fall at 62° · 4% split at the centre · 24 px clear |
| 05 | Chevron-wake band | Section openers, cover bands, web footers. | 16–24 px band · 1 px split V every 24 px · Open Water on Sea Mist |
| 06 | Section tab | Carries the section number into the running head. | 24 px tab · number in Archivo Expanded 800 · 1 px Deep Current rule |
| 07 | Pull-quote marks | Open and close pull quotes. Never typed quotes. | Blade pairs at cap height · Open Water opens, saffron closes |
| 08 | Footnote rule | Separates notes and sources from the body. | 48 × 1 px Riverstone · 6 px to notes · notes 9 px Storm Slate |
| 09 | List markers | Bullets in body copy, slides and cards. | Saffron dash 10 × 2 · blade bullet 7 × 9 Open Water · 01 ordinal · 8 px to text |
| 10 | Registration marks | Frame exhibits, pull-outs and photographs. | 12 px arms · 1 px Deep Current · 4 px outside the corner |

### 5.9.2 List markers

| Marker | Specification | Use |
|---|---|---|
| Saffron dash | 10 × 2 px, Beacon Saffron | Short lists in body copy |
| Blade bullet | 7 × 9 px blade, Open Water | Lists in cards and slides |
| Ordinal | 01, 02, 03 in Archivo | Sequences and ranked points |

All markers sit 8 px from the text. Use one marker type per list.

### 5.9.3 How the rules work on a page

On a report page, the dividers work as a set:

- The section tab (06) carries the section number "04 MARKET CONTEXT" into the running head with a 1 px Deep Current rule.
- The split rule (02) sits under the headline ("Private credit is filling the gap banks left behind").
- Hairlines (01) separate the body from the facts panel.
- Blade bullets (09) set the key points ("Yields 300–450 bp above bank credit"; "Covenants looser; recovery data thin").
- Registration marks (10) frame the exhibit area ("EXHIBIT 2.3").
- A confluence divider (04) marks the turn in the argument ("The question is no longer access to capital but its price").
- Pull-quote marks (07) open and close the quote.
- The footnote rule (08) separates source notes ("1 SEBI AIF data, Q4 FY25; KSA analysis").

On a slide, the same set applies at slide scale: section tab "03 RISK OUTLOOK", a headline ("Three risks will shape lending in FY27"), ordinals 01–03 for the three risks, registration marks around the exhibit area and a footnote rule above the source.

## 5.10 Navigator's marks

The marks a navigator makes on a chart, redrawn with a ruler. They annotate, point and group. They are precise, never scribbled, and fewer than you think.

### 5.10.1 The twelve marks

| No. | Mark | Purpose | Specification |
|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | Waypoint | Milestone, event or decision. | 2 px stroke · 14 × 20 · saffron = arrival (labels such as "WP 03", "ARRIVE") |
| 02 | Heading arrow | Direction of travel or trend. | 2 px · split head on 8 : 15 (label such as "HDG 045°") |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| 03 | Route line | Path, plan or forecast. | 1.5 px · dash 4 4 · diamond end |
| 04 | Soundings | Quiet context figures. | 9.5 px Archivo 500 · Open Water |
| 05 | Beacon | The first thing to see. Once. | Saffron only · rays 2 and 1.5 px |
| 06 | Lasso | Rings a figure. Straight sides. | 1.5 px · 7–9 sides · tail overshoots |
| 07 | Wake underline | Emphasis under a word. | Three strokes 2.5 / 1.5 / 1 px · ends cut at 62° |
| 08 | Margin bracket | Groups related lines. | 2 px · arms at 62° · 6 px gap |
| 09 | Callout leader | Ties a label to one point. | 1 px · rises at 62° · dot r 3.5 |
| 10 | Compass rose | Orientation on openers and maps. | Blade pairs · 1.2 px split |
| 11 | Horizon | Baseline for hero diagrams. | 1.5 px land · 1 px water |
| 12 | Ticks and strikes | Approve or correct in review. | 2 px tick · 1.5 px strike |

### 5.10.2 Rules

| Rule | Detail |
|---|---|
| Count | A maximum of three marks per view, including the beacon. |
| Weight | Strokes 1.5–2 px; 1 px for leaders and soundings only. |
| Colour | Deep Current and Open Water. Saffron for one mark, once. |
| Labels | Every mark carries a label. A mark never replaces data. |
| Drawing | Flat ends, mitred joins, straight segments. No freehand. |

### 5.10.3 Worked example: Exhibit 4.1, three marks, one saffron

Headline: "Unsecured retail credit growth halved after the RBI raised risk weights". Subtitle: "Year-on-year growth in unsecured personal loans, %, by quarter", Q1 FY23 to Q1 FY26. Source: "RBI sectoral deployment data, FY23–FY26; KSA analysis."

| Version | What it shows | Verdict |
|---|---|---|
| Wrong | Seven marks, five colours and a freehand ring. The data disappears. | Rejected |
| Right | Three marks, each with a label: a callout leader for "Peak 29.4%", a waypoint for "RBI raises risk weights, Nov 2023", and a saffron lasso on the latest value, 10.6%. One saffron. | Approved |

## 5.11 Illustration style

KSA illustrations are drawn, not decorated: a ruled line, a few flat planes cut from the identifier and one point of saffron. Each one explains an idea in one look.

### 5.11.1 Six principles

| Principle | Rule |
|---|---|
| Line | Deep Current #0E2F3C. 2 px on the 24 px grid, 3 px at hero scale. Flat ends, mitred joins. |
| Planes | Flat, blade-shaped fills in Open Water #17807E and Spray #CDE8E3. Planes carry no outline of their own. |
| Geometry | Slopes on 58° and 62° only. A horizon line anchors every scene. |
| Beacon | One saffron point per illustration: sun, beacon or destination. |
| Fade | No gradients, except the 12% to 0 Open Water fade on water. |
| People | No faces, hands or characters. People are silhouettes at a distance. |

Reference hero: "Confluence". Two courses meet under one beacon. Line 3 px; planes Open Water and Spray; 640 × 300 px.

### 5.11.2 Construction in four steps

| Step | Action |
|---|---|
| 01 Sketch on the lattice | Block shapes on the 58° K-lattice. |
| 02 Line | Rule the ridge and horizon in Deep Current. |
| 03 Planes | Add Spray water and Open Water facets. |
| 04 Beacon | Place the one saffron point last. |

### 5.11.3 Do and don't

| Do | Don't |
|---|---|
| Ruled line, flat planes, one beacon | Gradient skies, glows or soft curves |
| Silhouettes at a distance | Faces or characters |
| Horizon line in every scene | Floating objects with no ground |

## 5.12 Illustration library

One spot illustration per service line, for covers, openers and cards. New illustrations follow the same recipe: ruled line, flat planes, one beacon.

### 5.12.1 The six service illustrations

| No. | Service line | Subject | Use on |
|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | Strategy | Compass and charted route | Strategy reports, plans, transformation roadmaps |
| 02 | Risk | Storm, waves and the lighthouse beam | Risk outlooks, crisis response, regulatory alerts |
| 03 | Transactions | Two streams join, two kayaks meet | M&A, joint ventures, deal and integration work |
| 04 | Investigations | The lens reveals a hidden mark | Forensics, due diligence, background checks |
| 05 | Growth & ESG | Rising tide steps and kelp | Growth strategy, sustainability, BRSR reporting |
| 06 | Technology & Data | Network nodes over a current | Digital, analytics, data and cyber engagements |

### 5.12.2 One illustration, three sizes

| Size | Width | Line | Content |
|---|---|---|---|
| Hero | Minimum 480 px | 3 px | Full scene |
| Spot | 160–320 px | 2 px | One subject |
| Inline | 24–48 px | Icon stroke (2 px on the 24 px grid) | Simplified to the 24 px icon grid |

Rules:

- Line weight stays fixed as art scales. Never scale strokes.
- Below 160 px, switch to the inline glyph.
- One illustration per page or card.

## 5.13 Icon system

Icons share the illustration's line and the logo's cuts. There are two libraries: 48 service icons and 2,160 industry icons, all drawn on one 24 px grid.

### 5.13.1 The two libraries

| Library | Count | Structure | Files |
|---|---|---|---|
| Service icons | 48 | The core KSA library for services, sectors and concepts. Each icon is supplied in six versions as SVG and transparent PNG. | KSA_Monogram_and_Icons; file names follow ksa-icon-name |
| Industry icons | 2,160 | 45 IBEF industries × 48 icons. Each industry set has four groups: Value chain, Services, Advisory, Digital. | KSA_Industry_Icons |

The four industry groups:

| Group | What it covers |
|---|---|
| Value chain | The physical and commercial steps of the industry, from inputs to customer |
| Services | The services firms in the industry buy and sell |
| Advisory | KSA's advisory themes as they apply to that industry |
| Digital | Technology, data and digital channels in that industry |

### 5.13.2 Drawing rules

| Rule | Specification |
|---|---|
| Grid | 24 × 24 px with a 2 px safe margin, so every icon carries the same visual weight |
| Stroke | 2 px, flat-cut ends, sharp corners, echoing the cut geometry of the logo |
| Accent | One Beacon Saffron accent per icon, marking the point of the idea: the finding, the signal, the decision. Never more than one. |
| Geometry | Circles, squares and straight lines. No gradients, shadows, 3D or decorative detail. |

### 5.13.3 Three styles

| Style | Colour | Use |
|---|---|---|
| Line | Deep Current, white or black | Interfaces, tables, small sizes |
| Duotone | Deep Current line with one saffron accent | Reports, slides and the website. The default. |
| Badge | Icon reversed to white on a coloured tile | Service cards, feature lists and social posts. Cluster badges carry no saffron. |

### 5.13.4 Sizes

| Context | Sizes |
|---|---|
| Brand use (print, slides, social) | 16 px minimum, then 24, 32 and 48 px. Scale icons whole, in steps of 8 px. |
| Product UI (see chapter 07) | 16 inline · 20 control · 24 default · 32 feature |
| Website services row | Six cluster icons at 28 px over a hairline |

Never mix KSA icons with other icon libraries. In UI, the hit area grows and the icon does not: a 24 px icon sits in a 44 × 44 px target on iOS and 48 × 48 px on web and Android.

## 5.14 Graphic assets checklist

Before a piece leaves the studio, check:

- One pattern per spread, slide or screen, at the right strength for the job.
- No body text on a pattern above 10%; no pattern with a photograph; no logo on a family A repeat.
- Patterns scaled within their tile range, cropped flat, masked only by a 62° blade.
- One label and one badge per card; one seal per document; stamps top right, square.
- The lightest rule that does the job; quotes opened and closed with blade marks, not typed quotes.
- No more than three navigator's marks per view, each labelled, one saffron.
- One illustration per page or card, with a fixed line weight and one beacon.
- Icons from the KSA libraries only, on the 24 px grid, with one saffron accent at most.
- One Beacon Saffron point across the whole view.

CHAPTER 06

# Data visualisation and consulting exhibits

Evidence is the KSA product. This chapter sets out how we draw it: honestly, labelled plainly and lit by a single beacon so the insight lands first. It starts with six principles and the eleven parts every exhibit carries, then the colour roles and ramps for data. It gives the full chart library (line and area, bars and columns, part to whole) and the consulting exhibits used in strategy, deals, risk and investigations work: the waterfall bridge, Marimekko, 2×2 bubble matrix, slopegraph, 5×5 risk heat map, Harvey balls, dumbbell, roadmap Gantt and maturity ladder. It closes with tables, RAG scorecards, number formatting, the eight metric cards, interaction and states on screen, and how one finding changes across four media. The colour values here are the data tokens in chapter 07 and in the KSA_Design_Tokens package.

## 6.1 Six principles

Our charts are evidence in an argument. Six principles keep them honest.

| No. | Principle | Rule |
|---|---|---|
| 01 | Insight-first titles | State the finding as a sentence. "Margin by year" is a label, not an insight. |
| 02 | One beacon | One saffron mark per exhibit: the thing the headline is about. The rest is Open Water or Riverstone. |
| 03 | Calm grid | Fog gridlines, four or five ticks, no borders. The data is the darkest ink in the frame. |
| 04 | Honest scales | Bars start at zero, one axis per chart, equal spacing for equal time. |
| 05 | Label directly | Name lines at their ends and values at bar ends. Use legends only when labels cannot fit. |
| 06 | Always cite the source | Every exhibit has a source line. Add "KSA analysis" when we have transformed the data. |

Four things are never used: pie charts, 3D, dual axes and smoothed lines.

## 6.2 Exhibit anatomy

Every exhibit, on a slide, a page or a screen, has the same eleven parts.

### 6.2.1 The eleven parts

| No. | Part | Specification |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Exhibit number | "EXHIBIT 3" in Open Water, numbered in reading order. |
| 2 | Insight headline | A full sentence stating the finding. Two lines at most. |
| 3 | Subtitle and unit | Measure, unit and period, for example "EBITDA margin, % of revenue, FY16–FY25". |
| 4 | Axis | Four or five ticks, Fog gridlines, zero baseline in Riverstone. |
| 5 | Direct labels | Values at the bar end. On lines, label the start, the end and turning points only. |
| 6 | Highlight | One Beacon Saffron mark: what the headline is about. |
| 7 | Benchmark | 1 px dashed Storm Slate, always labelled with its value. |
| 8 | Annotation | Explains a turn in the data. 10 px text, 1 px leader rising at 62° (the callout leader in chapter 05). |
| 9 | Source | "Source: ...; KSA analysis". No exceptions. |
| 10 | Notes | Definitions, exclusions, rounding and data status. |
| 11 | Identifier | The Confluence Y signs off client-facing exhibits, at the foot, bottom right. |

### 6.2.2 Worked example

Exhibit 3. Headline: "EBITDA margin crossed the peer median in FY25, the first time in a decade". Subtitle: "EBITDA margin, % of revenue, FY16–FY25". Columns FY16 to FY25 in Open Water; FY25 at 15.1% in Beacon Saffron. Peer median 14.0% as a dashed Storm Slate benchmark. Annotation: "Two plants consolidated into one, Q2 FY22".

Source: "Company annual reports FY16–FY25; Capitaline peer set (n = 9); KSA analysis". Note: "Peer median for FY25. Margins before exceptional items. Illustrative figures."

### 6.2.3 Exhibit type

Archivo throughout. Sizes are for screen exhibits and the reference artboard; see 6.15 for deck and print sizes.

| Element | Weight | Size |
|---|---|---|
| Exhibit number | 600 | 10 px |
| Eyebrow | 600 | 10 px, capitals |
| Headline | 700 | 15.5 / 20 px |
| Subtitle | 400 | 11 px |
| Labels | 400, tabular figures | 10 px |
| Source | 400 | 9.5 px |

All figures in exhibits use tabular figures (font-variant-numeric: tabular-nums).

## 6.3 Colour for data

Colour in a chart has a job. Open Water carries the story, Beacon Saffron points to the one thing that matters, Riverstone holds the context.

### 6.3.1 Roles

| Role | Light | Dark | Rule |
|---|---|---|---|
| Primary data path | Open Water #17807E | #3FB0A9 | The series the exhibit is about. |
| Highlight | Beacon Saffron #EE9B1E | Beacon Saffron #EE9B1E | One bar, point or line. Never two. Never a series colour in the cycle. |
| Context | Riverstone #8B9A9C | Drizzle #7A96A3 | Peers, prior years, everything else. |
| Benchmark | Storm Slate #3E5563, 1 px dashed | Drizzle #7A96A3, 1 px dashed | Targets, medians and averages. |
| Grid | Fog #D4DEE2, 1 px | Fog at 15% | Recessive by design. |
| Baseline | Riverstone #8B9A9C, 1 px | Drizzle #7A96A3 | The zero line is darker than the grid. |
| Text in charts | Storm Slate #3E5563 for labels, Deep Current #0E2F3C for values | Sea Mist #EEF4F1 | Never label in saffron, Riverstone or Estuary Sand on light. |

### 6.3.2 Categorical order 1–8

Use the categorical palette only when the categories have no order and the reader must tell them apart. Assign colours in this order.

| Order | Name | Hex | Token |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Open Water | #17807E | --ksa-data-cat-1 |
| 2 | Tidewater Blue | #2D6A9F | --ksa-data-cat-2 |
| 3 | Kelp Green | #4B7A4E | --ksa-data-cat-3 |
| 4 | Storm Slate | #3E5563 | --ksa-data-cat-4 |
| 5 | Estuary Sand | #D8C5A1 | --ksa-data-cat-5 |
| 6 | Dusk Plum | #5E4B78 | --ksa-data-cat-6 |
| 7 | Shallows | #5DB2AB | --ksa-data-cat-7 |
| 8 | Lichen | #9AAD5A | --ksa-data-cat-8 |

Beacon Saffron is not in the cycle. Never place category 4 (Storm Slate) next to category 6 (Dusk Plum): they are the closest pair under deuteranopia (see chapter 07). Label lines and slices directly.

### 6.3.3 Highlight versus context

Six colours, a legend and no message is the wrong answer. Riverstone context with the client in saffron is the right one.

Example: "CASA ratio, % of deposits, Q1 FY26". Client 44.2 in Beacon Saffron; Peer A 41.8, Peer B 38.5, Peer C 36.9, Peer D 33.0 and Peer E 29.4 in Riverstone. The same data drawn in six categorical colours with a legend is rejected.

### 6.3.4 Ramps

| Ramp | Steps (light to dark or low to high) | Use |
|---|---|---|
| Sequential, teal | Spray #CDE8E3 · Shallows #5DB2AB · Open Water #17807E · Deep Lagoon #0B5654 · Deep Current #0E2F3C | Magnitude, heat maps |
| Sequential, warm | Haze #FBEBCD · Dawn #F5C46D · Beacon Saffron #EE9B1E · Burnished Gold #9C630E | A second measure; rare |
| Diverging | Red Clay #B4472F · Coral Flare #E2735C · Fog #D4DEE2 (zero) · Shallows #5DB2AB · Open Water #17807E | Variance, sentiment, ± change |
| Risk heat | Kelp Green #4B7A4E · Lichen #9AAD5A · Dawn #F5C46D · Beacon Saffron #EE9B1E · Coral Flare #E2735C · Red Clay #B4472F | Risk matrices only |

The risk ramp is the one place saffron appears as a ramp step. It is used on risk matrices and nowhere else.

Risk ramp bands for a 5×5 likelihood × impact score (1 to 25):

| Score | Band | Colour |
|---|---|---|
| 1–2 | Low | Kelp Green #4B7A4E |
| 3–4 | Minor | Lichen #9AAD5A |
| 5–6 | Moderate | Dawn #F5C46D |
| 7–10 | Elevated | Beacon Saffron #EE9B1E |
| 11–15 | High | Coral Flare #E2735C |
| 16–25 | Critical | Red Clay #B4472F |

### 6.3.5 Cluster colours

One colour per service cluster, fixed in all reports. Use them only when the chart is about the clusters.

| Cluster | Colour | Hex |
|---|---|---|
| Strategy, Deal & Transactions | Open Water | #17807E |
| Tax & Regulatory | Burnished Gold | #9C630E |
| Crisis & Resilience | Storm Slate | #3E5563 |
| Technology & AI | Tidewater Blue | #2D6A9F |
| Managed Services | Kelp Green | #4B7A4E |
| International Desk | Dusk Plum | #5E4B78 |

### 6.3.6 State colours

States always come with an icon, sign or word.

| State | Treatment | Example |
|---|---|---|
| Success | Kelp Green #4B7A4E on an 8% tint | On track · +12.4% |
| Warning | Burnished Gold #9C630E text on Haze #FBEBCD | Filing due in 3 days |
| Alert or negative | Red Clay #B4472F on an 8% tint | Breach · −3.1% |
| Info | Tidewater Blue #2D6A9F on an 8% tint | Refreshed 09:00 IST |

### 6.3.7 Light and dark data palettes

| Element | Light | Dark |
|---|---|---|
| Ground | White or Sea Mist #EEF4F1 | Deep Current #0E2F3C |
| Primary series | Open Water #17807E | #3FB0A9 |
| Context series | Riverstone #8B9A9C | Drizzle #7A96A3 |
| Grid | Fog #D4DEE2 | Fog at 15% |
| Text | Storm Slate #3E5563 | Sea Mist #EEF4F1 |
| Highlight | Beacon Saffron #EE9B1E | Beacon Saffron #EE9B1E |

Example used on both: "Digital adoption, % of users", April to March, values 30, 45, 49, 60, 68, 75.

### 6.3.8 Contrast for data colours

WCAG AA requires 4.5:1 for text and 3:1 for marks.

| Pair | Ratio | Verdict |
|---|---|---|
| Open Water on white | 4.75:1 | Passes AA for text and links |
| Beacon Saffron on white | 2.25:1 | Fills only. Label in Deep Current. |
| Riverstone on white | 2.92:1 | Marks only. Label in Storm Slate. |
| Estuary Sand on white | 1.69:1 | Below 3:1: add a direct label. |
| Beacon Saffron on Deep Current | 6.27:1 | Passes as text on dark. |
| Burnished Gold on Haze | 4.25:1 | Warning text at 14 px bold and up. |

## 6.4 Choosing the form

Pick the form by the question the reader is asking.

| The question | Form | Section |
|---|---|---|
| How has it changed over time? | Line, area, forecast | 6.5 |
| How do several series compare over time? | Multi-line (up to 6), then small multiples | 6.5 |
| Which is biggest? | Sorted horizontal bar | 6.6 |
| How do two periods compare across groups? | Grouped column | 6.6 |
| What is the mix, and how does the total move? | Stacked column (4 segments max) | 6.6 |
| Do people agree or disagree? | Diverging bar | 6.6 |
| Are we on target? | Bullet bar, half-donut gauge | 6.6, 6.7 |
| What share of the whole? | Donut, waffle, 100% stacked bar, treemap | 6.7 |
| How did a start value become an end value? | Waterfall bridge | 6.8 |
| How big is each segment, and who holds it? | Marimekko | 6.8 |
| Which options should we pursue first? | 2×2 bubble matrix | 6.8 |
| Who moved between two dates? | Slopegraph | 6.8 |
| Which risks matter most after controls? | 5×5 risk heat map | 6.9 |
| Who is strongest on each capability? | Harvey balls | 6.9 |
| Where is the gap between now and target widest? | Dumbbell | 6.9 |
| Is the programme on plan? | Roadmap Gantt | 6.9 |
| Where do we stand, and what is the next step? | Maturity ladder | 6.9 |
| What are the exact figures? | Table, RAG scorecard | 6.10, 6.11 |
| What is the one number to watch? | Metric card | 6.13 |

## 6.5 Line and area

Lines show change over time. Draw straight segments between real data points, label every line where it ends and let one line carry the story.

### 6.5.1 Specification

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Line | 2 px Open Water; highlight 3 px Beacon Saffron |
| Context | 2 px Riverstone |
| Benchmark | 1 px Storm Slate, dashed 4 3 |
| Forecast | 2 px dotted 2 3, same hue as the actual line |
| Area | Line colour, gradient 12% to 0%, zero baseline |
| Band | Open Water at 12%, no outline |
| Markers | End and highlight only · r 3.5, with a 2 px white ring |
| Grid | Fog 1 px, 4–5 ticks; baseline Riverstone |
| Labels | Direct, at the line end, 10 px; value in bold |
| Density | Maximum 6 lines, then small multiples |

| | |
|---|---|
| Hover | 1 px Riverstone crosshair; tooltip in Deep Current, 4 px radius, 8 px offset, 120 ms ease-out |

### 6.5.2 The six line forms

| No. | Form | Example | Rule |
|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | Single line | Retail loan book, ₹ '000 crore, FY18–FY25: 487 at FY25 against a FY25 plan of 520 (−6% vs plan) | Saffron end-point; benchmark labelled with its value |
| 02 | Multi-line | Gross NPA ratio, % of advances, FY19–FY25: SFBs 4.4, NBFCs 3.4, PSU banks 3.0, Private banks 1.7, Foreign banks 1.2 | Five lines, labels at the ends; no legend |
| 03 | Area and hover | Monthly SIP inflows, ₹ '000 crore, Apr 24–Mar 25; tooltip "DEC 2024 · SIP inflow ₹26.5k cr" | Area from zero; crosshair and tooltip on hover |
| 04 | Forecast | Peak power demand, GW, FY18–FY30F; band = 80% interval | Dotted after the last actual; band at 12% |
| 05 | Small multiples | Fee growth by cluster, % YoY, FY21–FY25: Strategy 18, Tax 12, Crisis 12, Tech & AI 24, Managed 9, Intl Desk 34 | One question per panel; others ghosted in Fog |
| 06 | Sparklines and metric card | Fee income · Q2 FY26: ₹26.1 cr, 8.4% vs Q1 | See 6.5.3 |

### 6.5.3 Sparkline sizes

| Context | Size | Stroke | Marker |
|---|---|---|---|
| Card | 120 × 32 px | 2 px | End marker |
| Table | 80 × 24 px | 1.5 px | End marker |
| Inline | 48 × 16 px | 1.5 px at most | No marker |

Inside the metric card component (6.13), the sparkline runs 8 to 13 points at 1.5 px with an end marker.

### 6.5.4 Do and don't

| Don't | Do |
|---|---|
| A legend box: the eye shuttles back and forth. | Direct labels at the line ends. |
| Smoothing, which invents values that never happened ("curve ≠ data"). | Straight segments between real points. |

## 6.6 Bars and columns

Bars compare amounts. Their length is the message, so the baseline is always zero and the order is chosen, never accidental.

### 6.6.1 Specification

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Bar : gap | 2 : 1 (the gap is 50% of the bar width) |
| Groups | 2 px inside a group, one bar width between groups |
| Baseline | Zero, Riverstone 1 px |
| Labels | At the bar end, 10 px, Deep Current |
| Colour | Open Water, plus one saffron |
| Density | Maximum 12 bars and 4 stacked segments |

### 6.6.2 Rules

- Zero baseline, always. Never break or truncate the axis.
- Sort largest first unless the order is natural: time, age bands, rating grades.
- Use columns for time. Use horizontal bars for long labels or more than seven items.

### 6.6.3 The six bar forms

| No. | Form | Example | Rule |
|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | Column with one highlight | Gross GST collections, ₹ lakh crore, FY25, by month April to March; April marked "2.10 · April record" in saffron | Single series; one saffron column |
| 02 | Sorted horizontal bar | Deal value by sector, FY25, ₹ '000 crore: BFSI 84.2, Manufacturing 61.5, Healthcare 43.8, Consumer 38.1, Energy 31.6, Technology 27.9, Real estate 18.4 | Largest first; values at the bar end |
| 03 | Grouped | Revenue by region, ₹ crore, FY24 and FY25: North, South, West, East | Prior year in Riverstone, current year in Open Water |
| 04 | Stacked, 4 segments max | Fees by cluster, ₹ crore, FY22–FY25: totals 264, 304, 348, 396; segments Strategy, Tech & AI, Crisis, Other | Total above each stack |
| 05 | Diverging | Risk culture survey, % of 412 managers: "Board gets timely risk data" 20% disagree, 62% agree; "Controls are tested often" 15%, 63%; "Speak-up channel is trusted" 33%, 42%; "Third-party risk is understood" 43%, 33% | Disagree to the left, agree to the right of a common centre |
| 06 | Bullet vs target | FY25 scorecard vs target: Revenue ₹ crore 412; EBITDA margin % 15.1%; NPS score 42; Billable use % 71% | Bar is the actual, tick is the target |

### 6.6.4 Do and don't

| Don't | Do |
|---|---|
| An axis that starts at 95: a truncated axis turns +5% (to 101) into a cliff. | A zero baseline; the change goes in the label ("101 · +5%"). |
| Unsorted bars, with colour that means nothing. | Sorted bars, one colour, values at the end (Retail 64, SME 51, Corporate 38, Agri 22). |

## 6.7 Part to whole

Show a share only when the whole matters. A donut states the total; a bar compares the parts.

### 6.7.1 Donut specification

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Thickness | 18% of the diameter |
| Segments | Maximum 5; roll the rest into Other |
| Order | Largest first, clockwise from 12 o'clock |
| Gaps | 2 px, in the surface colour |
| Centre | The total, in Archivo Expanded 700 |
| Labels | A legend with %, never labels inside slices |

### 6.7.2 The six part-to-whole forms

| No. | Form | Example |
|---|---|---|
| 01 | Donut with legend | FY25 fees by cluster, ₹412 crore: Strategy 36%, Tax 25%, Crisis 19%, Tech & AI 11%, Other 9% |
| 02 | Half-donut gauge | Collection efficiency, Q2 FY26: 92.4% against a 95% target; "2.6 pts below target"; scale 0 to 100 |
| 03 | Waffle, 10 × 10 | New MSME loans to women-led firms, FY25: 38 in every 100 loans, up from 29 in FY22; 1 square = 1% |
| 04 | 100% stacked bar | FMCG sales by channel, % of value, FY22–FY25: general trade falls from 71 to 59; quick commerce rises from 1% to 11%; modern trade and e-commerce complete each bar |
| 05 | Treemap | Nifty 50 weight by sector, %, Sep 2025: Financials 37%, Others 23%, IT 13%, Oil & gas 11%, FMCG 9%, Auto 7% |
| 06 | No pie charts | The same six shares (24, 19, 17, 15, 13, 12) drawn two ways: angles defeat the eye; a sorted bar reads |

| | |
|---|---|
| | at once |

### 6.7.3 When to use which

| Form | Use when | Limit |
|---|---|---|
| Donut | One whole, up to 5 parts, with a total worth stating. | ≤ 5 segments |
| Half-donut gauge | A single KPI against a target or capacity. | 1 value + target |
| Waffle | A share people should feel: "38 in 100". | 1–2 parts |
| 100% stacked bar | How a mix shifts over time or across groups. | ≤ 4 segments |
| Treemap | Many parts of very different size, with hierarchy. | ≤ 8 tiles + Other |
| Pie | Never. Use a donut or a sorted bar. | Not used |

## 6.8 Consulting exhibits I

Four workhorse exhibits from strategy work. Each answers a specific question.

### 6.8.1 Waterfall bridge

Use when explaining how a start value became an end value, one driver at a time.

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Rises | Open Water #17807E |
| Falls | Red Clay #B4472F |
| Totals (start and end) | Deep Current #0E2F3C |
| Connectors | 1 px Riverstone |
| Labels | Signed values above each bar (+68, −47); totals as plain figures |
| Summary | The net change in a callout above the end total |

Example. Headline: "Volume and price added ₹99 crore; input and people costs took back ₹69 crore". Subtitle: "EBITDA bridge, FY24 to FY25, ₹ crore".

| Step | Value |
|---|---|
| FY24 EBITDA | 412 |
| Volume growth | +68 |
| Price and mix | +31 |
| Input costs | −47 |
| Employee costs | −22 |
| Procurement savings | +18 |
| Other | −9 |
| FY25 EBITDA | 451 |
| Net change | +39 crore · +9.5% |

Source: "Company management accounts; KSA analysis". Note: "Rises in Open Water, falls in Red Clay, totals in Deep Current; connectors 1px Riverstone."

### 6.8.2 Marimekko

Use when both segment size and the share inside each segment matter. Maximum 6 columns × 4 rows.

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Column width | The segment's share of the total market, labelled under the column (for example "Dairy 38%") |
| Column height | 100%, split by player type |
| Row colours | Top 3 brands Open Water; Next 7 Tidewater Blue; Regional Estuary Sand; Unorganised Riverstone |
| Labels | Share in each cell large enough to hold it; white on Open Water and Tidewater Blue, Deep Current on Sand and Riverstone |
| Highlight | One cell outlined with a 2 px Beacon Saffron rule |

Example. Headline: "Staples are still 58% unorganised: the largest headroom for branded players". Subtitle: "Packaged food market by segment and player type, FY25, % of value". Segments: Dairy 38%, Snacks 24%, Bakery 18%, Staples 12%, Beverages 8%. The Staples unorganised cell (58%) carries the saffron outline. Source: "Industry interviews; company filings; KSA market model".

### 6.8.3 2×2 bubble matrix

Use when ranking options on two criteria. Bubble area adds a third. Saffron marks the pick.

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| X axis | Ease of implementation, hard to easy, left to right |
| Y axis | Value at stake, ₹ crore a year, from zero |
| Bubble area | Investment |
| Quadrants | Top left PLAN CAREFULLY · top right DO NOW · bottom left PARK · bottom right QUICK WINS |
| Quadrant labels | Capitals, 600, Storm Slate, in the outer corners |
| Colour | Bubbles in Open Water at 85% with a 1.5 px white ring; the pick in Beacon Saffron |
| Dividers | 1 px Storm Slate lines at the midpoints of both axes |

Example. Headline: "Of the three initiatives worth over ₹100 crore, dynamic pricing is the easiest". Subtitle: "Initiatives by ease and annual value at stake". Initiatives: network consolidation, dynamic pricing (saffron), working capital release, digital collections, ERP replacement, procurement analytics, shared services, vendor rationalisation. Source: "[Client name] workshops, [Month Year]; KSA analysis".

### 6.8.4 Slopegraph

Use when only the start and the end matter. Maximum 8 lines, one in saffron.

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Axes | Two vertical axes, start and end period |
| Labels | Rank, name and value at both ends ("#5 Bank A 71" to "82 Bank A #2") |
| Colour | Context lines 2 px Riverstone; the subject 3 px Beacon Saffron, with its labels in Deep Current 700 |
| Axes style | Fog verticals at each period |

Example. Headline: "Bank A climbed from fifth to second on customer satisfaction in two years". Subtitle: "Customer satisfaction index (0–100) and rank, private banks".

| Bank | FY23 rank | FY23 | FY25 | FY25 rank |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Peer A | #1 | 79 | 84 | #1 |
| Bank A | #5 | 71 | 82 | #2 |
| Peer B | #2 | 76 | 78 | #3 |
| Peer C | #3 | 74 | 75 | #4 |
| Peer D | #4 | 73 | 70 | #5 |
| Peer E | #6 | 68 | 66 | #6 |

Source: "[Survey name], FY23 and FY25 (n = [x]); KSA analysis".

## 6.9 Consulting exhibits II

Five structures for risk, capability and change programmes. Each answers one question a board asks.

### 6.9.1 5×5 risk heat map

Use when ranking a risk register for a board. Maximum 12 risks.

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Grid | 5 × 5, likelihood (x, 1–5) by impact (y, 1–5), 2 px gaps |
| Cell colour | Risk ramp by score 1 to 25 (see 6.3.4) |
| Risk markers | Numbered Deep Current discs with a white number and white ring, keyed to a list |
| Movement | The inherent position drawn as a dashed ring, with an arrow to the residual position |
| Legend | Ramp from score 1 to 25; key for the inherent marker ("R2 before controls") |

Example. Headline: "Three risks stay high even after controls". Subtitle: "Residual risk register, likelihood × impact, each scored 1 to 5".

| No. | Risk | Likelihood | Impact | Score |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Related-party leakage | 3 | 4 | 12 |
| 2 | Ransomware outage (from 5 × 5 before controls) | 3 | 4 | 12 |
| 3 | DPDP Act breach | 3 | 3 | 9 |
| 4 | Vendor kickbacks | 4 | 3 | 12 |
| 5 | GST credit mismatch | 2 | 2 | 4 |
| 6 | Key-person exit | 2 | 4 | 8 |
| 7 | INR / USD shock | 4 | 2 | 8 |

Source: "[Client name] risk register, [Month Year]; KSA analysis".

On screen, the same matrix labels every cell with its count (see the Risk monitor in chapter 07).

### 6.9.2 Harvey balls

Use when comparing judgement across 3 to 5 options.

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Scale | Five points: empty (none), quarter, half, three-quarter, full (market-leading) |
| Colour | Balls in Deep Current. The column the headline is about is drawn in Open Water on a Sea Mist band, with a 3 px saffron bar on its header. |
| Layout | Options as columns, capabilities as rows, a 1 px Deep Current rule under the header and Fog hairlines between rows |
| Key | "None" to "Market-leading" under the table |

Example. Headline: "Boutiques lead on regulatory and IP work". Subtitle: "Capability by provider type, five-point assessment". Columns: Boutique, Big Four, Mid-tier, Niche. Rows: forensic accounting, digital forensics, SEBI / RBI regulatory, brand protection & IP, field intelligence, speed to mobilise. Source: "[Client name] RFP panel, [x] interviews; KSA analysis".

### 6.9.3 Dumbbell

Use when showing a gap between two states.

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Points | Current in Riverstone; target in Open Water; joined by a 2.5 px Fog line |
| Highlight | The widest gap: a 3 px Beacon Saffron connector and a bold label |
| Axis | Maturity score 1 to 5 |
| Gap column | Signed gap at the right, sorted largest first |

Example. Headline: "Third-party risk has the widest gap". Subtitle: "Compliance maturity, current vs target, score 1 to 5".

| Area | Current | Target FY28 | Gap |
|---|---|---|---|
| Third-party risk | 1.8 | 4.0 | +2.2 |
| Data privacy (DPDP) | 2.0 | 4.0 | +2.0 |
| Cyber resilience | 2.4 | 4.2 | +1.8 |
| Fraud analytics | 2.2 | 3.8 | +1.6 |
| KYC / AML | 3.1 | 4.3 | +1.2 |
| Board oversight | 3.6 | 4.2 | +0.6 |

Source: "KSA maturity diagnostic, [Client name], [Month Year]".

### 6.9.4 Roadmap Gantt

Use when phases overlap and dated decisions matter. Always draw today. Maximum 8 rows.

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Time axis | Months across the top |
| Milestones row | Decision gates as Deep Current diamonds, labelled |
| Bars | Planned span in Spray #CDE8E3; the completed share filled in Open Water from the left |

| | |
|---|---|
| Today | A 2 px vertical Beacon Saffron line with a saffron tag, "TODAY 16 OCT", in Deep Current 700 |
| Rows | Numbered phases; key for Complete, Planned and Decision gate |

Example. Headline: "Build is a third complete and February go-live holds". Subtitle: "Fraud-risk programme, July 2026 to March 2027, by phase". Milestones: SteerCo, Board, Audit Cttee, Go-live, Close. Phases: 1 Diagnose; 2 Design operating model; 3 Build controls & analytics; 4 Pilot: two plants; 5 Scale & embed. Today line: "TODAY 16 OCT". Source: "[Client name] programme office, status at [date]".

### 6.9.5 Maturity ladder

Use when the client must see where they stand and the next step.

| Level | Name | Description |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Ad hoc | Reactive, person-led |
| 2 | Defined | Policies written |
| 3 | Managed | Owned and measured |
| 4 | Integrated | Embedded in decisions |
| 5 | Optimised | Predictive, automated |

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Steps | Five rising steps, left to right, on a 1 px Riverstone baseline. Levels reached in Open Water with white text; the next levels in Spray; the top level in Sea Mist, with Deep Current text. |
| Number and name | Level number in Archivo Expanded 700; name in 700; descriptor beneath |
| Today | A Deep Current pointer and "TODAY" above the current step |
| Target | The target step outlined with a 2 px Beacon Saffron rule, a saffron diamond and "TARGET FY28" above it |

Example. Headline: "Level 2 today; the target is level 4 by FY28". Subtitle: "Enterprise risk maturity, five-level model". Source: "KSA ERM maturity model; [Client name] self-assessment".

## 6.10 Tables

A table is an exhibit too. Figures line up on the decimal, units live in the header, and one row carries the message.

### 6.10.1 Table specification

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Row height | 32 px compact · 40 px default · 6.5 mm in print |
| Header | 10–11 px capitals, 600 · 1.5 px Deep Current rule below |
| Alignment | Text left · figures right, tabular figures |
| Decimals | Same decimals down a column; round last (4,812 · 17.4) |
| Zebra | Off by default · Fog rules between rows |
| Totals | 1 px rule above · 1.5 px below, bold |
| Highlight | One row only · Haze #FBEBCD fill and a 3 px saffron bar on the left |
| Ratios | Set in italics, indented under their parent line |
| Estimates | Estimate columns shaded in Sea Mist and marked "E" |
| Negatives | Red Clay, in brackets |
| Nil | An en dash in Riverstone |

Four things every table shows: units and period in the header; negatives in Red Clay brackets; totals rules; one highlight row.

### 6.10.2 Worked example: Exhibit 7, financial summary

Headline: "EBITDA compounds at 20% a year as margin widens 300 bps". Subtitle: "Listed auto-components maker, consolidated, ₹ crore; FY26E is KSA estimate (shaded)".

| ₹ crore, year to 31 March | FY23 | FY24 | FY25 | FY26E | CAGR / Δ FY23–26 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Revenue from operations | 4,186 | 4,812 | 5,463 | 6,120 | 13.5% |
| *Growth, %* | *9.8* | *15.0* | *13.5* | *12.0* | |

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **EBITDA** (highlight row) | **653** | **784** | **950** | **1,138** | **20.3%** |
| *EBITDA margin, %* | *15.6* | *16.3* | *17.4* | *18.6* | +300 bps |
| Depreciation | 168 | 186 | 207 | 231 | |
| Finance costs | 94 | 102 | 88 | 71 | |
| Exceptional items | – | (86) | – | – | |
| Profit before tax | 391 | 410 | 655 | 836 | 28.8% |
| Tax | 98 | 104 | 165 | 210 | |
| **Profit after tax** (totals rules) | **293** | **306** | **490** | **626** | **28.8%** |
| Free cash flow | 118 | (142) | 214 | 388 | |
| *Net debt / EBITDA, x* | *1.1x* | *1.1x* | *0.6x* | *0.2x* | |
| *Return on capital employed, %* | *14.1* | *13.2* | *17.8* | *20.4* | +630 bps |

Source: "Company annual reports FY23–FY25; KSA estimates. Ratios in italics; CAGR over three years."

# 6.11 RAG scorecards

Shape carries status; colour confirms it.

## 6.11.1 Status shapes

| Status | Shape | Colour |
|---|---|---|
| On track | Circle | Kelp Green #4B7A4E |
| At risk | Triangle | Burnished Gold #9C630E |
| Off track | Diamond | Red Clay #B4472F |

Each shape is followed by its word. Never show a coloured dot alone.

## 6.11.2 Scorecard columns

| Column | Content |
|---|---|
| KPI | Name and unit |
| Actual | Bold, Deep Current, right aligned |
| Target | Storm Slate, right aligned |
| Vs tgt | Progress bar in Open Water on Sea Mist, with a Deep Current tick at the target |
| 8 qtrs | Sparkline, 8 quarters, Storm Slate |
| Status | Shape and word |

## 6.11.3 Worked example: Exhibit 8

Headline: "Two of six controls are off track; KYC backlog is growing". Subtitle: "Compliance programme, [Client name], Q2 FY27".

| KPI | Actual | Target | Status |
|---|---|---|---|
| Vendor DD coverage | 86% | 95% | ▲ At risk |
| Whistle-blower ≤ 30 days | 92% | 85% | ● On track |
| KYC backlog, accounts | 14,820 | 5,000 | ◆ Off track |
| Policy attestation | 98% | 98% | ● On track |
| Incident containment, h | 6.2 | 4.0 | ▲ At risk |
| Audit points closed | 71% | 90% | ◆ Off track |

# 6.12 Number formatting

| Case | Format | Rule |
|---|---|---|
| Crore | ₹ 1,234 cr | Space after ₹; "₹ crore" in headers |
| Lakh crore | ₹ 12.4 lakh cr | From ₹ 1 lakh crore up; one decimal |
| Global | US$ 1.48 bn | For global readers; state the rate |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Percent | 18.6% | One decimal, no space; growth signed, +12.0% |
| Rate change | +45 bps | Ratio changes in bps, always signed |
| Multiple | 8.2x | One decimal, lower-case x, no space |
| Negative | (142) · −142 | Brackets in tables; true minus (−) in text |
| Grouping | 12,34,567 | Indian grouping for India; 1,234,567 for global |
| Alignment | Text left · figures right | Tabular figures |
| Decimals | 4,812 · 17.4 | Same decimals down a column; round last |

Same number, two readers. For an Indian board: ₹ 4,812 crore. For a London fund: ₹ 4,812 crore (US$ 573 mn at ₹ 84).

Units in cards and hero figures are set at half the size of the figure (₹ 1,284 cr). Use the true minus sign (−, U+2212), never a hyphen.

# 6.13 Metric cards and KPIs

A metric card answers three questions in one glance: how much, compared with what, and is that good. Everything else is optional.

## 6.13.1 Card anatomy

| No. | Part | Specification |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Context tag | Metric and period; 10–11 px capitals, Storm Slate ("REVENUE · Q2 FY27") |
| 2 | Value | Archivo Expanded 700, Deep Current; unit at half size ("₹ 1,284 cr") |
| 3 | Delta pill | Glyph, figure and basis (YoY, QoQ) ("▲ 12.4% YoY") |
| 4 | Comparison | What the delta is measured against ("vs ₹ 1,142 cr in Q2 FY26") |
| 5 | Sparkline | 8 to 13 points, 1.5 px, end marker |
| 6 | Footnote | Source and date, 10 px ("SAP ledger · updated 14 Oct 2026") |
| 7 | Container | White, radius 8, Fog border + e1 shadow, padding 20 |

## 6.13.2 Delta pill

22 px high, radius 999, a 12% tint of the state colour, text weight 600. Colour follows meaning; the glyph follows direction.

| Case | Example | Glyph | Colour |
|---|---|---|---|
| Up and good | 12.4% | ▲ | Success (Kelp Green) |
| Down and good (NPA) | 18 bps | ▼ | Success (Kelp Green) |
| Up and bad (DSO) | 16 days | ▲ | Error (Red Clay) |
| Down and bad | 3.2% | ▼ | Error (Red Clay) |
| No change | 0.0% | – | Neutral (Storm Slate) |

On dark, delta pills switch to Lichen #9AAD5A and Coral Flare #E2735C to keep contrast.

## 6.13.3 Sizing

| Context | Minimum width | Padding | Value | Tag | Radius |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Desktop | ≥ 240 px | 24 | 32 px | 11 px | 8 |
| Web page | ≥ 200 px | 20 | 28 px | 11 px | 8 |
| Mobile | 2-up, ≥ 156 px | 16 | 24 px | 10 px | 12 |

## 6.13.4 Density

- Maximum 4 cards a row; 2 on mobile.
- One period and one basis per row.
- One delta and one visual per card.
- Values of 7 characters or fewer.
- Saffron once per row at most.

### 6.13.5 Eight variants

Shown in the light theme on Sea Mist, except variant 08. Saffron appears once in the row: the record quarter in variant 06.

| No. | Variant | Example |
|---|---|---|
| 01 | Simple value | OPEN ALERTS · 37 · across 11 marketplaces and 9 states |
| 02 | Value + delta | REVENUE · Q2 FY27 · ₹ 1,284 cr · ▲ 12.4% YoY · vs ₹ 1,142 cr |
| 03 | With sparkline | GROSS NPA · 2.41% · ▼ 18 bps · 8 quarters · lower is better |
| 04 | Progress to target | CAPEX SPENT · FY27 · ₹ 86.4 cr · 72% of ₹ 120 cr · progress bar with a pace marker at 58% |
| 05 | Vs benchmark | EBITDA MARGIN · FY26 · 18.6% · dashed line: peer median 15.2% · +340 bps |
| 06 | Mini bar | FRAUD CASES · QUARTER · 14 · Q3 FY25 to Q2 FY27 · highest yet; the record bar in saffron |
| 07 | Alert state | DAYS SALES OUTSTANDING · 74 days · ▲ 16 days · "Above 60-day covenant · review"; Red Clay frame and alert icon |
| 08 | Dark theme | CASE CLOSURE · 92% · within 30 days · Q2 FY27 · ▲ 4.1 pts; Storm Slate card, Spray tag, white value, Lichen delta pill |

## 6.14 Interaction and states

Charts on screen respond quietly: a crosshair, a tooltip, a dimmed series. Every state, including no data, is designed.

### 6.14.1 Tooltip anatomy

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Size | Maximum width 240 px; height auto; padding 8 / 10 px |
| Fill | Deep Current, white text, radius 4, e2 shadow |
| Motion | Fade + 4 px rise, 120 ms ease-out |
| Nub | 6 px, points at the mark; flips at the edges |
| Content | Period, series, value with unit ("OCT 2025 · Data analytics 31 cases") |
| Placement | Above the mark, centred; 8 px offset; 8 px from the edges of the chart |

On dark, the tooltip inverts to white with Deep Current text.

### 6.14.2 Crosshair and multi-series tooltip

1 px Riverstone crosshair that snaps to the period (for example, to the month). The tooltip lists each series and a total: "OCT 2025 · CASES: Data analytics 31, Whistle-blower 20, Internal audit 11, Total 62".

### 6.14.3 Legend behaviours

| Action | Behaviour |
|---|---|
| Hover a legend key | Isolate that series; others drop to 20% |
| Click a legend key | Toggle the series off; the key becomes hollow and the label is struck through |

### 6.14.4 Bar states

| State | Treatment |
|---|---|
| Default | Open Water |
| Hover | Deep Lagoon #0B5654 + tooltip ("Infra 63") |
| Selected | Deep Current; the rest drop to 35% |

### 6.14.5 Filter chips and date range

| Control | Specification |
|---|---|
| Filter chips | 26 px high, radius 999; active chip in Deep Current with a × to clear; "+ Filter" to add |
| Period segments | 32 px high, radius 4: 1M · 3M · YTD · FY26 · Custom |

| | |
|---|---|
| Date range | "1 Apr 2026 – 30 Sep 2026", with comparison basis "vs H1 FY26" |
| Focus | 2 px Deep Current ring with a 2 px gap |

### 6.14.6 Dark theme charts

Grid in Fog at 15%. Primary series #3FB0A9. The tooltip inverts to white. Example: "Cases opened · FY26", tooltip "SEP 2025 · Analytics 26".

### 6.14.7 Empty, loading, error and no-data states

| No. | State | Pattern | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| 07 | Empty | A sentence, an icon and an action | "No cases match these filters" · Clear filters |
| 08 | Loading | Fog skeleton with shimmer (the wake-line loader in chapter 07) | Skeleton bars in the chart frame |
| 09 | Error | Say what failed; offer a retry | "Couldn't load case data" · Retry |
| 10 | No data for period | Link a nearby period | "No filings for Q3 FY27 yet" · View Q2 FY27 → |

## 6.15 Data across media

One finding, four media. The insight and the highlight stay fixed; type size, density and interaction change with the reader's distance and time.

### 6.15.1 Specification by medium

| | Deck 16:9 | Print A4 | Web dashboard | Mobile |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Canvas | 1280 × 720 px | A4, 2 or 3 columns | Tile ≥ 4 of 12 columns | 360–430 pt wide |
| Headline | 28–32 pt, the insight | 11–12 pt bold | 16–18 px | 16 px, 2 lines |
| Data labels | 14–16 pt | 7–8 pt | 12 px | 12 px |
| Source, notes | 10 pt | 6.5–7 pt | 11 px, on hover ⓘ | Behind ⓘ |
| Line weight | 3 pt · highlight 4.5 | 1 pt · highlight 1.5 | 2 px · highlight 3 | 2.5 px |
| Gridlines | None; baseline only | 0.35 pt Fog | 1 px Fog | None |
| Series · labels | ≤ 3 · ≤ 5 labels | ≤ 6 · ≤ 12 labels | ≤ 6 · labels on hover | 1 + highlight · ≤ 2 |
| Interaction | Build in steps | None | Tooltip, filter, export | Tap, swipe periods |

### 6.15.2 The same finding in four media

Finding: "Data analytics overtook whistle-blowers as the top fraud trigger in FY25". Measure: share of investigations by first trigger, %, FY20–FY26. Source: "[Survey name], [x] investigations FY20–FY26; KSA analysis." Note: "first trigger recorded at case opening; remainder from audit and regulators."

| Medium | Treatment |
|---|---|
| 01 Presentation slide | Headline states the insight; direct labels (Analytics 41%, Whistle-blower 31%), no legend; one annotated crossover ("FY25 crossover"). |
| 02 Thought-leadership page | Exhibit 4 with number, source and notes; the serif body flows around it ("The data finds it first"). |
| 03 Web dashboard tile | Crosshair, tooltip, legend toggles, a 3Y / 7Y period switch and export. |
| 04 Mobile card | One series, one highlight and a big number: "41% of cases now start with data analytics, ▲ 5 pts"; "Tap for whistle-blower trend"; "View as table →". |

The sizes in 6.2.3 and 6.15.1 apply inside exhibits. The accessibility minimums in chapter 07 (12 px UI text, 9 pt for print sources) are floors for interface text and for source lines set outside an exhibit.

## 6.16 Chart themes for analysts

The KSA_Design_Tokens package carries the data palette into the tools analysts use, so a chart starts on-brand.

| File | Tool | How to apply |
|---|---|---|
| ksa-echarts-theme-light.json, ksa-echarts-theme- | Apache ECharts | echarts.registerTheme('ksa', json) |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| dark.json | | |
| ksa-powerbi-theme.json | Power BI | View > Themes > Browse for themes |
| ksa.mplstyle | Python matplotlib | plt.style.use('ksa.mplstyle') |
| ksa-tokens.css, ksa-tokens.json | Web, Figma Tokens Studio, Style Dictionary | See chapter 07 |

Rules that tokens alone cannot enforce:

- One Beacon Saffron (#EE9B1E) highlight per chart or view. It is never a series colour in the cycle.
- Bars start at zero. No pies, 3D or dual axes. Maximum 12 bars, 6 lines, 5 donut segments.
- Saffron, Riverstone and Estuary Sand fail contrast as text on white: label them in Deep Current or Storm Slate.
- Use tokens by role (color.action.primary), never raw hex in product code.

## 6.17 Exhibit checklist

- The title states the insight; the subtitle states the measure, unit and period.
- One saffron mark, and it is the thing the headline is about.
- Bars start at zero; one axis; equal spacing for equal time; no pies, 3D or dual axes.
- Density limits kept: 12 bars, 6 lines, 4 stacked segments, 5 donut segments, 8 slopegraph lines, 12 risks, 8 Gantt rows, 6 × 4 Marimekko.
- Direct labels; a legend only when labels cannot fit.
- Benchmarks dashed in Storm Slate and labelled with their value.
- A source line on every exhibit, with "KSA analysis" where we transformed the data; notes for definitions and rounding.
- Numbers in the right format for the reader; tabular figures; negatives in brackets in tables.
- Status shown by shape and word, with colour confirming it.
- Every on-screen state designed, including empty, loading, error and no data.

CHAPTER 07

# UI assets, design tokens, web and mobile apps, and motion

This chapter carries the brand into software. It defines the design tokens that every KSA product reads: the twenty-two semantic colour tokens in light and dark themes, the type scale, spacing, radius, elevation, breakpoints, icon sizes and touch targets. It then specifies the controls, navigation and feedback components, and shows them assembled in four flagship reference screens: the KSA Client Room portal, the Brand and Risk Monitor, the kayaksa.com insights pages and the KSA mobile app. It closes with motion, built on the paddle stroke and four duration tokens, and with accessibility to WCAG 2.2 AA, including the contrast matrix and colour-vision checks. The values here are taken from the KSA_Design_Tokens package (ksa-tokens.css and ksa-tokens.json, v1.0, October 2026), which is the source of truth for code.

## 7.1 How the tokens work

### 7.1.1 Name by role, never by hue

Tokens are named by role: color.action.primary, never teal. Components read roles only, so a theme swap is a token swap. Product code never uses raw hex.

| Layer | Example | Who uses it |
|---|---|---|
| Palette (primitive) | --ksa-open-water: #17807E | The token files only |
| Semantic (role) | --ksa-color-action-primary | Components and product code |
| Data | --ksa-data-cat-1, --ksa-data-seq-3, --ksa-data-risk-6 | Charts and dashboards |

### 7.1.2 Files

| File | Format | Use |
|---|---|---|
| ksa-tokens.css | CSS custom properties. Light by default; add data-theme="dark" to the html element for the dark theme. | Web products |
| ksa-tokens.json | W3C design-tokens format | Figma Tokens Studio, Style Dictionary and other pipelines |
| ksa-echarts-theme-light.json, ksa-echarts-theme-dark.json | Apache ECharts themes | echarts.registerTheme('ksa', json) |
| ksa-powerbi-theme.json | Power BI report theme | View > Themes > Browse for themes |
| ksa.mplstyle | Matplotlib style | plt.style.use('ksa.mplstyle') |

### 7.1.3 Naming across platforms

| Context | Pattern | Example |
|---|---|---|
| Design documentation | color.group.role | color.action.primary |
| CSS | --ksa-color-group-role | --ksa-color-action-primary |
| JSON | color.light.group-role and color.dark.group-role | color.dark.action-primary |

### 7.1.4 Fonts

The CSS file loads both families from Google Fonts: Archivo with width 62–125 and weight 100–900, and Source Serif 4 with optical size 8–60, weights 400–700, roman and italic.

| Token | Stack |
|---|---|

Two helper classes ship with the tokens: .ksa-display sets the display style at font-stretch 118%; .ksa-figure sets font-variant-numeric: tabular-nums for figures.

# 7.2 Colour tokens and themes

Twenty-two semantic tokens carry the palette into product. Each has a light and a dark value.

## 7.2.1 The twenty-two semantic tokens

| No. | Token | Light | Dark | Use |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | color.surface.page | #EEF4F1 Sea Mist | #0E2F3C Deep Current | App background |
| 02 | color.surface.card | #FFFFFF | #3E5563 Storm Slate | Cards, tables |
| 03 | color.surface.raised | #FFFFFF | #1F4B5F Undertow | Sidebars, menus |
| 04 | color.surface.inverse | #0E2F3C Deep Current | #EEF4F1 Sea Mist | Top bar, tooltips |
| 05 | color.text.heading | #0E2F3C Deep Current | #FFFFFF | Headings, key figures |
| 06 | color.text.body | #3E5563 Storm Slate | #EEF4F1 Sea Mist | Body copy, labels |
| 07 | color.text.muted | #7A96A3 Drizzle | #7A96A3 Drizzle | Placeholder, meta |
| 08 | color.text.link | #0B5654 Deep Lagoon | #CDE8E3 Spray | Links, tertiary actions |
| 09 | color.action.primary | #17807E Open Water | #3FB0A9 | Primary button fill |
| 10 | color.action.primary-hover | #0B5654 Deep Lagoon | #5DB2AB Shallows | Hover, pressed |
| 11 | color.action.on-primary | #FFFFFF | #0E2F3C Deep Current | Label on primary |
| 12 | color.action.destructive | #B4472F Red Clay | #E2735C Coral Flare | Delete, withdraw |
| 13 | color.border.subtle | #D4DEE2 Fog | #2C4955 | Dividers, input borders |
| 14 | color.border.strong | #7A96A3 Drizzle | #7A96A3 Drizzle | Control outlines |
| 15 | color.focus.ring | #0E2F3C Deep Current | #EE9B1E Beacon Saffron | 2 px ring with a 2 px gap |
| 16 | color.data.primary | #17807E Open Water | #3FB0A9 | Main series, bars, lines |
| 17 | color.data.highlight | #EE9B1E Beacon Saffron | #EE9B1E Beacon Saffron | One point of focus only |
| 18 | color.data.context | #8B9A9C Riverstone | #7A96A3 Drizzle | Baselines, context |
| 19 | color.state.success | #4B7A4E Kelp Green | #9AAD5A Lichen | Positive delta, complete |
| 20 | color.state.warning | #9C630E Burnished Gold | #F5C46D Dawn | Needs attention (text) |
| 21 | color.state.error | #B4472F Red Clay | #E2735C Coral Flare | Error, negative delta |
| 22 | color.state.info | #2D6A9F Tidewater Blue | #7A96A3 Drizzle | Neutral information |

Two dark values sit outside the named palette: #3FB0A9 (teal on dark, used for the primary action and primary data series) and #2C4955 (the subtle border on dark).

## 7.2.2 The two themes

| Theme | Page | Cards | Raised | Primary action |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Light | Sea Mist #EEF4F1 | White #FFFFFF, radius 8, e1 | White | Open Water #17807E, white label |
| Dark | Deep Current #0E2F3C | Storm Slate #3E5563, radius 8 | Undertow #1F4B5F | #3FB0A9, Deep Current label |

The light theme suits client-facing portals and reading. The dark theme suits long monitoring and analytics sessions.

## 7.2.3 Key pairs and contrast

| Pair | Light | Verdict | Dark | Verdict |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| text.heading / surface.card | 14.09:1 | AAA | 7.82:1 | AAA |
| text.body / surface.page | 7.02:1 | AAA | 12.64:1 | AAA |
| action.on-primary / action.primary | 4.75:1 | AA | 5.36:1 | AA |
| text.link / surface.card | 8.49:1 | AAA | 6.05:1 | AA |
| text.muted / surface.card | 3.13:1 | Large text only | 4.51:1 | AA |
| data.primary / surface.page | 4.26:1 | 3:1 for marks ✓ | 5.36:1 | 3:1 for marks ✓ |

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| data.highlight / surface.card | 2.25:1 | Label it | 3.48:1 | 3:1 for marks ✓ | |

Notes:

- Muted text (3.1:1 on white) is for placeholders and meta only.
- The dark muted value of 4.51:1 is measured on the dark page (Deep Current). On a Storm Slate card, Drizzle measures 2.5:1, so on dark cards keep muted text to non-essential meta and use text.body for anything a reader must read.
- Saffron is a highlight, never a surface or a text colour on light.

### 7.2.4 Palette primitives

The JSON and CSS files also carry the twenty-two named palette colours.

| Name | Hex | CSS variable |
|---|---|---|
| Deep Current | #0E2F3C | --ksa-deep-current |
| Open Water | #17807E | --ksa-open-water |
| Beacon Saffron | #EE9B1E | --ksa-beacon-saffron |
| Sea Mist | #EEF4F1 | --ksa-sea-mist |
| Storm Slate | #3E5563 | --ksa-storm-slate |
| Tidewater Blue | #2D6A9F | --ksa-tidewater-blue |
| Kelp Green | #4B7A4E | --ksa-kelp-green |
| Estuary Sand | #D8C5A1 | --ksa-estuary-sand |
| Red Clay | #B4472F | --ksa-red-clay |
| Riverstone | #8B9A9C | --ksa-riverstone |
| Deep Lagoon | #0B5654 | --ksa-deep-lagoon |
| Shallows | #5DB2AB | --ksa-shallows |
| Spray | #CDE8E3 | --ksa-spray |
| Burnished Gold | #9C630E | --ksa-burnished-gold |
| Dawn | #F5C46D | --ksa-dawn |
| Haze | #FBEBCD | --ksa-haze |
| Undertow | #1F4B5F | --ksa-undertow |
| Drizzle | #7A96A3 | --ksa-drizzle |
| Fog | #D4DEE2 | --ksa-fog |
| Dusk Plum | #5E4B78 | --ksa-dusk-plum |
| Lichen | #9AAD5A | --ksa-lichen |
| Coral Flare | #E2735C | --ksa-coral-flare |

### 7.2.5 Data tokens

| Set | Values | CSS variables |
|---|---|---|
| Categorical 1–8 | #17807E · #2D6A9F · #4B7A4E · #3E5563 · #D8C5A1 · #5E4B78 · #5DB2AB · #9AAD5A | --ksa-data-cat-1 to -8 |
| Sequential, teal | #CDE8E3 · #5DB2AB · #17807E · #0B5654 · #0E2F3C | --ksa-data-seq-1 to -5 |
| Sequential, warm | #FBEBCD · #F5C46D · #EE9B1E · #9C630E | JSON only |
| Diverging | #B4472F · #E2735C · #D4DEE2 · #5DB2AB · #17807E | JSON only |
| Risk | #4B7A4E · #9AAD5A · #F5C46D · #EE9B1E · #E2735C · #B4472F | --ksa-data-risk-1 to -6 |
| Highlight | #EE9B1E | color.data.highlight |
| Context | #8B9A9C | color.data.context |

Cluster colours (JSON color.data.clusters): Strategy, Deal & Transactions #17807E; Tax & Regulatory #9C630E; Crisis & Resilience #3E5563; Technology & AI #2D6A9F; Managed Services #4B7A4E; International Desk #5E4B78. Chapter 06 sets the rules for using them.

## 7.3 Type scale

Foundations every screen shares. Sizes snap to a 4 px grid, and line heights land on it too.

| Token | Specimen | Web (size / line height, px) | Mobile | Font | CSS shorthand |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Display | ₹412 cr | 56 / 60 | 36 / 40 | Archivo 700, width 118% | 700 56px/60px |
| H1 | Clear course | 40 / 48 | 28 / 34 | Archivo 600 | 600 40px/48px |
| H2 | Risk, mapped | 32 / 40 | 22 / 28 | Archivo 600 | 600 32px/40px |
| H3 | Due diligence, FY25 | 24 / 32 | 20 / 26 | Archivo 600 | 600 24px/32px |
| H4 | Vendor integrity review | 20 / 28 | 18 / 24 | Archivo 600 | 600 20px/28px |
| Body L | Evidence, set in a calm serif. | 18 / 28 | 17 / 26 | Source Serif 4 400 | 400 18px/28px serif |
| Body | Fieldwork closes on 14 November. | 16 / 24 | 16 / 24 | Archivo 400 | 400 16px/24px |
| Body S | Updated 14 Oct 2026 · 6 min read | 14 / 20 | 14 / 20 | Archivo 400 | 400 14px/20px |
| Caption | Source: RBI, FY25; KSA analysis | 12 / 16 | 12 / 16 | Archivo 400 | 400 12px/16px |
| Overline | CRISIS & RESILIENCE | 11 / 16 | 11 / 16 | Archivo 600, tracking 0.2em, capitals | 600 11px/16px |

Rules:

- Sentence case for headings. Capitals for overlines only.
- Figures in tables, cards and charts use tabular figures (.ksa-figure).
- Units in hero figures and metric cards are set at half the figure size.
- Body L (Source Serif 4) carries long reading: standfirsts, insight articles, report text on screen.

## 7.4 Spacing

A 4 px base. Every gap, padding and margin comes from this scale.

| Token | Value | Use |
|---|---|---|
| space.1 | 4 px | Icon to label |
| space.2 | 8 px | Inline gap |
| space.3 | 12 px | Control padding |
| space.4 | 16 px | Card padding (compact) |
| space.5 | 24 px | Group gap |
| space.6 | 32 px | Section gap |
| space.7 | 48 px | Block gap |
| space.8 | 64 px | Page band |
| space.9 | 96 px | Hero band |

CSS variables run from --ksa-space-1 to --ksa-space-9.

## 7.5 Radius

Brand graphics, print, patterns, photographs and charts keep square corners. Radius belongs to UI only.

| Token | Value | Use |
|---|---|---|
| radius.none | 0 px | Print, brand graphics, charts |
| radius.xs | 2 px | Checkbox |
| radius.sm | 4 px | Button, input, tag, tooltip, segmented control |
| radius.md | 8 px | Card, menu |
| radius.lg | 12 px | Modal, sheet, mobile card |
| radius.pill | 999 px | Chip, avatar, delta pill, badge count |

## 7.6 Elevation

Shadows are tinted with Deep Current, never black, on light. On dark, each level adds a faint Fog keyline so cards stay defined.

| Level | Name | Light | Dark | Use |
|---|---|---|---|---|

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| e0 | Flat | 0 0 0 1px #D4DEE2 | 0 0 0 1px rgba(212,222,226,.15) | Tables |
| e1 | Resting | 0 1px 2px rgba(14,47,60,.08) | 0 0 0 1px rgba(212,222,226,.10), 0 1px 2px rgba(0,0,0,.30) | Cards |
| e2 | Raised | 0 6px 16px rgba(14,47,60,.10) | 0 0 0 1px rgba(212,222,226,.10), 0 6px 16px rgba(0,0,0,.35) | Menus, popovers, tooltips |
| e3 | Overlay | 0 16px 40px rgba(14,47,60,.18) | 0 0 0 1px rgba(212,222,226,.10), 0 16px 40px rgba(0,0,0,.45) | Modals, toasts, sheets |

In light mode, cards pair e1 with a 1 px Fog border. No drop shadows in print or brand graphics; separate with tone and a 0.5 pt hairline.

# 7.7 Breakpoints, layout grid, icons and touch

## 7.7.1 Breakpoints and grid

| Breakpoint | Device | Columns | Gutter | Margin | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1440 | Desktop | 12 | 24 px | 64 px | Content caps at 1312 px |
| 1024 | Laptop | 12 | 24 px | 32 px | |
| 768 | Tablet | 8 | 16 px | 32 px | |
| 390 | Mobile | 4 | 16 px | 20 px | |

The token file also carries the presentation and print grids for reference: slide 1920 (12 columns, 40 px gutter, 128 px sides, 96 px top, 80 px foot) and A4 (12 columns, 4 mm gutter, 15 mm sides, 20 mm top, 22 mm foot, 12 pt baseline). Chapter 03 and chapter 08 cover them.

## 7.7.2 Icons and touch

| Icon size | Use |
|---|---|
| 16 px | Inline, in text |
| 20 px | In controls |
| 24 px | Default |
| 32 px | Feature |

| Target | Size |
|---|---|
| iOS minimum | 44 × 44 px |
| Web and Android | 48 × 48 px |

Icons are drawn on the 24 px grid with a 2 px stroke (see chapter 05). The hit area grows; the icon does not.

# 7.8 Components I: controls

Quiet by default, exact in every state. Only focus and selection change the outline. Colour always comes from tokens.

## 7.8.1 Buttons

40 px high on web, 48 px on mobile, radius 4.

| Variant | Construction | Label example |
|---|---|---|
| Primary | Open Water fill (action.primary), white label | Approve |
| Secondary | 1 px Deep Current outline, Deep Current label | Export |
| Tertiary | Text and arrow, Deep Lagoon (text.link) | View all |
| Destructive | Red Clay fill (action.destructive), white label | Withdraw |

Every variant is specified in six states.

| State | Treatment |
|---|---|
| Default | Token colours as above. Labels in Archivo 600. |

| | |
|---|---|
| Hover | Primary fill moves to action.primary-hover (Deep Lagoon on light, Shallows on dark). Destructive deepens. Secondary gains a Sea Mist fill. Tertiary turns to the heading colour and underlines. |
| Pressed | Primary uses action.primary-hover. Secondary takes a Fog fill. |
| Focus | 2 px focus ring outside a 2 px gap (Deep Current ring and white gap on light; Beacon Saffron ring and Deep Current gap on dark) |
| Disabled | Fog fill (or Fog outline for secondary) with a Riverstone label on light; Drizzle label on dark |
| Loading | A spinner leads the label; the button keeps its width |

Sizes:

| Size | Height |
|---|---|
| SM | 32 px |
| MD | 40 px |
| LG | 48 px |

Icon buttons come in five forms: primary, outline, ghost, with a count badge, and in focus. Rules:

- One primary button per view.
- Icon-only buttons always get a tooltip.

### 7.8.2 Text input

40 px high · 1 px Fog border · on focus, an Open Water border and a 3 px ring · the label is always visible above the field, with helper text below.

| State | Label | Value or placeholder | Helper |
|---|---|---|---|
| Default | Client name | e.g. [Client name] Pvt Ltd (placeholder, text.muted) | Legal entity, as on MCA |
| Focus | Client name | [Client name] | Legal entity, as on MCA |
| Filled | Client name | [Client name] Ltd | Legal entity, as on MCA |
| Error | CIN | L00000XX0000 | CIN must be 21 characters (state.error, with icon) |
| Disabled | Engagement ID | KSA-RI-2026-001 | Assigned automatically |

Error messages say what is wrong and how to fix it. The CIN check validates the 21-character Corporate Identification Number format before submission.

### 7.8.3 Select

A 40 px field with a chevron. The menu opens on surface.raised at e2. Example: Sector, with BFSI selected, from All sectors, BFSI, Energy & utilities, Healthcare.

### 7.8.4 Selection controls

Checkbox, radio and toggle, each shown off, on, hover, focus and disabled.

| Rule | Value |
|---|---|
| Control size | 18 px |
| Hit area | 44 × 44 px |
| Label | Part of the target |
| Checkbox radius | 2 px |
| Examples | "Include FY24" (checkbox), "Annual" (toggle) |

### 7.8.5 Chips, segmented control, search and date

| Component | Specification | Example |
|---|---|---|
| Chips | Radius 999; count inside the chip | Risk · Due diligence 12 · ESG · FY25 |
| Segmented control | Radius 4; one segment selected | Quarter · Year · FYTD; List · Map |
| Search | Field with a search icon and a "/" keyboard shortcut hint | Search engagements, clients |
| Date range | Field showing the full range in Indian date order | 01 Apr 2025 – 31 Mar 2026 |

# 7.9 Components II: navigation and feedback

Navigation stays calm. Feedback speaks once, with a shape and a word.

## 7.9.1 Navigation in place

| No. | Component | Specification |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Top bar | 64 px high; primary navigation (Dashboard, Engagements, Insights), search, alerts and account avatar |
| 2 | Sidebar | Grouped items under an overline (WORKSPACE); the active item carries a 3 px saffron bar on its left edge; counts on the right (Engagements 2) |
| 3 | Breadcrumbs | Engagements / Crisis & Resilience / [Name] |
| 4 | Tabs | Active tab underlined with a 2 px saffron bar; counts in tabs (Findings 8) |
| 5 | Insight card | Content-type label (RISK INSIGHT), headline, meta ("6 min read · Sep 2026") |
| 6 | Engagement card | Cluster overline (CRISIS & RESILIENCE), project name, status tag (At risk), workstream, progress (Fieldwork 64%), team avatars, status (On track) |

The saffron bar in the sidebar and tabs is the one saffron element of the navigation. Do not add other saffron to the chrome.

## 7.9.2 Progress, steps, people and status

| Component | Specification | Example |
|---|---|---|
| Stepper | Numbered steps with state words | 01 Scope · Done; 02 Fieldwork · Done; 03 Review · Current; 04 Report · To do |
| Progress bar | Label, bar and percentage | Documents read 72%; Interviews 38% |
| Avatars | Initials in a pill, overlapping, with an overflow count | AB CD EF GH +3 |
| Person | Name and designation | [Full Name] · [Designation] |
| Status tags | Shape (dot) and word, never colour alone | Complete · Review · Overdue · Draft |
| Counts | Pill badges | 3 · 12 · 99+ |
| Pagination | Numbers with an ellipsis | 1 2 3 4 … 12 |

## 7.9.3 Alerts and toast

Shape and label, never colour alone. Each alert has an icon, a bold title and one line of detail.

| Type | Token | Example title | Detail |
|---|---|---|---|
| Info | state.info | New SEBI circular on related-party transactions | Applies to listed companies from 1 Jan 2027. |
| Success | state.success | Report shared with the client team | Read receipts from 4 of 5 recipients. |
| Warning | state.warning | Fieldwork is 6 days behind plan | Two site visits in [City] are still pending. |
| Error | state.error | Upload failed: file is over 25 MB | Compress the PDF or split it, then try again. |

Toast: surface.inverse (Deep Current on light UI, Sea Mist on dark UI), radius 8, e3, a state glyph, one line, one action and a close control. Example: "Draft saved · 14:32" with Undo.

## 7.9.4 Modal dialog

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Container | Radius 12 · e3 elevation |
| Scrim | Deep Current at 55% |
| Title | A question that names the action: "Withdraw this proposal?" |
| Body | The consequence and the way back: "[Client name] will no longer see it in their portal. You can restore it within 30 days." |
| Actions | Secondary "Cancel" and destructive "Withdraw", right aligned |

# 7.10 Reference screen 1: KSA Client Room portal

KSA Client Room gives a client one calm place to follow the engagement: progress, numbers, deliverables and the people doing the work. It is shown with sample data.

## 7.10.1 Setting

| Item | Value |
|---|---|
| URL | clientroom.kayaksa.com/[project]/overview |
| Theme | Light; page Sea Mist |
| Cards | White, radius 8, e1 |
| Grid | 12 columns, 64 px margin, 24 px gutter |
| Light theme roles | Page (Sea Mist), cards (white), borders (Fog), data and action (Open Water), headings (Deep Current), active (Beacon Saffron bar) |

## 7.10.2 Layout, top to bottom

| No. | Region | Content |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Navigation | 64 px top bar with search ("Search deliverables, people and files", ⌘K), alerts and account ([Full Name], [Designation], [Client name]). White sidebar headed CLIENT ROOM and [Client name] · Client workspace. WORKSPACE: Overview (active, 3 px saffron bar), Engagements, Deliverables, Data room, Meetings, Messages 3, Invoices. RESOURCES: KSA insights 4, Your KSA team (3 online), Help and support. Footer: ISO 27001 secured; Sign out. |
| 1a | Page header | Breadcrumb Engagements / Project [Name]. Title "Engagement overview". Meta: Commercial due diligence · Packaged foods; Week 6 of 10; Steering committee Thu 22 Oct, 11:00 IST. Actions: Export summary (secondary), Book a call (primary). |
| 2 | Metric cards | Four cards: context tag, value in Archivo Expanded, delta pill with a drawn triangle. |
| 3 | Engagement stepper | Done, current and next, with dates. Workstream bars carry the detail. |
| 4 | Exhibit card | Action title, unit, legend and source, like a slide. Crosshair and a Deep Current tooltip on hover. |
| 5 | Deliverables table | 50 px rows. Status tags pair a dot with a word, never colour alone. |

## 7.10.3 Metric cards

| Tag | Value | Delta and comparison |
|---|---|---|
| TARGET EV, BASE CASE | ₹1,240 cr | 4.2% vs IC memo · Range ±7% |
| SYNERGIES IDENTIFIED | ₹86 cr | ₹12 cr this week · Run-rate by FY28 |
| DELIVERABLES SIGNED OFF | 11 / 18 | 3 this week · 2 awaiting your review |
| DATA REQUESTS ON TIME | 92% | 3 pts vs plan · 31 of 34 closed |

## 7.10.4 Engagement progress

Phase 3 of 5.

| Step | Status |
|---|---|
| Kick-off and scoping | Completed 8 Sep |
| Market model | Completed 26 Sep |
| Customer diligence | In progress · due 23 Oct |
| Synergy case | Due 6 Nov |
| Final report | Due 17 Nov |

Workstreams: Market and competition, Complete; Customer interviews, 38 of 50; Operations and supply chain, 45%; Financial and synergy model, 30%.

## 7.10.5 Exhibit card

EXHIBIT 2. "Base case sits 8% below management plan by FY28". Revenue, ₹ crore, FY22–FY29E, with a Revenue / EBITDA / Volume switch. Series: KSA base case (Open Water), forecast (dotted), management plan (dashed

benchmark). Forecast callout at FY28E: KSA base ₹1,452 cr; Mgmt plan ₹1,580 cr; Gap −8.1%. Source: "[Client name] MIS FY22–FY25; KSA market model; KSA analysis".

A team panel lists the KSA team with initials avatars: Partner, engagement lead (LEAD); Director, commercial; Manager, customer diligence; Consultant, financial model; Analyst, data room.

### 7.10.6 Deliverables table

Filters: All 18 · Awaiting your review 2 · Signed off 11 · Filter · Upload file.

| Deliverable | Workstream | Owner | Due | Status |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Market sizing and growth outlook | Market and competition | GH [Full Name] | 26 Sep | Signed off |
| Customer interview synthesis, 38 of 50 | Customer diligence | IJ [Full Name] | 17 Oct | In review |
| Channel economics: modern trade vs. general trade | Customer diligence | IJ [Full Name] | 22 Oct | Due this week |
| Plant capacity and capex review | Operations | GH [Full Name] | 14 Oct | Overdue |
| Synergy case v1: procurement and logistics | Financial and synergy | KL [Full Name] | 29 Oct | Draft |

## 7.11 Reference screen 2: KSA Brand and Risk Monitor

A dark analytics theme for long monitoring sessions, shown in the Brand and Risk Monitor, a counterfeit-tracking tool. Sample data.

### 7.11.1 Setting

| Item | Value |
|---|---|
| URL | monitor.kayaksa.com/overview |
| Theme | Dark; page Deep Current |
| Sidebar | Undertow (surface.raised) |
| Cards | Storm Slate, radius 8 |
| Primary action | #3FB0A9 with Deep Current text |
| Focus | Beacon Saffron ring |
| Dark theme roles | Page, sidebar, cards, data and action, body, focus, high severity |

### 7.11.2 Layout

| Region | Content |
|---|---|
| Top bar | Search ("Search brands, listings, domains", ⌘K); live status "Live · scanned 4 min ago"; account |
| Sidebar | BRAND & RISK MONITOR. MONITOR: Overview (active), Detections 24, Takedowns, Domains, Marketplaces, Social and apps, Regions. WORKSPACE: Reports, Rules and alerts. Client switcher: [Client name], Managed Services |
| Header | "Counterfeit and brand-abuse overview"; "[Client name] · 14 marketplaces, 2,300 domains and 6 social platforms monitored"; Export report |
| Filters | Period segments 7D · 30D (active) · 90D · 12M; chips Platform All 14 · Category Home care · Severity High and above · Region All India · Clear all; date 17 Sep – 16 Oct |

### 7.11.3 The five panels

| No. | Panel | Specification |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Metric cards on Storm Slate | Values in white Archivo Expanded. On dark, delta pills switch to Lichen and Coral Flare to keep contrast. |
| 2 | Area chart | Data path #3FB0A9, gradient 12% to 0, grid Fog at 15%. One saffron point marks the peak. |
| 3 | Risk heat map | 5 × 5 matrix on the risk ramp, Kelp Green to Red Clay. Every cell carries its count. |
| 4 | Severity alerts | Icon, word and colour together. Rows link to the case, newest first within severity. |
| 5 | Region tiles | Equal hexagons per state, so small states stay readable. One saffron leader. |

### 7.11.4 Panel content

Metric cards:

| Tag | Value | Delta |
|---|---|---|
| LISTINGS SCANNED | 1.84 M | 12% vs previous 30 days |
| SUSPECTED COUNTERFEITS | 2,416 | 18% · festive sale spike |
| TAKEDOWNS ACTIONED | 1,982 | 9% · 82% of detections |
| MEDIAN TIME TO TAKEDOWN | 31 h | 6 h · target 36 h |

Area chart: "Detections tripled in the festive sale week"; suspected counterfeit listings per day, last 30 days; series "Detections per day" and "30-day average" (82). The festive sale week is shaded; the saffron peak reads "168 on 4 Oct · 3.1× the pre-sale run rate". Source: "KSA marketplace crawler, 14 platforms; KSA analysis".

Risk matrix, "Open cases by likelihood and impact":

| Likelihood ↓ / Impact → | Minimal | Minor | Moderate | Major | Severe |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Almost certain | – | 2 | 4 | 7 | 5 |
| Likely | 1 | 3 | 6 | 9 | 4 |
| Possible | 2 | 5 | 8 | 6 | 2 |
| Unlikely | 3 | 6 | 4 | 2 | 1 |
| Rare | 4 | 3 | 2 | 1 | – |

Caption: "Likely × Major holds 9 open cases". Legend from Low risk to Critical.

Priority alerts, sorted by severity, then age (tabs Open 24 · Assigned 9 · Resolved):

| Severity | Alert | Source and age |
|---|---|---|
| Critical | Counterfeit [Brand] detergent, 212 listings | Marketplaces · 12 min ago |
| Critical | Lookalike domain [brand]-offers.in takes payments | Domains · 38 min ago |
| High | Fake customer-care numbers on map listings, [City] | Search and maps · 2 h ago |
| High | Unauthorised distributor selling below MAP in [City] | Grey market · 5 h ago |
| Medium | Impersonation handle @[brand].offers | Social · 9 h ago |

Each row ends with a Review action.

Region tiles, "Where the fakes ship from", seller locations of suspected counterfeits, last 30 days. One hexagon per state, labelled with its two-letter code. Scale 0, 50, 250+ on a dark teal ramp (Undertow #1F4B5F, Deep Lagoon #0B5654, Open Water #17807E, #3FB0A9, Spray #CDE8E3). The leading state, Maharashtra, is the one saffron tile. Top 5 states: Maharashtra 412, Delhi 356, Gujarat 298, Uttar Pradesh 241, Telangana 188.

On a dashboard, the one-saffron rule applies per panel: one saffron peak in the area chart, one saffron leader in the region tiles. The risk ramp's saffron step is part of the ramp, not a highlight.

## 7.12 Reference screen 3: kayaksa.com insights

The website is where a reader first meets KSA thinking. Lead with one idea, prove it with evidence, then open the library.

### 7.12.1 Setting

| Item | Value |
|---|---|
| URL | www.kayaksa.com/insights |
| Navigation | Services · Industries · Insights · About us · Careers · Talk to us (primary) |
| Breakpoints | Mobile 390: 4 columns, 20 px margin · Tablet 768: 8 columns, 32 px margin · Desktop 1440: 12 columns, 64 px margin |

### 7.12.2 The five parts

| No. | Part | Specification |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Hero | Deep Current with the Current pattern fading in from the right. Archivo Expanded headline, serif |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | | standfirst, two CTAs. Example: "REPORT · TRANSACTIONS OUTLOOK 2026"; "India's next decade of deals will be won in diligence"; "We studied [x] mid-market transactions to find what separates the deals that create value from the ones that quietly destroy it."; Read the outlook · Download PDF · 24 pages. |
| 2 | Insight cards | A badge names the content type; each type keeps one pattern for its thumbnail. "Latest thinking" with filters All · Reports · Articles · Podcasts · Webinars · View all. |
| 3 | Featured exhibit | One chart a month, set like a page from a report: headline, unit, source. |
| 4 | Services row | The six cluster icons at 28 px over a hairline. Saffron marks the first. |
| 5 | Mobile web | One column, 48 px buttons, menu behind a 24 px icon. Headline drops to 28/34. |

### 7.12.3 One pattern per content type

| Content type | Thumbnail pattern |
|---|---|
| Report | Chart contours |
| Article | Wake lines |
| Podcast | Soundings |
| Case study | K-lattice |

Example cards: REPORT "How Indian boards should read a quality-of-earnings report", 24 pages · 12 Oct 2026; ARTICLE "SEBI's new related-party rules: what changes for promoter groups", 8 min read · 9 Oct 2026; PODCAST "Counterfeits at festive scale: what brands should watch", 32 min listen · 2 Oct 2026.

### 7.12.4 Featured exhibit

EXHIBIT 3. "Mid-market deal value has doubled since FY21". Mid-market deal value, ₹ thousand crore: FY21 38, FY22 51, FY23 47, FY24 58, FY25 66, FY26E 79. Text: "Deals between ₹100 and ₹1,000 crore now make up most of the market. They also carry most of the diligence risk." Action: Explore the data. Source: "Illustrative data. Source: [Deal database], company filings; KSA analysis."

### 7.12.5 Desktop to mobile

| Element | Desktop | Mobile |
|---|---|---|
| H1 | 40/48 | 28/34 |
| Standfirst | 19/29 | 17/26 |
| Button height | 40 px | 48 px |

### 7.12.6 Footer

Columns SERVICES (the six clusters), INSIGHTS (Reports, Articles, Podcasts, Events) and FIRM (About us, Careers, Leadership, Contact). Newsletter: "The Kayak Brief, monthly", work email field, Subscribe. Base line: "© 2026 Kayak Strategic Advisors · [City], India" and Privacy · Terms · Accessibility.

## 7.13 Reference screen 4: KSA mobile app

For partners and clients on the move: a morning briefing, reading, engagement status and alerts. The same tokens as the web, tuned for the thumb.

### 7.13.1 The four screens

| Screen | Theme | Content | Design point |
|---|---|---|---|
| A Home · briefing | Light | "Friday 16 October · Good morning". TODAY'S BRIEFING · 3 MIN: "Before Thursday's steering committee": 01 Base case is 8% below plan by FY28; 02 Customer interviews at 38 of 50; 03 Plant capex review is two days late. Project card: Target EV ₹1,240 cr (4.2%), Synergies ₹86 cr (₹12 cr), Open. "For you": REPORT "How boards should read a quality-of-earnings report" (24 pages · 12 Oct); ARTICLE | One saffron idea: the briefing numbers. |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | "SEBI's new related-party rules, explained" (8 min read · 9 Oct). | |
| B Insight reader | Light | ARTICLE · 8 min read. "SEBI's new related-party rules: what changes for promoter groups". Byline [Full Name], [Designation] · 9 Oct 2026. Exhibit 2: "Group loans will need approval three times as often"; transactions needing shareholder approval, multiple of FY25: Group loans 3.4×, Brand royalties 2.6×, Shared services 1.9×, Leases 1.2×. Source: SEBI circulars; KSA analysis of 120 listed groups. Reader controls: Aa (text size), Listen · 11 min. | Serif body 17/27. Exhibits keep their anatomy. |
| C Engagement dashboard | Light | Commercial due diligence, Project [Name]; tabs Overview · Deliverables · Team. Target EV, base case ₹1,240 cr, 4.2%, range ₹1,150–1,320 cr vs IC memo. Exhibit 2: base case 8% below plan by FY28 (revenue, ₹ crore; dashed: management plan; FY22, FY25, FY28E). Phase 3 of 5 · Customer diligence 60%. "Next: steering committee, Thu 22 Oct, 11:00", Add to calendar. | KPI, exhibit and next step in one scroll. |
| D Alerts | Dark | Alerts: All 24 · Critical 2 · High 6 · Medium 9. "Needs your decision: 2 takedowns", Approve. Feed: CRITICAL 12 min, Counterfeit [Brand] detergent, 212 listings on 2 marketplaces; CRITICAL 38 min, Lookalike domain takes payments, [brand]-offers.in, registered 3 days ago; HIGH 2h, Fake customer-care numbers, map listings in [City]; HIGH 5h, Below-MAP selling in [City], unauthorised distributor, 41 SKUs; MEDIUM 9h, Impersonation handle, @[brand].offers, 2,300 followers. | Severity by icon, word and edge. |

### 7.13.2 Five mobile rules

| No. | Rule | Specification |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Tab bar | Five tabs (Home, Insights, Work, Alerts, Profile), 24 px icons with labels. Active: Deep Current icon, saffron accent and a 2 px saffron bar. |
| 2 | 48 px targets | Every tappable thing is at least 48 × 48, even when the icon is 24. |
| 3 | 12 px cards | Mobile cards, sheets and modals use radius 12. Buttons stay at radius 4 and 48 high. |
| 4 | Dark alerts | Storm Slate cards on Deep Current. Severity colour on the left edge, never alone. |
| 5 | One primary action | A single full-width or right-aligned action per screen, in thumb reach. |

Mobile type follows the mobile column of the type scale in 7.3; reading text in the insight reader is set at 17/27.

## 7.14 Motion

Motion moves like a paddle stroke: a firm catch, then a long glide. Four tokens cover every case.

### 7.14.1 The paddle stroke

- Move only to explain: where something came from, where it went, what changed.
- Firm start, gliding finish: curves accelerate hard and settle long. No bounce, no overshoot.
- Fast in, faster out. No interface transition takes longer than 480 ms.
- One moving idea per moment; the rest of the page holds still.

### 7.14.2 Duration and easing tokens

| Token | Duration | Easing | Use | CSS variable |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| motion.micro | 120 ms | ease-out | Hover, press, tooltip, toggles | --ksa-motion-micro: 120ms ease-out |
| motion.standard | 200 ms | cubic-bezier(.2,0,0,1) | Menus, tabs, cards, toasts | --ksa-motion-standard: 200ms cubic-bezier(.2,0,0,1) |
| motion.paddle | 320 ms | cubic-bezier(.3,0,0,1) | Blade wipe, panels, | --ksa-motion-paddle: 320ms cubic- |

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | emphasis | bezier(.3,0,0,1) |
| motion.page | 480 ms | cubic-bezier(.2,0,0,1) | Route change, large sheets | --ksa-motion-page: 480ms cubic-bezier(.2,0,0,1) |

### 7.14.3 Signature transitions

| Transition | Specification | Storyboard |
|---|---|---|
| Blade wipe | A 62° edge sweeps across on motion.paddle (320 ms). Used for section changes. | 0 · 80 · 160 · 240 · 320 ms |
| Wake-line loader | Fog skeleton with wake lines at 62° passing across, 1200 ms loop | 0 · 300 · 600 · 900 · 1200 ms |
| Chart draw-on | Left to right, 600 ms on the standard curve; the end marker appears last | 0 · 150 · 300 · 450 · 600 ms |
| Number count-up | Tabular figures, 600 ms on the standard curve | ₹0 → ₹250 → ₹362 → ₹402 → ₹412 crore at 0 · 150 · 300 · 450 · 600 ms |
| Tooltip | Fade + 4 px rise, motion.micro (120 ms) | 0 · 40 · 80 · 120 ms |

The 480 ms ceiling applies to interface transitions. Data reveals (chart draw-on and count-up) run at 600 ms on the standard curve, and loaders loop until content arrives.

### 7.14.4 Choreography

| Rule | Specification |
|---|---|
| Stagger lists | 40 ms between items, maximum 5 items: card 1 at +0 ms, card 2 +40, card 3 +80, card 4 +120, card 5 +160 |
| Exit before enter | Exit is a 120 ms fade on motion.micro. Enter is 320 ms on motion.paddle, starting at 80 ms, so the two overlap by 40 ms. |

### 7.14.5 Reduced motion

When the user's system asks for reduced motion, motion becomes fades only.

| Element | Reduced-motion behaviour |
|---|---|
| Wipes, slides, draw-ons | Become a 120 ms cross-fade |
| Count-ups | Show the final figure at once |
| Loaders | Stay static with a text label |
| Loops | None runs over 5 s |
| Tokens | The CSS file sets motion.standard, motion.paddle and motion.page to 120ms linear under prefers-reduced-motion: reduce |

## 7.15 Accessibility and inclusion

Clarity for every reader is part of the brand. We design to WCAG 2.2 AA and test with real assistive technology.

### 7.15.1 Contrast matrix

WCAG 2.2: AA 4.5:1, AAA 7:1, large text 3:1. Ratios are for text on background.

| Text ↓ / Background → | White | Sea Mist | Haze | Deep Current | Storm Slate | Undertow |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Deep Current | 14.1 AAA | 12.6 AAA | 12.0 AAA | – | 1.8 Fail | 1.5 Fail |
| Storm Slate | 7.8 AAA | 7.0 AAA | 6.7 AA | 1.8 Fail | – | 1.2 Fail |
| Deep Lagoon | 8.5 AAA | 7.6 AAA | 7.2 AAA | 1.7 Fail | 1.1 Fail | 1.1 Fail |
| Open Water | 4.7 AA | 4.3 Large | 4.0 Large | 3.0 Fail | 1.6 Fail | 2.0 Fail |
| Tidewater Blue | 5.7 AA | 5.1 AA | 4.9 AA | 2.5 Fail | 1.4 Fail | 1.6 Fail |
| Kelp Green | 5.0 AA | 4.5 Large | 4.3 Large | 2.8 Fail | 1.6 Fail | 1.9 Fail |
| Red Clay | 5.4 AA | 4.9 AA | 4.6 AA | 2.6 Fail | 1.4 Fail | 1.7 Fail |
| Burnished Gold | 5.0 AA | 4.5 Large | 4.2 Large | 2.8 Fail | 1.6 Fail | 1.9 Fail |
| Beacon Saffron | 2.2 Fail | 2.0 Fail | 1.9 Fail | 6.3 AA | 3.5 Large | 4.2 Large |

| | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| White | – | 1.1 Fail | 1.2 Fail | 14.1 AAA | 7.8 AAA | 9.4 AAA |

Two rules follow from the matrix:

- Open Water passes on white, not on Sea Mist. On Sea Mist, small text and links use Deep Lagoon.
- Saffron is never text on light.

### 7.15.2 Colour-blind check

The categorical palette (1 Open Water, 2 Tidewater Blue, 3 Kelp Green, 4 Storm Slate, 5 Estuary Sand, 6 Dusk Plum, 7 Shallows, 8 Lichen) is simulated for normal vision, deuteranopia and protanopia.

| Closest pair under deuteranopia | ΔE |
|---|---|
| 4 Storm Slate / 6 Dusk Plum | 11 |
| 1 Open Water / 4 Storm Slate | 13 |

Never place 4 next to 6. Label lines and slices directly.

### 7.15.3 Focus indicators

Never remove focus. Never show focus by colour alone.

| Theme | Indicator |
|---|---|
| Light | 2 px Deep Current ring with a 2 px white gap |
| Dark | 2 px Beacon Saffron ring with a 2 px gap |

### 7.15.4 Never colour alone

Line style, marker, label, glyph and sign carry meaning; colour only confirms it.

| Meaning | Carried by |
|---|---|
| Series (Open Water, Tidewater, Kelp) | Direct labels at the line ends |
| Actual versus forecast | Solid versus dotted line |
| Status (Complete, Review, Overdue, Note) | Shape and word |
| Change (+12.4%, –3.1%) | Sign and glyph (▲ ▼) |

### 7.15.5 Minimum sizes

| Item | Minimum |
|---|---|
| UI text | 12 px |
| Print sources | 9 pt |
| Body text default | 16 px |
| Touch targets | 44 px minimum; 48 px on web mobile and Android |

### 7.15.6 Motion and language

- Reduced motion: fades only. Nothing loops past 5 s or flashes more than 3 times a second.
- Plain English. Spell out RBI, SEBI and MCA on first use on each page.
- Write ₹ crore and lakh with Indian digit grouping: ₹1,24,500.
- Write labels as verbs or nouns, not jargon: "Export report", not "Execute".

### 7.15.7 Quick checklist

- Text 4.5:1; large text 3:1; graphics 3:1.
- Focus visible on every control.
- Series and states labelled as well as coloured.
- Touch targets 44 px or more.
- Chart titles state the insight.
- Alt text says what a chart shows.
- Headings and reading order are logical.

- Reduced-motion setting honoured.

## 7.16 Implementation checklist

- Import ksa-tokens.css once; set data-theme="dark" on the html element for dark products.
- Use semantic tokens in components, never palette variables or raw hex.
- One primary button per view; one saffron element in the chrome (the active bar).
- Cards on the right elevation: e0 tables, e1 cards, e2 menus and popovers, e3 modals and toasts.
- Layout on the breakpoint grid, content capped at 1312 px.
- Buttons 40 px on web, 48 px on mobile; every target 44 px or more (48 px on Android and mobile web).
- Status always as shape and word; alerts with an icon and a title.
- Motion from the four tokens; reduced motion honoured.
- Every chart built to the anatomy in chapter 06.

CHAPTER 08

# Applications: corporate presentations and thought-leadership reports

The boardroom deck and the published report are where clients judge us most closely. This chapter sets out the two systems that carry most of our work. The first is a 16:9 slide system built like a consulting report: one message per slide, stated in the title and proved by the exhibit. The second is an A4 thought-leadership system that reads like a good book: calm pages, a serif voice and exhibits that carry the argument. Both use the same grammar as the rest of these guidelines. They sit on a 12-column grid, follow the 8-point scale, use Archivo for structure and Source Serif 4 for voice, and allow one Beacon Saffron accent per view. Build every deck from the master template and every report from the report template. Never start from a blank file.

## 8.1 Shared rules for decks and reports

Decks and reports follow the same reading logic. A reader should be able to take the titles alone and follow the argument.

### 8.1.1 One message per view

- Each slide makes one point. Each report spread makes one point.
- The title states the point as a full sentence. The exhibit proves it. The so-what or the body text explains what follows from it.
- If a slide or spread needs two titles, it is two slides or two spreads.

### 8.1.2 Pacing

The pacing rules from Chapter 03 apply to both formats.

| Rule | Deck | Report |
|---|---|---|
| Open and close | Open on dark, read on light, close on dark | Open on dark, read on light, close on dark |
| Data runs | Three data slides in a row at most, then a beacon or a breather | Three data pages in a row at most, then a beacon or a breather |
| Chapter structure | One section divider per section | One opener per chapter; chapters run three to five pages |
| Density | Change density every five to seven slides | Change density every five to seven pages |
| Reference map | 20-slide board deck: frame, three chapters (diagnosis, options, plan), close | 16-page report: front, two parts, back |

### 8.1.3 Colour, pattern and the beacon

| Element | Deck | Report |
|---|---|---|
| Dark grounds | Cover, section dividers, closing | Cover, chapter openers, back cover |
| Light grounds | All content slides: white or Sea Mist #EEF4F1 | All body and exhibit pages: white; sidebars in Sea Mist |
| Patterns | Two per deck at most: one for cover and closing, one for section dividers | One per report: the cover's, reused on the openers and back cover |
| Beacon Saffron #EE9B1E | One highlight per slide | One highlight per page or spread |
| Saffron as text | Only on Deep Current #0E2F3C | Only on Deep Current #0E2F3C |
| Corner radius | 0 on every brand graphic, chart and image | 0 on every brand graphic, chart and image |

### 8.1.4 Exhibit anatomy

Every exhibit in a deck or a report keeps the same parts, in the same order, as set out in Chapter 06.

| Part | Content | Rule |
|---|---|---|
| Exhibit number | "EXHIBIT 4" | Archivo SemiBold caps, top left of the exhibit |
| Insight headline | The finding, as a sentence | On a slide the action title carries the insight; in a report the exhibit title does |
| Subtitle and unit | "Incremental category revenue by channel, FY25–FY29E, ₹ crore" | Always states the unit and the period |
| Direct labels | Values on or beside the marks | No legends where a direct label fits |
| Highlight | One Beacon Saffron mark | One per exhibit, and one per view |
| Source | "Source: Retail audit panel FY22–FY25; KSA channel model; KSA analysis" | Every exhibit; ends with "KSA analysis" where we did the work |
| Notes | "Note: deals can show more than one flag." | Before the source on the same line or the line above |

## 8.2 The 16:9 presentation system

Our decks are built like consulting reports. The title says what the slide proves. The exhibit proves it. A short so-what tells the committee what to do with it.

### 8.2.1 Canvas and grid

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Canvas | 1920 × 1080 px, 16:9 |
| Side margins | 128 px left and right |
| Top margin | 96 px |
| Bottom margin | 64 px |
| Live area | 1664 × 920 px (x 128 to 1792, y 96 to 1016) |
| Columns | 12 columns of 102 px |
| Gutters | 40 px |
| Spacing unit | 8 px; every gap is a step on the 8-point scale |
| Template file | DG-03_Deck_v1.0.potx (register code KSA-DG-03) |

Twelve columns of 102 px plus eleven gutters of 40 px fill the 1664 px live width exactly: 1224 + 440 = 1664.

### 8.2.2 Column positions

Use these x positions when you place objects by number. The master layouts already have guides at every column edge.

| Column | Left edge, px | Right edge, px |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | 128 | 230 |
| 2 | 270 | 372 |
| 3 | 412 | 514 |
| 4 | 554 | 656 |
| 5 | 696 | 798 |
| 6 | 838 | 940 |
| 7 | 980 | 1082 |
| 8 | 1122 | 1224 |
| 9 | 1264 | 1366 |
| 10 | 1406 | 1508 |
| 11 | 1548 | 1650 |
| 12 | 1690 | 1792 |

### 8.2.3 Column spans

| Span | Width, px | Typical use |
|---|---|---|
| 3 columns | 386 | Sidebar, so-what panel, contact block |
| 4 columns | 528 | One module of a 4 + 4 + 4 slide |
| 5 columns | 670 | Text column of a Current slide (5 + 7) |
| 6 columns | 812 | Smallest exhibit width; half of a Confluence split |
| 7 columns | 954 | Exhibit column of a Current slide (5 + 7) |
| 8 columns | 1096 | Agenda list; wide exhibit with a 3-column so-what and one empty column |
| 9 columns | 1238 | Exhibit beside a 3-column so-what (9 + 3) |
| 12 columns | 1664 | Full-width exhibit, big number, title |

Grid rules:

- An exhibit on a slide spans at least 6 of the 12 columns. A sidebar spans 3.
- Text and exhibits snap to columns. Only images and patterns bleed to the canvas edge.
- Gutters never shrink to fit more content. Cut the content instead.

### 8.2.4 Vertical zones

Every content slide has the same four zones from top to bottom.

| Zone | Position | Content |
|---|---|---|
| Tracker | Top left, inside the 96 px top margin | Section number and name in caps, for example "02 MARKET AND COMPETITION" |
| Title zone | From y 96 | The action title, one or two lines at 48/56 px, so 56 to 112 px deep |
| Content zone | Below the title zone, on the 12 columns | Exhibit, text, so-what panel |
| Source zone | Bottom of the live area, above the 64 px bottom margin | Source line at 16/22 px, then the identifier and the page number |

The identifier and page number close every content slide. The source line sits in the source zone, never inside the chart.

### 8.2.5 Type on slides

All sizes are in pixels on the 1920 × 1080 canvas.

| Role | Size / leading, px | Face and weight | Rule |
|---|---|---|---|
| Cover title | 104/110 | Archivo Expanded | Sentence case; covers and closing only |
| Action title | 48/56 | Archivo Bold | One or two lines; never below 40 px |
| Body | 24–26/36 | Archivo Regular | Never below 20 px; split the slide instead |
| Big number | 300 | Archivo Expanded 800 | One number per slide; unit at 40–50% of the figure |
| Quote | 72/90 | Source Serif 4 Italic | Named author below in Archivo |
| Chart labels | 20 | Archivo Regular or Medium | Tabular figures |
| Source line | 16/22 | Archivo Regular | "Source: ...; KSA analysis" |
| Tracker and eyebrows | Caps, tracked | Archivo SemiBold | Section name top left; labels such as "EXHIBIT 4" and "SO WHAT" |

Type rules:

- Left aligned, ragged right. Centre only short display lines on covers.
- Archivo Expanded only at 20 px and above. In practice it appears only in the cover title and the big number.
- Three weights at most on a slide: 400, 600 and 700. The big number is the one place Archivo Expanded 800 appears.
- If text will not fit at 20 px, the slide is carrying two messages. Split it.

### 8.2.6 Slide rules

1. One message per slide. The title says it as a full sentence. Read the titles alone and the story holds.
2. Titles take one or two lines and never shrink below 40 px.

3. Body text never goes below 20 px. Split the slide instead.
4. Two patterns per deck at most: one for the cover and closing, one for the section dividers.
5. One saffron highlight per slide.
6. Every exhibit carries a source line in the source zone.
7. A tracker names the section top left. The identifier and the page number close every content slide.

# 8.3 The eight core slide layouts

The master template holds eight core layouts. Almost every deck we write can be built from these eight. Each layout below gives its purpose, its grid, its content and its rules, with the worked example from the published guidelines: a commercial due diligence read-out to a steering committee.

| No. | Layout | Ground | Pattern | Signature |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | Cover | Deep Current | Pattern 1: Chart contours | Project name, purpose, date, confidentiality |
| 02 | Agenda | White | None | Saffron marks the current item |
| 03 | Section divider | Deep Current | Pattern 2: Chevron wake | Section number and name |
| 04 | Insight + exhibit | White | None | Title, exhibit, so-what |
| 05 | Three columns | White or Sea Mist | None | 4 + 4 + 4 grid |
| 06 | Big number | White | None | One number, one line |
| 07 | Quote | White or Sea Mist | None | Serif italic 72/90 |
| 08 | Closing | Deep Current | Pattern 1 returns | Thank you and named contacts |

## 8.3.1 Layout 01: Cover

Purpose: names the engagement, the meeting and the date. It sets the deck's first pattern.

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Ground | Deep Current #0E2F3C |
| Pattern | Pattern 1, Chart contours (pattern 11 in the library), in the Brand strength. The same pattern returns on the closing slide |
| Project name | "Project [Name]": the engagement's code name |
| Cover title | Archivo Expanded 104/110 px, white, sentence case. Example: "Market and competition" |
| Purpose line | Archivo Regular, white or Spray. Example: "Commercial due diligence · Steering committee 3" |
| Date and classification | Archivo SemiBold caps, tracked. Example: "22 OCTOBER 2026 · STRICTLY CONFIDENTIAL" |
| Logo | Reversed full logo with 2X clear space |
| Beacon | One saffron element at most, usually the right blade of the identifier |

Rules:

- No exhibit, number or photograph on the cover.
- The pattern stays clear of the title and the logo's clear space.

## 8.3.2 Layout 02: Agenda

Purpose: shows the committee how the time will be spent and where the decisions sit. Saffron marks where we are now.

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Ground | White |
| Title | Action title 48/56 px. It states the shape of the meeting, for example "Ninety minutes. Two decisions needed from the committee, flagged in section 5." |
| Agenda list | Numbered items in Archivo, number in Archivo Bold, duration ranged right in the same row |
| Current item | One Beacon Saffron marker on the item now being covered. On a repeated agenda slide, the marker moves |
| Durations | Minutes, in Archivo Regular, tabular figures |

Worked example:

| No. | Item | Time |
|---|---|---|
| 01 | Where we are | 10 min |
| 02 | Market and competition | 20 min |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 03 | Customer diligence: first read | 25 min |
| 04 | Synergy hypotheses | 15 min |
| 05 | Decisions and next steps | 10 min |

The durations add to 80 minutes in a 90-minute meeting. Leave the slack in. Repeat the agenda at the start of each section with the saffron marker moved on to the current item.

### 8.3.3 Layout 03: Section divider

Purpose: resets attention between sections. It is the deck's breather.

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Ground | Deep Current #0E2F3C |
| Pattern | Pattern 2, Chevron wake (pattern 06 in the library). Used on every divider in the deck and nowhere else |
| Section number | "02", Archivo Expanded, white |
| Eyebrow | "SECTION", Archivo SemiBold caps |
| Section title | Archivo Expanded, white, sentence case. Example: "Market and competition" |
| Page number | Bottom right, as on content slides |

Rules:

- One divider per section. Do not use dividers inside a section.
- No body text, no exhibit.

### 8.3.4 Layout 04: Insight + exhibit

Purpose: our working slide. It states a finding, proves it with one exhibit and says what follows.

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Ground | White |
| Tracker | Top left: "02 MARKET AND COMPETITION" |
| Action title | 48/56 px Archivo Bold, one or two lines, the finding as a full sentence |
| Exhibit | At least 6 columns; usually 9 columns with a 3-column so-what, or 7 columns beside a 5-column text block |
| Exhibit label | "EXHIBIT 4", then the subtitle with period and unit |
| So-what panel | 3 columns, eyebrow "SO WHAT", then three short lines. The first line carries the number |
| Highlight | The one bar or line that proves the title, in Beacon Saffron. All other marks in Open Water or the context grey |
| Source | Source zone, 16/22 px |
| Close | Identifier and page number, bottom right |

Worked example:

- Action title: "Modern trade will carry 42% of category growth by FY29, yet the target sells only 18% of volume there."
- Exhibit 4: "Incremental category revenue by channel, FY25–FY29E, ₹ crore".

| Channel | Incremental revenue, ₹ crore |
|---|---|
| General trade | 160 |
| Modern trade (highlighted) | 340 |
| E-commerce | 210 |
| Quick commerce | 90 |

- Axis: 0 to 400, zero baseline, gridlines at 100.
- So what: "Modern trade adds ₹340 cr, 42% of growth"; "Shelf space, not price, drives share"; "Target under-indexes in MT by 9 pts".
- Source: "Retail audit panel FY22–FY25; KSA channel model; KSA analysis". Page 09.

Rules:

- The highlighted mark is the one the title names. If the title names two things, the slide makes two points.
- The so-what never repeats the title. It gives the number, the cause and the implication.

### 8.3.5 Layout 05: Three columns (4 + 4 + 4)

Purpose: options, pillars, workstreams or service lines. This is the Delta composition from Chapter 03.

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Ground | White or Sea Mist |
| Eyebrow | Section name, for example "APPROACH" |
| Action title | 48/56 px. Example: "Three workstreams answer one question: is ₹1,240 crore the right price?" |
| Modules | Three modules of 4 columns each, 528 px wide, 40 px gutters |
| Module content | Name in Archivo Bold; two short sentences in body type; a caps label at the foot |
| Beacon | One module may carry the beacon. The other two stay neutral |
| Close | Tracker top left; identifier and page number bottom right |

Worked example:

| Module | Description | Label |
|---|---|---|
| Market model | Size and growth by channel, region and price tier. Where the target can win. | READ-OUT · WEEK 3 |
| Customer diligence | 50 interviews with distributors, retailers and buyers. What the market really thinks. | READ-OUT · WEEK 7 |
| Synergy case | Procurement, logistics and overhead. What is bankable, and when. | READ-OUT · WEEK 9 |

Rules:

- Three modules, never four on this layout. Four items need a different layout or two slides.
- Modules align at the top and share one baseline for their labels.

### 8.3.6 Layout 06: Big number

Purpose: one headline metric, with context in a narrow column. This is the Beacon composition from Chapter 03.

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Ground | White |
| Eyebrow | Section name, for example "SYNERGY CASE" |
| Big number | Archivo Expanded 800 at 300 px. Unit at 40–50% of the figure size. Example: "₹86 cr" |
| Supporting line | One line in body type below or beside the number. Example: "of run-rate synergies identified by FY28, 70% of them in procurement and logistics" |
| Breakdown | Optional: up to three component values in a narrow column |
| Source | Source zone, 16/22 px |
| Beacon | The big number may carry the saffron, or one component may. Never both |

Worked example:

| Component | Value |
|---|---|
| Procurement | ₹38 cr |
| Logistics | ₹22 cr |
| Overheads and other | ₹26 cr |
| Total run-rate synergies by FY28 | ₹86 cr |

Source: "Management accounts FY25; supplier quotes; KSA synergy model v1". Page 14. Procurement and logistics give ₹60 cr of the ₹86 cr, which is the 70% in the supporting line. Check that components add to the total before the slide leaves the studio.

Rules:

- One number per slide. A second number goes on the next slide or in the breakdown.
- The number is in Indian format for Indian readers: ₹1,234 cr, ₹12.4 lakh cr.

### 8.3.7 Layout 07: Quote

Purpose: a breather that puts a client, an expert or a partner in the room.

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Ground | White or Sea Mist |
| Quote | Source Serif 4 Italic, 72/90 px, Deep Current |
| Quote marks | Opened by an Open Water blade mark, closed by a Beacon Saffron mark, as in Chapter 05 |
| Attribution | "[Full Name]" in Archivo Bold; "[Designation], Kayak Strategic Advisors" in Archivo Regular |
| Close | Identifier and page number |

Worked example: "Good advice is a decision a board can defend, not a study it has to read." [Full Name], [Designation], Kayak Strategic Advisors.

Rules:

- The quote is real and attributed by name. Anonymous quotes from interviews carry a role, for example "Category head, national retailer".
- Three lines at most at 72/90 px. Longer quotes go in a body slide.

### 8.3.8 Layout 08: Closing

Purpose: ends the deck on dark and tells the reader who to call.

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Ground | Deep Current #0E2F3C |
| Pattern | Pattern 1 returns: the cover's Chart contours |
| Title | "Thank you", Archivo Expanded, white |
| Contacts | Two named contacts: "[Full Name]", "[Designation]", "name@kayaksa.com" in white and Spray |
| Logo | Reversed full logo with 2X clear space |
| Page number | Bottom right |

Rules:

- Name people. Never close on a generic inbox alone.
- No new content on the closing slide.

## 8.4 Building a deck

### 8.4.1 Deck structure

Use the 20-slide board deck in Chapter 03 as the reference shape.

| Part | Slides | Layouts |
|---|---|---|
| Frame | Cover, agenda | 01, 02 |
| Each section | Divider, then content | 03, then 04, 05, 06, 07 |
| Close | Decisions, next steps, closing | 04 or 05, then 08 |

### 8.4.2 Common faults and fixes

| Fault | Fix |
|---|---|
| Title is a topic ("Market overview") | Rewrite as the finding in a full sentence |
| Text shrunk below 20 px to fit | Split the slide |
| Title shrunk below 40 px | Shorten the title to two lines |
| Two or more saffron marks | Keep the one the title names; return the rest to Open Water or the context grey |
| A third pattern in the deck | Remove it; patterns belong only to cover, closing and dividers |
| Exhibit under 6 columns | Widen it, or move the text to the so-what panel |
| No source line | Add one in the source zone, or remove the exhibit |
| Legend on a simple chart | Replace with direct labels |

### 8.4.3 Files

| Item | Code | File | Owner |
|---|---|---|---|
| Presentation template | KSA-DG-03 | DG-03_Deck_v1.0.potx: 16:9 master layouts, full-colour logo | Brand lead |

Save working decks with the production naming pattern KSA_Type_Topic_Version_Date, for example KSA_Deck_ProjectName-SteerCo3_v1.2_2026-10-22. Embed fonts or export to PDF before sending.

# 8.5 The A4 thought-leadership system

Our reports read like a good book. The pages are calm, the voice is serif and the exhibits carry the argument. The same system serves sector outlooks, points of view and research reports.

## 8.5.1 Page and grid

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Page | A4 portrait, 210 × 297 mm |
| Side margins | 15 mm left and right |
| Top margin | 20 mm |
| Foot margin | 22 mm |
| Live area | 180 × 255 mm |
| Columns | 12 |
| Column width | 11.33 mm (136 mm of column space ÷ 12) |
| Gutters | 4 mm |
| Baseline | 12 pt (4.23 mm); about 60 baselines in the live area |
| Bleed | 3 mm on every edge for print |

Body text sits on the 12 pt baseline. Every element snaps to it.

## 8.5.2 Column spans

| Span | Width, mm | Typical use |
|---|---|---|
| 1 column | 11.33 | Hanging numbers, margin marks |
| 3 columns | 42.00 | Running notes, small captions |
| 4 columns | 57.33 | Sidebar box in Sea Mist; a third of the page |
| 6 columns | 88.00 | Half page; one of two text columns |
| 8 columns | 118.67 | Main text column beside a 4-column sidebar |
| 12 columns | 180.00 | Full-width exhibit, chapter title, cover title |

Columns start at 15 mm from the left trim and repeat every 15.33 mm (11.33 mm column plus 4 mm gutter).

## 8.5.3 Type in reports

All sizes are in points.

| Role | Size / leading, pt | Face and weight |
|---|---|---|
| Cover title | 40/44 | Archivo Expanded |
| Chapter title | 32/36 | Archivo Expanded |
| Heading | 18/22 | Archivo Bold |
| Standfirst | 13/18 | Source Serif 4 Regular |
| Body | 9.5/12 | Source Serif 4 Regular |
| Pull quote | 18/24 | Source Serif 4 Italic |
| Exhibit title | 16/20 | Archivo Bold |
| Source, notes | 7/9 | Archivo Regular |
| Running header | Caps, tracked | Archivo SemiBold |

Type rules:

- Body never below 9 pt. Notes and sources never below 7 pt.
- Left aligned, ragged right, never justified. 60–75 characters a line; the 6-column and 8-column measures keep body text inside that range.
- Numbers in tables and exhibits use tabular figures.

## 8.5.4 Running elements

| Element | Position | Content |
|---|---|---|
| Running header, left | Top margin, column 1 | Report title in caps: "TRANSACTIONS OUTLOOK 2026" |
| Running header, right | Top margin, ranged right | Chapter name in caps: "WHERE DILIGENCE FAILS" |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Footer | Foot margin | "KSA Insights" and the folio |
| Identifier | Foot margin | Signs off every page |

The cover, chapter openers and back cover carry no running header.

### 8.5.5 Report rules

1. Body sits on a 12 pt baseline; every element snaps to it.
2. One idea per spread.
3. The pull quote is a line from the text, never a new claim.
4. One pattern per report: the cover's, reused on the chapter openers and the back cover.
5. Exhibits keep their anatomy: number, headline, unit, source.
6. Body never below 9 pt; notes and sources never below 7 pt.
7. Sidebars sit in Sea Mist, four columns wide.

## 8.6 The six report page types

The report template holds six page types plus the master grid. The worked example is "Transactions Outlook 2026: India's next decade of deals".

| No. | Page type | Ground | Signature |
|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | Cover | Deep Current | Current pattern, title 40 pt |
| 02 | Contents | White | Chapters and exhibits |
| 03 | Chapter opener | Deep Current | Number, title, standfirst |
| 04 | Body spread | White | Serif 9.5/12, pull quote, sidebar box |
| 05 | Exhibit page | White | Exhibit at full width |
| 06 | Back cover | Deep Current | Identifier, contact, logo |
| 07 | A4 grid | n/a | 15 / 20 / 22 mm margins, 4 mm gutter, 12 columns, 12 pt baseline |

### 8.6.1 Page type 01: Cover

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Ground | Deep Current #0E2F3C |
| Pattern | Current (pattern 09 in the library), Brand strength. The report's only pattern |
| Series line | Caps eyebrow: "TRANSACTIONS OUTLOOK 2026" |
| Cover title | Archivo Expanded 40/44 pt, white, sentence case: "India's next decade of deals" |
| Subtitle | Source Serif 4, 13/18 pt: "What [x] mid-market transactions teach boards about diligence" |
| Imprint | "KSA Insights · October 2026" and "www.kayaksa.com" |
| Logo | Reversed full logo with 2X clear space |
| Finish in print | Spot UV for the pattern, tone on tone |

### 8.6.2 Page type 02: Contents

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Ground | White |
| Title | "Contents", chapter-title style |
| Chapter list | Number, title and page, one line each, page numbers ranged right in tabular figures |
| Exhibit list | Eyebrow "EXHIBITS", then exhibit number and title |

Worked example:

| No. | Chapter | Page |
|---|---|---|
| 01 | Executive summary | 4 |
| 02 | The mid-market moment | 8 |
| 03 | Where diligence fails | 16 |
| 04 | Five questions for boards | 24 |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 05 | Methodology | 30 |


| Exhibit | Title |
|---|---|
| Exhibit 1 | Deal value by size band, FY21–FY26 |
| Exhibit 2 | Deals by sector and ownership |
| Exhibit 3 | Red flags found after close |
| Exhibit 4 | Where the red flag was visible |
| Exhibit 5 | Diligence spend vs. deal outcome |

### 8.6.3 Page type 03: Chapter opener

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Ground | Deep Current #0E2F3C, carrying the cover's pattern |
| Chapter number | "03" in Archivo Expanded, with the eyebrow "CHAPTER" |
| Chapter title | Archivo Expanded 32/36 pt, white: "Where diligence fails" |
| Standfirst | Source Serif 4 13/18 pt: "Most deals that disappoint did not hide their problems. The red flags sat in the data room, in plain sight, and nobody was asked to look." |
| Key figures | Up to three figures with one-line labels |
| Beacon | One figure may carry the saffron |

Worked example of the key figures:

| Figure | Label |
|---|---|
| [x]% | of deals hit a red flag |
| ₹[x] cr | value written down |
| [x] in 10 | flags visible pre-close |

### 8.6.4 Page type 04: Body spread

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Ground | White |
| Heading | Archivo Bold 18/22 pt: "Red flags hide in working capital" |
| Standfirst | Source Serif 4 13/18 pt: "Receivable days rose in the year before sale in a third of the deals that failed. It was the most common signal, and the least examined." |
| Body | Source Serif 4 9.5/12 pt on the 12 pt baseline |
| Pull quote | Source Serif 4 Italic 18/24 pt, a line from the text with a named author: "The numbers were right. The question was wrong." [Full Name], [Designation] |
| Sidebar box | Sea Mist, four columns (57.33 mm) wide. Eyebrow "CASE IN POINT", heading, two figures |
| Notes | Numbered, 7/9 pt, at the foot of the column |

Sidebar worked example: "A mid-market deal, and the receivable days nobody checked", with "[x] extra receivable days" and "[x] ₹ crore tied up".

Note worked examples: "1. Receivable days measured on the trailing twelve months, not at year end." "2. KSA analysis of [x] deals, FY21–FY26." A box headed "What boards should ask" may follow the notes.

### 8.6.5 Page type 05: Exhibit page

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Ground | White |
| Exhibit number | "EXHIBIT 4" |
| Exhibit title | Archivo Bold 16/20 pt, the finding as a sentence |
| Subtitle and unit | Archivo Regular, with the base: "% (n = [x])" |
| Exhibit | Full width, 12 columns, 180 mm |
| Highlight | One bar in Beacon Saffron; the rest in Open Water |
| Note and source | 7/9 pt at the foot |

Worked example: "Working capital is the red flag boards miss most often". Subtitle: "Share of failed deals where the red flag was visible before close, % (n = [x])".

| Red flag | Share of failed deals |
|---|---|
| Working capital (highlighted) | 38% |
| Customer concentration | 31% |
| Related parties | 27% |
| Regulatory licences | 19% |
| IT and data | 14% |
| Key people | 11% |

Note: "Deals can show more than one flag." Source: "Deal databases, company filings, [x] practitioner interviews; KSA analysis." Bars are sorted largest first, on a zero baseline, with direct labels.

### 8.6.6 Page type 06: Back cover

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Ground | Deep Current #0E2F3C, carrying the cover's pattern |
| Positioning line | "Kayak Strategic Advisors helps boards and investors make decisions they can defend." |
| Contact | "[City], India"; "insights@kayaksa.com · www.kayaksa.com" |
| Copyright | "© 2026 Kayak Strategic Advisors" |
| Marks | Identifier and reversed full logo, each with 2X clear space |

### 8.6.7 Page type 07: the A4 grid

The seventh panel in the template is the master grid itself: 15 mm sides, 20 mm top, 22 mm foot, 12 columns, 4 mm gutters and a 12 pt baseline. Turn its guides on before placing anything.

## 8.7 Building a report

### 8.7.1 Report structure

Use the 16-page report in Chapter 03 as the reference shape.

| Part | Pages | Page types |
|---|---|---|
| Front | Cover, contents, executive summary | 01, 02, 04 |
| Each chapter | Opener, then three to five pages | 03, then 04 and 05 |
| Back | Methodology, back cover | 04, 06 |

### 8.7.2 Production

| Item | Specification |
|---|---|
| Text stock | Uncoated, 120 gsm, FSC certified |
| Cover stock | Uncoated, 350 gsm, FSC certified |
| Cover finish | Spot UV for the pattern, tone on tone |
| Print PDF | PDF/X-4 with 3 mm bleed; fonts embedded; images at 300 dpi; CMYK |
| Screen PDF | sRGB; tagged, with reading order, H1–H3 and bookmarks; alt text on every image and chart |
| Report cover template | KSA-PR-01, A4, reversed logo with blades, digital print, owner Brand lead, on demand, PR-01_ReportCover_v1.0.indd |
| Proposal cover template | KSA-PR-02, A4, full-colour logo with blades, digital print, owner Brand lead, on demand, PR-02_ProposalCover_v1.0.indd |

### 8.7.3 Common faults and fixes

| Fault | Fix |
|---|---|
| Body set at 9 pt or below to fit | Cut the text or add a page |
| Justified text | Set ragged right |

| | |
|---|---|
| A second pattern inside the report | Remove it; the cover's pattern is the only one |
| Pull quote that says something the text does not | Replace with a line from the text |
| Sidebar on white or wider than four columns | Set in Sea Mist at four columns |
| Exhibit without a unit or source | Add both, or cut the exhibit |
| Two ideas on one spread | Split across two spreads |

## 8.8 Before a deck or report leaves the studio

Run the 24-point checklist in Chapter 10 on every deck and report. These six checks catch most faults in this chapter's formats.

1. Read the titles alone. Does the story hold?
2. Count the saffron. Is there one highlight per slide or page?
3. Count the patterns. Two per deck at most, one per report.
4. Check the floor sizes: titles 40 px, slide body 20 px, report body 9 pt, notes 7 pt.
5. Check every exhibit for number, headline, unit and source.
6. Check that every content slide and page closes with the identifier and the page number.

CHAPTER 09

# Brand assets: stationery, gifting, inventory register and interiors

This chapter covers the things people hold, carry and walk into: stationery, gifts and the spaces where clients meet us. Each is made to the same standard as our advice. The stationery suite is one family on paper, specified to the millimetre. The merchandise range is small and made to be kept. Every branded item is listed on one controlled register, KSA-BR-REG; if an item is not on the register, it is not ordered. The reception, the meeting rooms and the signs use honest materials, one strong idea per room and the same Deep Current, Sea Mist and single saffron cue as every page and screen. Build artwork to the numbers in this chapter, never by eye.

## 9.1 Stationery suite

One family on paper. Deep Current is for brand moments, white is for words, and the two-colour foot bar runs on every sheet.

### 9.1.1 The suite

| No. | Item | Size, mm | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | Presentation folder | 220 × 310 (holds A4) | Pocket and card slits; Confluence pattern inside |
| 02 | Letterhead | A4, 210 × 297 | First page of every letter |
| 03 | Continuation sheet | A4, 210 × 297 | Page 2 onward |
| 04 | Tab dividers | A4 plus tab, five tabs | Laminated tabs |
| 05 | C4 envelope | 324 × 229 | Return line: "If undelivered, return to Kayak Strategic Advisors · [Office address, City, PIN]" |
| 06 | DL envelope | 220 × 110 | Closed with the 07 foil seal on the flap |
| 07 | Envelope seal | 28 octagon | Saffron hot foil on Deep Current |
| 08 | Compliment slip | DL, 210 × 99 | "With compliments" |
| 09 | Business card | 85 × 55 | Saffron painted edge |
| 10 | Notepad | A5, 50 sheets | Head-glued |
| 11 | ID card | CR80 | Printed lanyard |

### 9.1.2 Shared rules

- The foot bar is the suite's signature. It runs full bleed along the foot of every sheet and card, split 50 : 50 between Open Water #17807E on the left and Beacon Saffron #EE9B1E on the right. This is the one saffron element on the sheet.
- Deep Current #0E2F3C grounds are for brand moments: the folder, the card front, the seal. Letters, notes and forms sit on white.
- Text is Archivo for structure (names, addresses, labels) and Source Serif 4 for the voice (letter text).
- The logo keeps 2X clear space on every item. X is the width of the K upright.
- Placeholders in square brackets are replaced with real details before artwork goes to print: [Office address line 1], [City, State, PIN], [+91 00000 00000], [Registered office address], [Registration / CIN number].

### 9.1.3 Letter layout

| Part | Content |
|---|---|
| Date | [Date] |
| Recipient | [Recipient name], [Designation], [Organisation], [Address] |
| Subject | "Subject: [Subject of the letter]" |

| | |
|---|---|
| Salutation | "Dear [Name]," |
| Letter text | Source Serif 4, 10.5 pt on 16 pt leading, left aligned, in Deep Current or near-black. Short paragraphs, one line between them |
| Close | "Yours sincerely," |
| Signature | [Full Name]; [Designation], Kayak Strategic Advisors |
| Footer | "Kayak Strategic Advisors · [Registered office address] · [Registration / CIN number]" |

The continuation sheet carries "[Recipient name] · [Date]" and "Page 2 of 2" at the head, the identifier, and a short footer: "Kayak Strategic Advisors · www.kayaksa.com".

# 9.2 Stationery specifications

Millimetres are measured from the trimmed edge. Type is in points.

## 9.2.1 A4 letterhead, 210 × 297 mm

Key positions, in mm from the top-left trim:

| Guide | Position, mm |
|---|---|
| Left text margin | 19 from the left trim |
| Logo | 19 to 69 from the left trim (50 mm wide) |
| Top of logo and address block | 15 from the top trim |
| Header rule | 42 from the top trim |
| Date line, start of letter | 55 from the top trim |
| Footer line | 278 from the top trim |
| Trim | 297 |

| No. | Element | Colour | Specification |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Logo | Full colour | 50 mm wide; 2X clear space |
| 2 | Address block | Storm Slate #3E5563 | Archivo Regular 9/14.4 pt, ranged right to the right margin |
| 3 | Header rule | Deep Current | 1.5 pt (0.5 mm), margin to margin |
| 4 | Letter text | #1D2F38 | Source Serif 4 Regular 10.5/16 pt |
| 5 | Subject line | Deep Current | Archivo Bold 10.5 pt |
| 6 | Signature | Deep Current | Archivo Bold 10.5 pt; role 9 pt in Open Water |
| 7 | Footer | Storm Slate | Archivo 9 pt on a 0.25 mm Fog rule; identifier 6 mm high |
| 8 | Foot bar | Open Water / Beacon Saffron | 1.6 mm deep, full bleed, split 50 : 50 |

Clear space is 2X on every side of the logo, where X is the width of the K upright. The address block contains [Office address line 1], [City, State, PIN], [+91 00000 00000] and www.kayaksa.com.

## 9.2.2 Business card, 85 × 55 mm

Card front:

| No. | Element | Colour | Specification |
|---|---|---|---|
| 9 | Ground | Deep Current | Full flood |
| 9 | Logo, front | White (reversed) | 48 mm wide, centred: 18.5 to 66.5 mm from the left edge, 19.8 to 35.2 mm from the top edge; 2X clear space |

Card back (6 mm margins: content between 6 and 79 mm across, and from 6 to 49 mm down):

| No. | Element | Colour | Specification |
|---|---|---|---|
| 10 | Name | Deep Current | Archivo Bold 11 pt, width 110% |
| 11 | Designation | Open Water | Archivo Medium 7 pt |
| 12 | Contact block | #2A3F4B | Archivo 7/9.5 pt; the T, E and W labels in Bold |
| 13 | Identifier | Full colour | 6 mm high, the print minimum |
| 14 | Foot bar | Open Water / Beacon Saffron | 1 mm deep, full bleed, split 50 : 50 |

Contact block format:

T [+91 00000 00000] E [name]@kayaksa.com W www.kayaksa.com [Office address, City, PIN]

The card edge is painted Beacon Saffron. The edge and the foot bar together are the card's one saffron idea.

### 9.2.3 Production, first run

| Item | Size, mm | Stock | Print | Finish | Quantity |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Business card | 85 × 55 | Cotton board 700 gsm duplex | Offset, 3 spot | Spot UV, saffron painted edge | 100 a head |
| Letterhead | A4 | Uncoated wove 120 gsm | Offset, 3 spot | None | 2,500 |
| Continuation | A4 | Uncoated wove 120 gsm | Offset, 3 spot | None | 1,000 |
| Compliment slip | 210 × 99 | Uncoated wove 120 gsm | Offset, 3 spot | None | 500 |
| DL envelope | 220 × 110 | Wove 120 gsm, peel and seal | Offset, 3 spot | None | 1,000 |
| C4 envelope | 324 × 229 | Wove 120 gsm, peel and seal | Offset, 3 spot | None | 500 |
| Envelope seal | 28 octagon | Deep Current label, kiss-cut | Offset, Deep Current flood | Saffron hot foil | 1,000 roll |
| Presentation folder | 220 × 310 | Uncoated board 400 gsm | Offset, 3 spot | Die-cut pocket, slits | 250 |
| Notepad | A5, 50 sheets | Uncoated 100 gsm, grey back | Offset, 3 spot | Head-glued, Deep Current tape | 200 |
| ID card | CR80 | PVC 760 micron | Digital CMYK | Slot punch, lanyard | Per hire |
| Tab dividers | A4 plus 11 mm tab | Board 300 gsm | Digital CMYK | Laminated tabs | Per file |

### 9.2.4 Spot colours

| Spot | CMYK |
|---|---|
| Deep Current | 77 22 0 76 |
| Open Water | 82 0 2 50 |
| Beacon Saffron | 0 35 87 7 |

Rules:

- Pantone-equivalent spots are matched on drawdown.
- Approve a wet proof on the stock before every run.
- Saffron foil appears only on seals.

### 9.2.5 Digital templates and files

| Template | Rule |
|---|---|
| Word letterhead, KSA_Letterhead_A4_v1.0.dotx | Locked header and footer. Page 2 turns into the continuation layout automatically |
| Printing from Word | Print on plain paper, never over pre-printed sheets |
| Artwork file names | KSA_[Item]_[Size]_[Variant]_v1.0 |
| Print PDFs | PDF/X-4 with 3 mm bleed |

## 9.3 Merchandise and gifting

A small range, made to be kept. The mark stays quiet and the material does the talking. A gift should feel chosen, with the brand in the background.

### 9.3.1 The fourteen items

| No. | Item | Method | Mark |
|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | A5 notebook | Blind deboss, saffron ribbon | Monogram |
| 02 | Metal pen | Laser-engraved barrel | Wordmark |
| 03 | Ceramic mug | Fired transfer, matt glaze | Identifier |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| 04 | Insulated bottle | Laser-engraved, powder coat | Identifier |
| 05 | Tote bag | 1-colour screen print, canvas | Monogram |
| 06 | Umbrella | Screen print on one panel | Wordmark |
| 07 | Laptop sleeve | Debossed leather tab, felt | Identifier |
| 08 | Desk calendar | Offset, 3 spot, wire-bound | Full logo |
| 09 | Executive gift box | Rigid box, Delta lining | Full logo |
| 10 | Lapel pin | Hard enamel, gold plate | Identifier |
| 11 | Polo shirt | Embroidered, left chest | Identifier |
| 12 | Wireless charger | Tonal deboss, fabric top | Identifier |
| 13 | Tea tin | Printed wrap label ("Darjeeling · First flush") | Monogram |
| 14 | Diwali card | Saffron foil, 400 gsm | Identifier |

The Diwali card reads "Shubh Deepavali" with "From all of us at Kayak" and the firm's name. The desk calendar opens on January 2027 for the first run.

### 9.3.2 Principles

| Principle | Rules |
|---|---|
| A. Understated | Monogram or identifier on most pieces. The full logo only on packaging and printed matter. Tone on tone first: deboss, engrave, embroider. One mark per piece, placed where a maker would sign |
| B. Quality over quantity | Fewer, better things that last three years of daily use. No novelties, no single-use plastic. Approve a pre-production sample of every piece before the order is placed |
| C. Approved colourways | Deep Current, full colour. Deep Current, tonal. Natural, Deep Current. White, full colour. Saffron as an accent only: ribbon, foil, edge |
| D. Method by material | See the table below |

### 9.3.3 Method by material

| Material | Method |
|---|---|
| Paper, leather | Blind deboss or foil |
| Metal | Laser engraving |
| Textile | Embroidery, 6 threads |
| Ceramic, glass | Fired transfer |

### 9.3.4 Gifting rules

- The Managing Partner signs off every gifting programme and every new item family (see 9.4.5).
- Order only items that are on the register, from the approved sample.
- Packaging carries the full logo; the piece inside carries one quiet mark.
- Saffron appears once per piece: the notebook ribbon, the card foil, the gift-box detail.

## 9.4 Brand inventory register (KSA-BR-REG)

One controlled list of everything that carries the brand. If it is not on the register, it is not ordered.

### 9.4.1 Register details

| Field | Value |
|---|---|
| Document | KSA-BR-REG |
| Version | 1.0 |
| Effective | 16 Oct 2026 |
| Next review | Apr 2027 |
| Registered brand items | 38 |
| Full register | KSA-BR-REG_Inventory_v1.0.xlsx in the brand library |

## 9.4.2 Items by category

| Category | Code prefix | Items |
|---|---|---|
| Stationery | KSA-ST | 10 |
| Print | KSA-PR | 4 |
| Merchandise | KSA-MD | 14 |
| Signage | KSA-SG | 4 |
| Digital | KSA-DG | 6 |
| Total | | 38 |

Register colours are recorded against four references: Deep Current, Open Water, Beacon Saffron and Natural.

## 9.4.3 Register extract, KSA-ST-01 to KSA-DG-03

The published extract shows 21 of the 38 registered items.

| Code | Item | Category | Spec / size | Logo version | Decoration / finish | Owner | Reorder | File reference |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| KSA-ST-01 | Business card | Stationery | 85 × 55 mm | Reversed + identifier | Spot UV, saffron edge | Brand lead | 25 a person | ST-01_BusinessCard_v1.0.pdf |
| KSA-ST-02 | Letterhead | Stationery | A4 | Full colour | Offset, 3 spot | Office admin | 500 sheets | ST-02_Letterhead_v1.0.pdf |
| KSA-ST-03 | Continuation sheet | Stationery | A4 | Identifier | Offset, 3 spot | Office admin | 500 sheets | ST-03_Continuation_v1.0.pdf |
| KSA-ST-04 | Compliment slip | Stationery | 210 × 99 mm | Full colour | Offset, 3 spot | Office admin | 100 | ST-04_ComplimentSlip_v1.0.pdf |
| KSA-ST-05 | DL envelope | Stationery | 220 × 110 mm | Full colour | Peel and seal | Office admin | 250 | ST-05_EnvDL_v1.0.pdf |
| KSA-ST-06 | C4 envelope | Stationery | 324 × 229 mm | Full colour | Peel and seal | Office admin | 100 | ST-06_EnvC4_v1.0.pdf |
| KSA-ST-07 | Envelope seal | Stationery | 28 mm octagon | Identifier | Saffron hot foil | Brand lead | 1 roll | ST-07_Seal_v1.0.pdf |
| KSA-ST-08 | Presentation folder | Stationery | 220 × 310 mm | Reversed | Die-cut pocket | Brand lead | 50 | ST-08_Folder_v1.0.pdf |
| KSA-ST-09 | Notepad | Stationery | A5 · 50 sheets | Identifier | Head-glued | Office admin | 40 pads | ST-09_Notepad_A5_v1.0.pdf |
| KSA-ST-10 | Employee ID card | Stationery | CR80 portrait | Wordmark, reversed | Dye-sub, lanyard | HR lead | 10 blanks | ST-10_IDCard_v1.0.pdf |
| KSA-PR-01 | Report cover | Print | A4 | Reversed + blades | Digital print | Brand lead | On demand | PR-01_ReportCover_v1.0.indd |
| KSA-PR-02 | Proposal cover | Print | A4 | Full colour + blades | Digital print | Brand lead | On demand | PR-02_ProposalCover_v1.0.indd |
| KSA-PR-03 | Tab dividers | Print | A4 · 5 tabs | Full colour | Laminated tabs | Office admin | 20 sets | PR-03_TabDividers_v1.0.pdf |
| KSA-MD-01 | A5 notebook | Merchandise | Hardbound, 192 pp | Monogram | Blind deboss, ribbon | Brand lead | 30 | MD-01_Notebook_A5_v1.0.ai |
| KSA-MD-05 | Tote bag | Merchandise | 380 × 420 mm | Monogram | Screen print, 1 colour | Brand lead | 40 | MD-05_Tote_v1.0.ai |
| KSA-MD-09 | Executive gift box | Merchandise | 300 × 220 × 80 mm | Full logo | Rigid box, Delta lining | Brand lead | 20 | MD-09_GiftBox_v1.0.ai |
| KSA-MD-10 | Lapel pin | Merchandise | 20 mm high | Identifier | Hard enamel, gold plate | Brand lead | 50 | MD-10_LapelPin_v1.0.ai |

| | | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| KSA-SG-01 | Reception logo wall | Signage | 1,800 mm wide | Full colour | Built-up letters | Office admin | n/a | SG-01_ReceptionWall_v1.0.pdf |
| KSA-DG-01 | Email signature | Digital | 600 px wide | Wordmark | HTML, hosted image | IT lead | n/a | DG-01_EmailSignature_v1.0.html |
| KSA-DG-02 | Word letterhead | Digital | A4 .dotx | Full colour | Locked template | Brand lead | n/a | DG-02_Letterhead_v1.0.dotx |
| KSA-DG-03 | Presentation template | Digital | 16:9 .potx | Full colour | Master layouts | Brand lead | n/a | DG-03_Deck_v1.0.potx |

### 9.4.4 Merchandise codes not shown in the extract

The merchandise codes follow the numbering of the merchandise range in 9.3.1. The four codes shown in the extract (MD-01, MD-05, MD-09, MD-10) match that numbering. The remaining ten take their mark and decoration from 9.3.1. Size and reorder level are set when the pre-production sample is approved and recorded in the full register.

| Code | Item | Logo version | Decoration / finish | Owner | File reference |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| KSA-MD-02 | Metal pen | Wordmark | Laser-engraved barrel | Brand lead | MD-02_Pen_v1.0.ai |
| KSA-MD-03 | Ceramic mug | Identifier | Fired transfer, matt glaze | Brand lead | MD-03_Mug_v1.0.ai |
| KSA-MD-04 | Insulated bottle | Identifier | Laser-engraved, powder coat | Brand lead | MD-04_Bottle_v1.0.ai |
| KSA-MD-06 | Umbrella | Wordmark | Screen print on one panel | Brand lead | MD-06_Umbrella_v1.0.ai |
| KSA-MD-07 | Laptop sleeve | Identifier | Debossed leather tab, felt | Brand lead | MD-07_LaptopSleeve_v1.0.ai |
| KSA-MD-08 | Desk calendar | Full logo | Offset, 3 spot, wire-bound | Brand lead | MD-08_DeskCalendar_v1.0.ai |
| KSA-MD-11 | Polo shirt | Identifier | Embroidered, left chest | Brand lead | MD-11_Polo_v1.0.ai |
| KSA-MD-12 | Wireless charger | Identifier | Tonal deboss, fabric top | Brand lead | MD-12_Charger_v1.0.ai |
| KSA-MD-13 | Tea tin | Monogram | Printed wrap label | Brand lead | MD-13_TeaTin_v1.0.ai |
| KSA-MD-14 | Diwali card | Identifier | Saffron foil, 400 gsm | Brand lead | MD-14_DiwaliCard_v1.0.ai |

The remaining registered items (KSA-PR-04, KSA-SG-02 to KSA-SG-04 and KSA-DG-04 to KSA-DG-06) are held in KSA-BR-REG_Inventory_v1.0.xlsx. Signage items are drawn from the sign family in 9.7; digital items from the templates in Chapter 10.

### 9.4.5 Who approves

| Role | Responsibility |
|---|---|
| Brand lead | Owns the register. Approves items, proofs and samples |
| Managing Partner | Signs off new item families and gifting |
| Office admin | Holds stock. Reorders at the set level |
| HR lead | Item owner for the employee ID card (KSA-ST-10) |
| IT lead | Item owner for the email signature (KSA-DG-01) |

### 9.4.6 Requesting a new item

| Step | Action |
|---|---|
| 01 | Send the brand request form: item, purpose, quantity, date needed |
| 02 | The Brand lead checks it against these guidelines and issues a code |

| | |
|---|---|
| 03 | The supplier proof and pre-production sample are approved in writing |
| 04 | The item, artwork and file reference are added to the register before ordering |

Nothing is ordered before step 04 is complete.

### 9.4.7 Version and review

| Rule | Detail |
|---|---|
| Review cycle | Each April and October, and whenever these guidelines change |
| Minor version | A changed item raises the minor version, for example 1.0 to 1.1 |
| Major version | A new item family raises the major version, for example 1.x to 2.0 |
| Retired items | Stay on the register marked Withdrawn. Nothing is deleted |
| File references | Carry the item's version, for example ST-01_BusinessCard_v1.0.pdf |

## 9.5 Reception

The first room a client sees. One lit logo on Deep Current, honest materials and a clear desk: calm, warm and unmistakably ours.

### 9.5.1 Materials palette

| Material | Specification | Use |
|---|---|---|
| Oak slats | Natural oak, matt lacquer. 40 mm slats, 20 mm gaps | Slat walls, screens |
| Honed stone | Dholpur beige or Jaisalmer, honed | Desk and floor |
| Deep Current | Matt emulsion matched to #0E2F3C | Feature wall |
| Brass and saffron | Brushed brass light; 6 mm Beacon Saffron inlay | Lighting; inlay in the stone desk |
| Undertow wool | Wool bouclé or felt, #1F4B5F | Seating |
| Sea Mist walls | Matt emulsion matched to #EEF4F1 | All other walls |

The reception visual reference shows a Deep Current feature wall, a halo-lit built-up logo and a stone desk with a saffron inlay. It is for direction only. The fit-out architect details the room.

### 9.5.2 Logo wall

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Wall | Deep Current feature wall |
| Logo | Built-up letters, halo-lit, centred on the wall. Register item KSA-SG-01, 1,800 mm wide, full colour |
| Logo centre line | CL 2150 mm above finished floor |
| Lighting | LED halo, 3000K |
| Clear space | 2X on every side |
| Desk | 1,050 mm high, honed stone with the 6 mm saffron inlay |

### 9.5.3 Reception rules

1. One logo per wall, and one per sightline.
2. Keep 2X clear space around the logo: no art, screens or signage inside it.
3. Halo-light the logo at 3000K. No coloured, flashing or animated light.
4. No pattern behind the logo. Patterns go on screens, glass or a second wall.

### 9.5.4 Visitor badge

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Format | CR80 card, 54 × 86 mm, portrait |
| Lanyard | Deep Current |
| Content | "VISITOR"; [Full Name]; [Organisation]; "HOST" [Full Name]; "DATE" 16 Oct 2026 |
| Foot line | "Please return at reception" |

### 9.5.5 Welcome screen

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Canvas | 1920 × 1080 px |
| Margins | 96 px on every side |
| Content | Date in caps ("THURSDAY 16 OCTOBER 2026"), "Welcome", [Client name] |
| Pattern | In a 62° blade panel, never behind type |

Show one client name at a time.

## 9.6 Office interiors

Quiet rooms, one strong idea each. Pattern lives on walls and glass, colour comes from materials, and every room is named for a river.

### 9.6.1 Interior rules

1. Patterns go on walls or glass, never on furniture or upholstery.
2. One feature wall per room. The rest stay Sea Mist.
3. Acoustic panels in tonal Deep Current only.
4. Manifest all glass: a Wake band from 900 to 1500 mm, and a saffron dot at 1600 mm.

### 9.6.2 Colour proportion

Measured by visible surface area across the floor plate.

| Material or colour | Share | Where |
|---|---|---|
| Sea Mist and white | 50% | Walls, ceilings |
| Oak and stone | 25% | Floors, joinery |
| Deep Current | 15% | Feature walls, felt |
| Undertow | 8% | Upholstery |
| Beacon Saffron | 2% | Dots, inlays |

### 9.6.3 River meeting rooms

Every meeting room is named for an Indian river. The boardroom is Sangam, where the Ganga and the Yamuna meet: rivers in a confluence, like the Confluence Y.

| Room | Type | Seats |
|---|---|---|
| Ganga | Meeting room | 12 |
| Yamuna | Meeting room | 8 |
| Godavari | Meeting room | 8 |
| Narmada | Meeting room | 6 |
| Kaveri | Meeting room | 4 |
| Brahmaputra | Meeting room | 10 |
| Sangam | Boardroom | Long table |

Door plates carry the river name and "MEETING ROOM · [n] SEATS". The base strip shows status: Kelp Green when the room is free, Red Clay when it is in use.

### 9.6.4 Room types

| Space | Treatment |
|---|---|
| Studio and Godavari meeting room | Chart contours feature wall, felt pier in tonal Deep Current, Wake-line glass manifestation |
| Library | Quiet zone: oak shelving wall, felt panels, warm task light |
| Boardroom, Sangam | Long table, slatted oak screen wall, a Kayak slide on screen |

### 9.6.5 Glass manifestation

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Wake band | Frosted vinyl, from 900 mm to 1500 mm above finished floor |
| Saffron dot | Centred at 1600 mm above finished floor |
| Door | 1,000 mm leaf |
| Door plate | Centre line 1500 mm, latch side: "Godavari / MEETING ROOM · 8 SEATS" |
| Felt pier | Tonal Deep Current, beside the glass |

The saffron dot is the room's one saffron cue on its glass. Never put type on glass alone; room names sit on the door plate.

## 9.7 Signage and wayfinding

Few signs, placed where people decide. Deep Current panels, white type, one saffron cue, and sizes set by reading distance.

### 9.7.1 The sign family

| No. | Sign | Size, mm | Construction and content |
|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | Lobby directory | 600 wide | Aluminium; KSA strip in white. "[BUILDING NAME]", levels L00 to L08, "KAYAK STRATEGIC ADVISORS" against its level |
| 02 | Entrance door | Glass door | Vinyl logo 600 mm wide, Wake band at the glass-manifestation heights in 9.6.5. "KAYAK STRATEGIC ADVISORS", "Level [00]", "[Suite 000]", "Reception" inside the read zone |
| 03 | Floor directory | 600 × 900 | Matt acrylic 6 mm, text in white vinyl, cap 18 mm. Arrows from the icon set. Lists Reception, Ganga · Yamuna, Godavari · Narmada, Kaveri · Brahmaputra, Sangam boardroom, Library, Washrooms, Fire exit |
| 04 | Directional | 450 × 180 | Projecting, double-sided. Aluminium, powder-coated. Cap 40 mm, read at 5 m. Underside 2100 mm minimum above floor |
| 05 | Door plates | 300 × 150 | Latch side, CL 1500 mm. Name cap 24 mm, raised 1 mm, with Braille. Status strip |
| 06 | Pictograms | 380 × 380 | 24 grid, 2 px stroke. Men, Women, Accessible, Exit route, Lift, Stairs, Visitors |
| 07 | Lift lobby and parking | 900 wide | Lift lobby, CL 1800 mm. Cap 80 mm, read at 10 m. "Lifts · Levels [00] to [00]", "Parking [Level B0]" |

In situ, from lift lobby to entrance, a visitor passes the floor directory, the lift sign, the blade sign and the door plate. Only one logo sits on that sightline.

### 9.7.2 Sign rules

| Sign | Rule |
|---|---|
| Directional | The arrow leads the line. One destination per line |
| Door plates | Status strip: Kelp Green free, Red Clay in use |
| Pictograms | Statutory fire signs follow IS 12349 and ISO 7010. Do not restyle them |
| Lift lobby and parking | Level numbers stay in brackets until the address is fixed |
| All signs | One saffron cue per sign at most; white type on Deep Current |

### 9.7.3 Letter height by viewing distance

Cap height = viewing distance ÷ 125, with a minimum of 15 mm.

| Viewing distance | Cap height | Typical signs |
|---|---|---|
| 2 m | 15 mm | Door plates, tactile signs |
| 5 m | 40 mm | Directional, floor directory |
| 10 m | 80 mm | Lift lobby, lobby directory |
| 20 m | 160 mm | Exterior, car park |

For any other distance, divide the distance in millimetres by 125 and round up to the next whole millimetre. A sign read at 3 m needs a 24 mm cap.

### 9.7.4 Materials

| Material | Specification | Use |
|---|---|---|
| Brushed aluminium | 3 mm, satin | Directories, brackets |
| Matt acrylic | 6 mm, Deep Current | Door plates, tactile signs |
| Cut vinyl | White, frosted or Deep Current | Text on panels, glass manifestation, door logos |

### 9.7.5 Accessibility and Braille

| Rule | Specification |
|---|---|
| Contrast | Light reflectance value (LRV) difference of 70 points or more between sign and background; type at least 4.5:1 against its panel |
| Mounting height | Reading signs mounted with their text between 1200 and 1600 mm above floor |
| Tactile type | Raised 1 mm sans-serif capitals |
| Braille | Grade 1 Braille below the tactile type |
| Position | On the latch side of the door |
| Finish | Matt, non-glare finishes |
| Glass | Never type on glass alone |

### 9.7.6 Signage checklist

1. Is each sign placed where a person makes a decision?
2. Is the cap height right for the reading distance?
3. Is there one logo on the sightline?
4. Do tactile signs carry raised 1 mm capitals with Grade 1 Braille below, on the latch side?
5. Are fire signs statutory (IS 12349, ISO 7010) and unaltered?
6. Is each item on the register before it is ordered?

CHAPTER 10

# Digital media, Confluence magazine and the 24-point quality checklist

Most people meet Kayak first in a feed, an inbox, a video call or the monthly magazine. This chapter sizes the same calm voice and the one beacon for every screen. It sets the social media system across LinkedIn, Instagram, Facebook, X and YouTube, with six post archetypes on one grid. It sets the 600 px email system, the email signature, the virtual meeting room and the rules for a good meeting invite. It sets out Confluence, our monthly magazine, from its name to its 24-page issue. It closes with the 24 checks every piece must pass before it leaves the studio, and the asset kit every piece starts from.

## 10.1 Social media system

Six archetypes on one grid, one pattern each. Readers should know a Kayak post before they see the name.

### 10.1.1 Sizes by platform

Pixels, aspect ratio and safe area for each placement.

| Platform | Profile | Cover / header | Feed post | Vertical |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| LinkedIn | 400 × 400 · 1:1 · mark in 60% | 1128 × 191 · 5.9:1 · clear left 300 | 1200 × 1200 · 1:1 or 4:5 · margin 80 | 1080 × 1350 · 4:5 PDF · margin 80 |
| Instagram | 320 × 320 · 1:1 · mark in 60% | 1080 × 1920 highlight · icon in 40% | 1080 × 1350 · 4:5 · type in centre square | 1080 × 1920 · 9:16 · 250 top, 340 foot |
| Facebook | 720 × 720 · 1:1 · mark in 60% | 1640 × 624 · 2.63:1 · mobile 1110 wide | 1080 × 1350 · 4:5 · margin 80 | 1080 × 1920 · 9:16 · 250 top, 340 foot |
| X | 400 × 400 · 1:1 · mark in 60% | 1500 × 500 · 3:1 · centre 360 high | 1600 × 900 · 16:9 · margin 80 | 1080 × 1920 · 9:16 · 250 top, 340 foot |
| YouTube | 800 × 800 · 1:1 · mark in 60% | 2560 × 1440 · 16:9 · centre 1546 × 423 | 1280 × 720 · 16:9 · clear bottom right | 1080 × 1920 · 9:16 Shorts · clear right 120 |

How to read the safe areas:

| Safe-area note | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Mark in 60% | The identifier sits inside a circle 60% of the canvas diameter, so it survives a circle crop |
| Clear left 300 | Keep the left 300 px of the LinkedIn banner clear; the page logo overlaps it |
| Icon in 40% | Instagram highlight icons sit inside the centre 40% |
| Type in centre square | On a 4:5 Instagram post, type stays inside the centre 1080 × 1080 square so it survives the 1:1 grid crop |
| Margin 80 | 80 px margin on every side of the feed canvas |
| 250 top, 340 foot | On 9:16 stories and reels, keep 250 px at the top and 340 px at the foot clear of type |
| Mobile 1110 wide | Facebook mobile crops the cover to the centre 1110 px |
| Centre 360 high | On the X header, keep type inside the centre 360 px band |
| Centre 1546 × 423 | On the YouTube channel art, keep type and logo inside the centre 1546 × 423 px, which shows on every device |
| Clear bottom right | On YouTube thumbnails, keep the bottom-right corner clear for the duration stamp |
| Clear right 120 | On Shorts, keep the right 120 px clear of type for the platform controls |

### 10.1.2 Profile image

- Use the identifier only, on Deep Current #0E2F3C, inside the 60% circle.
- Never use the full logo as a profile image. It fails below 48 px.

- Most platforms crop to a circle. The LinkedIn page crops to a square. The same file works for both.
- Use the same profile image and the handle @kayaksa on every platform.

### 10.1.3 The post grid

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Canvas | 1080 px wide (1080 × 1080, 1080 × 1350 or 1080 × 1920) |
| Margin | 80 px |
| Columns | 6 |
| Gutter | 32 px |
| Spacing | 8 px steps |
| Footer | kayaksa.com, bottom left, inside the margin |
| Beacon | One Beacon Saffron accent per post |
| Pattern | One pattern per post at most |

### 10.1.4 The six post archetypes

| No. | Archetype | Ground | Pattern | Content |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | Insight | Deep Current | Current | Eyebrow, headline of three lines at most |
| 02 | Data | Sea Mist | Soundings | One number, one chart |
| 03 | Quote | White | Wake lines | Serif quote, named author |
| 04 | Service spotlight | White | Confluence | Cluster icon, cluster name, one line |
| 05 | Announcement | Deep Current | Paddle rhythm | Firm news |
| 06 | Event | Deep Current | Chevron wake | Date and time, register line |

### 10.1.5 Archetype 01: Insight

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Eyebrow | Content type and topic in caps: "INSIGHT · DATA PROTECTION" |
| Headline | Archivo, white, three lines at most: "DPDP readiness starts with a data map, not a policy" |
| Pattern | Current, in the Accent or Tonal strength |
| Footer | kayaksa.com |

### 10.1.6 Archetype 02: Data

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Eyebrow | "BY THE NUMBERS · DPDP ACT, 2023" |
| Big number | "₹250 crore", unit at 40–50% of the figure |
| Line | "The maximum penalty for a single failure to protect personal data." |
| Chart | One chart: "Maximum penalty by breach, ₹ crore" |
| Source | "Source: Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, Schedule" |

Worked example chart values:

| Breach | Maximum penalty, ₹ crore |
|---|---|
| Security safeguards (highlighted) | 250 |
| Breach notification | 200 |
| Children's data | 200 |
| Significant data fiduciaries | 150 |
| Any other breach | 50 |

### 10.1.7 Archetype 03: Quote

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Ground and pattern | White with Wake lines |
| Quote | Source Serif 4 Italic: "Resilience is not a cost line. It is the margin you keep when the shock arrives." |
| Author | Initials or photo ring, [Partner name], [Designation], Kayak Strategic Advisors |

### 10.1.8 Archetype 04: Service spotlight

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Eyebrow | "CLUSTER 03 OF 6" |
| Icon and name | Cluster icon and cluster name: "Crisis & Resilience" |
| Line | One line: "Risk, fraud and forensic investigations, brand protection and crisis response." |
| Call to action | "Explore the cluster" |
| Pattern | Confluence |

The six clusters are numbered in order: 01 Strategy & Deals, 02 Tax & Regulatory, 03 Crisis & Resilience, 04 Technology & AI, 05 Managed Services, 06 International Desk. A second worked example: "CLUSTER 05 OF 6 · Managed Services · Compliance, finance and payroll, run for you every month to a standard you can audit."

### 10.1.9 Archetype 05: Announcement

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Eyebrow | "NOW OPEN · [CITY]" |
| Headline | "Kayak Strategic Advisors is now open" |
| Line | "Strategy, deals, regulation and resilience for India's boards and investors." |
| Pattern | Paddle rhythm |

The careers post uses the same archetype: "CAREERS · We're building our team", with roles listed one per line (Consultants, strategy and deals; Investigators and risk analysts; Technology and AI specialists) and kayaksa.com/careers.

### 10.1.10 Archetype 06: Event

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Eyebrow | "WEBINAR · 45 MINUTES" |
| Title | "DPDP readiness: a briefing for boards" |
| Date and time | "[Date] · 4.00 pm IST" |
| Speakers | "[Partner name] and [Full Name]" |
| Register line | "Register at kayaksa.com/events" |
| Pattern | Chevron wake |

### 10.1.11 Feed rotation

- Newest first.
- Alternate dark and light posts.
- Never run the same pattern twice in a row.
- Festive greetings use the system: "Wishing you a bright Diwali. May the year ahead bring clear water and steady progress."

### 10.1.12 Copy rules

| Rule | Detail |
|---|---|
| Tone | Plain, confident British English. Lead with the insight, not the firm. No hype, no emoji |
| Hashtags | Three at most, at the end: #KayakInsights, one topic, one sector |
| Alt text | Describe the image, repeat its headline, give a chart's key number |
| One CTA | One verb, one link: "Read it at kayaksa.com". No links in images |
| Handle | @kayaksa on every platform |

# 10.2 LinkedIn

Our main channel. Insight first, firm news second, every post on the system grid. Staff carry the same banner so the firm reads as one voice. Page: linkedin.com/company/kayaksa.

## 10.2.1 Formats

| No. | Format | Size, px | Use and rule |
|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | Company page | Banner 1128 × 191; logo 400 × 400 | Banner type inside the safe zone, clear of the logo overlap at left. Banner line: "Clear advice for consequential decisions" with KAYAKSA.COM |
| 02 | Document carousel | 1080 × 1350 PDF | Five slides: cover, three ideas, one call to action. One idea per slide |
| 03 | Feed post | 1080 × 1350 | Portrait wins more of the feed. Use it for insight, data and quotes |
| 04 | Square post | 1200 × 1200 | Firm news, hiring, events |
| 05 | Article cover | 1920 × 1080 | Pattern from the right, headline left |
| 06 | Employee banner | 1584 × 396 | For staff profiles. Keep type right of the photo zone |

## 10.2.2 Company page text

| Field | Content |
|---|---|
| Name | Kayak Strategic Advisors |
| Tagline | Strategy, deals, regulation and resilience for India's boards and investors |
| Line | Business consulting and services · [City] · Founded 2026 |
| Overview | Kayak Strategic Advisors is an Indian strategy and risk advisory firm. We help boards, promoters and investors make consequential decisions with clear evidence, across six clusters: Strategy, Deal & Transactions; Tax & Regulatory; Crisis & Resilience; Technology & AI; Managed Services; and our International Desk. |
| Website | kayaksa.com |
| Industry | Business consulting and services |
| Founded | 2026 |
| Pinned post | "We are open. Kayak Strategic Advisors brings strategy, deals, regulation and resilience under one roof for India's boards. Read our first note at kayaksa.com" |

## 10.2.3 Document carousel worked example

| Slide | Content |
|---|---|
| 1/5 Cover | "INSIGHT · DATA PROTECTION · DPDP readiness: five questions for boards", "Swipe" |
| 2/5 | "01 Do we know where personal data lives?" Map every system, vendor and spreadsheet that holds it. |
| 3/5 | "02 Who decides why we collect it?" Name an owner for each purpose, and write it down. |
| 4/5 | "03 Can we prove consent?" Notice, consent and withdrawal must leave a record. |
| 5/5 Call to action | "Read all five questions · kayaksa.com/insights" |

Each slide shows its position (1/5 to 5/5). Every slide ends with "Kayak Strategic Advisors · kayaksa.com".

## 10.2.4 Employee banner

- Line: "Strategy, deals and resilience for India's boards".
- Type sits right of the profile-photo zone.
- One banner for all staff. Do not edit it per person.

# 10.3 Instagram

A calm grid that alternates dark and light, stories that inform in one screen, and one link: kayaksa.com. No filters, no stock photography.

## 10.3.1 Formats

| No. | Format | Size, px | Use and rule |
|---|---|---|---|

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | Profile, @kayaksa | 320 × 320 | Checkerboard rhythm, icon highlights, link in bio |
| 02 | Story, insight | 1080 × 1920 | "IN 60 SECONDS" eyebrow, one idea |
| 03 | Story, question | 1080 × 1920 | One poll sticker |
| 04 | Story, event | 1080 × 1920 | Countdown sticker and reminder |
| 05 | Reel cover | 1080 × 1920 | Title in the centre square |
| 06 | Carousel | 1080 × 1350 | Cover, then one point per slide; up to ten slides |

### 10.3.2 Profile

| Field | Content |
|---|---|
| Name | Kayak Strategic Advisors |
| Bio | "Strategy, deals, regulation and resilience. #KayakInsights" |
| Link | kayaksa.com |
| Highlights | Insights, Services, Events, Careers, About |
| Highlight covers | A white icon with its saffron accent, on Deep Current |

### 10.3.3 Grid and stories

- The profile grid runs as a checkerboard: dark and light posts alternate.
- Type stays inside the centre square, so a post survives any grid crop.
- Stories: keep 250 px at the top and 340 px at the foot clear of type.
- Stories: one idea, one sticker, one link.
- Reel covers keep the title in the centre square.
- Captions open with the insight. Three hashtags at most.

### 10.3.4 Worked examples

| Format | Content |
|---|---|
| Story, insight | "IN 60 SECONDS · INSIGHT · BRAND PROTECTION: Festive season is counterfeit season. Three checks before your brand's busiest month." |
| Story, question | "QUESTION FOR BOARDS: Has your board seen a map of its personal data?" Poll: "Yes, this quarter" 38%, "Not yet" 62% |
| Story, event | "LIVE WEBINAR · [DATE]: DPDP readiness: a briefing for boards. 4.00 pm IST · 45 minutes · free." Countdown: "Webinar starts in [02] days [14] hours [30] mins", "Remind me" |
| Reel cover | "SEBI's related-party rules, explained" |
| Carousel | "INSIGHT · BRAND PROTECTION: Three checks before the festive rush." 01 Watch the marketplaces: search your top sellers daily, by name and by image. 02 Check lookalike domains: new domains using your name appear weeks before a sale. |

## 10.4 Facebook

For events, community and paid reach. The page carries the same cover idea as LinkedIn, and every ad runs as one creative in three shapes. Page: facebook.com/kayaksa.

### 10.4.1 Formats

| No. | Format | Size, px | Use and rule |
|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | Page | Cover 1640 × 624; profile 720 × 720 | Mobile crops to the centre 1110 px. Keep the profile zone clear |
| 02 | Feed post | 1080 × 1080 | Data card. The caption leads with the number |
| 03 | Link post | 1200 × 628 | Insight preview from kayaksa.com |
| 04 | Event cover | 1920 × 1005 | Date and time in type, logo top left |
| 05 | Webinar ad set | 1:1, 4:5 and 9:16 | One creative in three shapes |

Feed posts may also run at 1080 × 1350 (4:5) with an 80 px margin, as in the sizes table.

### 10.4.2 Webinar ad set

| Shape | Placement |
|---|---|
| 1:1 | Feed, right column |
| 4:5 | Feed, mobile |
| 9:16 | Stories, Reels |

### 10.4.3 Platform rules

1. Cover type and logo sit inside the centre 1110 px. Mobile crops the sides.
2. One creative, three shapes: 1:1, 4:5 and 9:16.
3. Keep text to a fifth of the image.
4. Link posts let the preview carry the image. Never paste a URL into the picture.
5. Events: date and time in the copy as well as on the cover.
6. Reply to comments within one working day, in the firm's voice.

### 10.4.4 Worked examples

| Format | Content |
|---|---|
| Page | Category "Consulting agency · kayaksa.com". Cover line "Clear advice for consequential decisions", KAYAKSA.COM |
| Feed post | Caption: "₹250 crore. That is the maximum penalty under the DPDP Act for failing to protect personal data. #KayakInsights #DPDP" |
| Link post | Caption: "Most supply shocks start two tiers down. Our new insight sets out where to look first." Preview: "Supply-chain resilience: map tier two before the next shock" |
| Event cover | "[DATE] AT 16:00 IST · DPDP readiness: a briefing for boards · Online event · Kayak Strategic Advisors" |

## 10.5 X and YouTube

X and YouTube use the same six archetypes, the same grid logic and the same copy rules. Only the canvas changes.

### 10.5.1 X

| Placement | Size, px | Rule |
|---|---|---|
| Profile | 400 × 400 | Identifier inside the 60% circle |
| Header | 1500 × 500, 3:1 | Type inside the centre band 360 px high |
| Feed image | 1600 × 900, 16:9 | 80 px margin |
| Vertical video | 1080 × 1920, 9:16 | 250 px top and 340 px foot clear of type |

- Post text leads with the insight. One link. Three hashtags at most.
- Use the 16:9 canvas for Insight, Data and Event archetypes. Keep the headline to three lines.

### 10.5.2 YouTube

| Placement | Size, px | Rule |
|---|---|---|
| Profile | 800 × 800 | Identifier inside the 60% circle |
| Channel art | 2560 × 1440, 16:9 | Type and logo inside the centre 1546 × 423 |
| Thumbnail | 1280 × 720, 16:9 | Keep the bottom-right corner clear |
| Shorts | 1080 × 1920, 9:16 | Keep the right 120 px clear |

- Webinar recordings open and close on the title card (10.8.3). Speakers carry the lower third.
- Thumbnails use the Insight or Event archetype: eyebrow, headline of three lines at most, one saffron accent.

## 10.6 Email templates

One 600 px system: coded in tables, safe in Outlook, calm in any inbox.

### 10.6.1 Build rules

| No. | Rule | Specification |
|---|---|---|
| 01 | 600 px grid | 32 px padding, 536 px content, 16 px gutters. Below 600 px, every column stacks to 100% |
| 02 | Web-safe fonts | Archivo falls back to Arial: heads 28/34, body 16/24. Source Serif 4 falls back to Georgia: standfirst, letters |
| 03 | Bulletproof buttons | A padded table cell with bgcolor, VML for Outlook. 44 px high, Arial 15 bold. Never an image |
| 04 | Alt text and dark mode | Alt text on every image, so the email reads with images off. A reversed logo swaps in for dark mode |
| 05 | Preheader | 40–90 characters that add to the subject |
| 06 | Subject lines | Under 45 characters, sentence case, the idea first. No capitals, emoji or "!" |

A subject line such as "URGENT!! New data law update inside" breaks rule 06. Write "The DPDP Rules: what boards do first".

### 10.6.2 The four templates

| Template | Sender | Example send | Signature element |
|---|---|---|---|
| a. Newsletter, The Kayak Brief | KSA Insights, insights@kayaksa.com | Tue 09:00 | Monthly; lead insight, "Also this month", the number, events |
| b. Regulatory update | KSA Insights, insights@kayaksa.com | Fri 08:30 | One CTA |
| c. Webinar invitation | KSA Events, events@kayaksa.com | Mon 10:00 | RSVP and calendar buttons |
| d. Launch announcement | Kayak Strategic Advisors, hello@kayaksa.com | Thu 09:00 | Welcome letter |

### 10.6.3 Template a: The Kayak Brief

| Block | Content |
|---|---|
| Subject | "The Kayak Brief: read RPT rules twice" |
| Preheader | "Ten minutes on what is changing for Indian boards." |
| Masthead | "The Kayak Brief", "No. 01 · November 2026" |
| Lead insight | Eyebrow "INSIGHT · GOVERNANCE · 6 MIN READ". Headline "Related-party rules are tightening. Read them twice." Standfirst: "Transactions between group companies now need a paper trail they never did. Three questions every audit committee should ask at its next meeting." Button "Read the insight" |
| Also this month | Three cards with a content-type label, title and reading time: ARTICLE "Why family businesses should plan succession before they need to", 5 min read; PODCAST "Counterfeits at festive scale: what brand owners can do in 30 days", 28 min listen; EXPLAINER "ESG reporting for the mid-market: what to start measuring now", 7 min read. Link "All insights" |
| The number | "₹250 cr: the highest penalty per breach under India's Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023." Source: DPDP Act 2023, Schedule |
| Events | Date tile, format, title, register link: "12 NOV · Webinar · Online, 45 min · Reading the DPDP Rules: a board's checklist"; "[DD MON] · Roundtable · [City] · Succession in family business: the first conversation" |
| Footer | "You are receiving this because you subscribed to The Kayak Brief." "Unsubscribe · Manage preferences · View in browser." "Kayak Strategic Advisors · [Office address], [City], India." "kayaksa.com · insights@kayaksa.com" |

### 10.6.4 Template b: Regulatory update

| Block | Content |
|---|---|
| Subject | "The DPDP Rules: what boards do first" |
| Date and browser link | "16 October 2026", "View in browser" |
| Eyebrow | "REGULATORY UPDATE · DATA PROTECTION" |
| Headline | "The DPDP Rules are in force. What boards should do first" |
| Body | "The compliance clock has started. Most of the work is knowing your own data. Three steps for this quarter:" |
| Steps | 1. Map where personal data enters, moves through and leaves the business. 2. Name one owner for |

| | |
|---|---|
| | breach response and rehearse the first 72 hours. 3. Rewrite consent notices in plain language, in English and the languages your customers read. |
| CTA | One button: "Read the 3-minute brief" |
| Footer | "You are receiving this because you follow KSA regulatory updates." "Unsubscribe · Manage preferences." Address line |

### 10.6.5 Template c: Webinar invitation

| Block | Content |
|---|---|
| Subject | "Invitation: the DPDP Rules for boards" |
| Eyebrow | "WEBINAR · INVITATION" |
| Title | "Reading the DPDP Rules: a board's checklist" |
| Description | "Forty-five minutes on what the Rules ask of boards, where companies are starting, and the questions directors should put to management." |
| Details | DATE Thu 12 Nov 2026 · TIME 4.00–4.45 pm IST · WHERE Microsoft Teams |
| Speakers | Two speakers with initials or photo rings: [Full Name], [Designation], KSA |
| Audience | "Who should attend: board members, audit committee chairs, CFOs and general counsel." |
| Buttons | "RSVP now" (primary) and "Add to calendar" (secondary) |
| Footer | "You are receiving this because you subscribed to KSA events." "Unsubscribe · Manage preferences." Address line |

### 10.6.6 Template d: Launch announcement

| Block | Content |
|---|---|
| Subject | "Kayak Strategic Advisors is now open" |
| Hero | "Kayak Strategic Advisors is now open. A strategy and risk advisory firm for Indian boards, founders and investors." |
| Letter | Source Serif 4 (Georgia fallback): "Dear [First name], Today we open the doors of Kayak Strategic Advisors...", signed [Full Name], [Designation], Kayak Strategic Advisors |
| How we work | Independent: "We sell advice and nothing else, so it answers only to the facts." Evidence first: "Every view is built on data, documents and the people closest to it." Plain English: "Short notes, clear exhibits and a recommendation you can act on." |
| What we do | The six clusters: Strategy & Deals; Tax & Regulatory; Crisis & Resilience; Technology & AI; Managed Services; International Desk |
| Brief sign-up | "THE KAYAK BRIEF · Our thinking, once a month. Ten minutes on what is changing for Indian business, risk and regulation. The first issue arrives in November." Button "Subscribe" |
| Footer link | "Visit kayaksa.com →" |
| Footer | "You are receiving this because you asked to hear from Kayak Strategic Advisors." "Unsubscribe · Manage preferences · View in browser." Address line |

### 10.6.7 Email checks

1. Built on the 600 px table grid, with columns that stack below 600 px.
2. Live text in Arial and Georgia. Images carry alt text.
3. One primary button, coded, 44 px high.
4. Subject under 45 characters. Preheader 40–90 characters.
5. Footer gives the reason for receipt, unsubscribe, preferences and the postal address.
6. Tested in Outlook, Gmail and Apple Mail, light and dark.

## 10.7 Email signatures

The last line of every email. Same split, same calm, no decoration.

### 10.7.1 Signature versions

| Version | Size | Use | Content |
|---|---|---|---|
| Full | 600 × 190 px | New emails | Logo; [Full Name]; [Designation] · Kayak Strategic Advisors; M [+91 |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 00000 00000] · E [name]@kayaksa.com; kayaksa.com · LinkedIn; [Office address], [City] |
| Compact | One to two lines | Replies and forwards | [Full Name] · [Designation] · Kayak Strategic Advisors; M [+91 00000 00000] · kayaksa.com |
| Mobile | 320 px | Phones | Logo stacks above the name; the split bar turns horizontal. Phone and links are tappable |
| Event banner | 600 × 100 px, optional | Below the full signature | One firm event or insight, for example "WEBINAR · 12 NOVEMBER 2026 · Reading the DPDP Rules: a board's checklist · Register" |

Register reference: KSA-DG-01, email signature, 600 px wide, wordmark, HTML with hosted image, owner IT lead, DG-01_EmailSignature_v1.0.html.

### 10.7.2 Signature rules

- Live Arial text. The logo is the only image.
- Logo 150 px wide (300 px at @2x), alt text "Kayak Strategic Advisors".
- No quotes or taglines.
- The Open Water and Beacon Saffron split bar marks the signature, as the foot bar marks the stationery.

### 10.7.3 Banner rules

- One banner at a time, for a firm event or insight.
- Remove it the day after the event.
- 1200 × 200 px PNG under 100 KB, shown at 600 × 100, with alt text, linked to kayaksa.com.

## 10.8 Virtual meetings

The first frame of every call. Same split, same calm, no decoration.

### 10.8.1 Virtual backgrounds

| Property | Value |
|---|---|
| Canvas | 1920 × 1080 px, for Teams and Zoom |
| Margin | 96 px |
| Person safe area | Centre of the frame, kept clear of logo and type |

| Background | Description | Use |
|---|---|---|
| Wake lines, tonal | Sea Mist with the pattern fading in | The default for everyday calls |
| Deep Current, identifier | The identifier sits right, clear of the head | Talks and panels |
| Reception | An office that reads as a place, logo on the slat wall, top left | Client calls where a sense of place helps |

### 10.8.2 Lower third

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Position | Bottom left, 96 px in |
| Name | 54 px, bold |
| Designation | 34 px |
| Marker | The Open Water and Beacon Saffron split bar |

### 10.8.3 Title card

| Element | Specification |
|---|---|
| Use | Opens and closes every webinar |
| Eyebrow | "KSA WEBINAR" |
| Title | 104/116 px Archivo Expanded. Example: "Reading the DPDP Rules: a board's checklist" |
| Details | "Thursday 12 November 2026 · 4.00 pm IST", speaker, kayaksa.com/events |
| Beacon | One saffron rule |

### 10.8.4 Profile ring

| Variant | Use |
|---|---|
| LinkedIn | Staff photo with the ring |
| Teams | Staff photo with the ring |
| No photo | Initials in Archivo, white on Deep Current, inside the ring |

The ring is 6% of the diameter, split top and bottom like the identifier.

### 10.8.5 Meeting invite hygiene

Use the calendar template for every external meeting.

| Field | Content |
|---|---|
| Title | "[Topic] · KSA and [Organisation]". Topic first, then KSA and the other party |
| When | [Day, DD Mon], 10.00–10.50 IST |
| Where | Teams or [Office] |
| Invite | Named attendees, for example [Full Name] ×2 |
| Purpose | [The decision this meeting should reach] |
| Agenda | 1. Context · 10 min. 2. [Discussion item] · 30 min. 3. Next steps, owners · 10 min |
| Pre-read | [Document], attached |
| Join | [Teams link]; ID [000 000 000] · Code [000000]; Dial in [+91 00000 00000] |
| Sign-off | [Full Name] · [Designation], Kayak Strategic Advisors |

Rules:

1. Book 25 or 50 minutes, never back to back.
2. Every invite carries a purpose and an agenda, never "to discuss".
3. The agenda adds up to the booked time: 10 + 30 + 10 = 50 minutes.
4. Attach the pre-read to the invite.

## 10.9 Confluence: the monthly magazine

Confluence is the Kayak monthly on strategy, risk and the decisions between them.

### 10.9.1 Why the name

The identifier is the Confluence Y: two streams meet and become one stronger current. Every issue does the same for strategy and risk, India and the world, with balance, clarity and direction.

| Stream | Stream | One current |
|---|---|---|
| Client | Adviser | Confluence |
| Strategy | Risk | Confluence |
| India | The world | Confluence |

### 10.9.2 Masthead

| Version | Ground | Content |
|---|---|---|
| Reversed | Deep Current | CONFLUENCE; "The Kayak monthly on strategy, risk and the decisions between them"; "THE KAYAK MONTHLY · ISSUE 01 · [MONTH] 2026" |
| Positive | White or Sea Mist | The same lockup in Deep Current |

### 10.9.3 Formats and cadence

| Item | Rule |
|---|---|
| Interactive web edition | kayaksa.com/confluence, one link per article |
| PDF edition | A4 portrait, tagged, one file per issue |

| | |
|---|---|
| Mobile reading view | One column, 16/24 serif body |
| Publication day | First Tuesday of the month |
| Publication time | 09:00 IST |
| Announcement | By The Kayak Brief. The email leads with the cover story |

### 10.9.4 Covers

Each issue changes the cover art and the cover-story cluster. The masthead does not move.

| Issue | Cover art | Cover story | Cover line |
|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | Illustration on Sea Mist | Strategy & Deals | "Growth and risk are one decision. Boards that keep strategy and risk in separate rooms end up managing neither." |
| 02 | Chart contours | Tax & Regulatory | "Reading the regulatory tide. Data, ESG and related-party rules are all moving at once. Where a mid-market board should start." |
| 03 | Confluence pattern | International Desk | "India, from the outside in. What foreign boards misread in their first [x] months here, and what Indian boards misread abroad." |

Below the cover story, the cover lists four to six section lines, each with its section tag: for example "REGULATORY RADAR · [x] rule changes to read now", "IN CONVERSATION · [Guest name] on compliance", "BY THE NUMBERS · The mid-market deal, charted", "STORM WATCH · Counterfeits at festive scale", "SIGNAL · Who signs off on the AI?", "ACROSS THE WATER · The first move abroad", "DEAL WATER · Closing the valuation gap".

### 10.9.5 Issue architecture: 24 pages

| Pages | Section | Colour family | Content |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Cover | House (Deep Current) | Masthead, cover story, section lines |
| 2 | Contents | House | Sections and pages |
| 3 | The Heading | House | The editor's note: "Two currents, one decision" |
| 4–7 | Cover Story | Borrows the cover-story cluster's colour | Opener spread and feature: "Growth and risk are one decision" |
| 8–9 | Deal Water | Strategy & Deals | "Closing the valuation gap" |
| 10–11 | Regulatory Radar | Tax & Regulatory | "What changed this month" |
| 12–13 | Storm Watch | Crisis & Resilience | "The third party nobody checked" |
| 14–15 | Signal | Technology & AI | "Who signs off on the AI?" |
| 16–17 | Across the Water | International Desk | "India entry: the first 100 days" |
| 18–19 | By the Numbers | House | "Six years of mid-market deals" |
| 20–21 | In Conversation | Borrows the guest's cluster colour | "[Guest name] on compliance" (Managed Services in Issue 01) |
| 22–23 | Soundings | House | Five short reads |
| 24 | Last Stroke | House | One chart, one idea |

### 10.9.6 Section colours

| Cluster | Colour | Hex | Sections |
|---|---|---|---|
| Strategy & Deals | Open Water | #17807E | Deal Water |
| Tax & Regulatory | Burnished Gold | #9C630E | Regulatory Radar |
| Crisis & Resilience | Storm Slate | #3E5563 | Storm Watch |
| Technology & AI | Tidewater Blue | #2D6A9F | Signal |
| Managed Services | Kelp Green | #4B7A4E | Through In Conversation or the Cover Story |
| International Desk | Dusk Plum | #5E4B7 | Across the Water |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | 8 | |
| House sections | Deep Current | #0E2F3C | Cover, Contents, The Heading, By the Numbers, Soundings, Last Stroke |

Cover Story and In Conversation borrow their cluster's colour. Section tags are set in the cluster colour with white caps. House-section tags are Deep Current.

### 10.9.7 Section tags, Issue 01

COVER STORY · DEAL WATER · REGULATORY RADAR · STORM WATCH · SIGNAL · ACROSS THE WATER · IN CONVERSATION · THE HEADING · BY THE NUMBERS · SOUNDINGS · LAST STROKE

### 10.9.8 Magazine specification

| Item | Specification |
|---|---|
| Grid | A4 portrait; digital page 794 × 1123 px. 12 columns, 15 mm margins, 4 mm gutters, 12 pt baseline |
| Cover title | 51/54 pt Archivo Expanded |
| Opener title | 42/45 pt Archivo Expanded |
| Standfirst | 18–30 pt Source Serif 4 |
| Pull quote | 26/32 pt Source Serif 4 Italic |
| Body | 9.5/12 pt Source Serif 4 |
| Tags | 12 pt caps |
| Sources | 7/9 pt |
| Tags colour | Cluster colour, white caps; house sections Deep Current |
| Patterns | One per spread at most. A photo or chart counts as the spread's art |
| Images | Deep Current duotone on openers. Portraits in original colour, never blade-cropped |
| Access | Tagged PDF with reading order, H1–H3 and section bookmarks; alt text on every image and chart; AA contrast |
| Running head | "CONFLUENCE · ISSUE 01 · [MONTH] 2026" with the section tag |
| Folio | "kayaksa.com/confluence" and the page number |

### 10.9.9 Inside an issue: page types

| No. | Page | Specification |
|---|---|---|
| 01 | Contents | "In this issue", issue and month, each section with its page number and story title |
| 02 | Cover-story opener | Duotone image, 30 pt serif standfirst, pull quote, byline and reading time ("[Full Name] · [Designation] · 12 min read") |
| 03 | Regulatory Radar | Timeline (Week 1 to Week 4) and status tags |
| 04 | By the Numbers | Three headline figures and two exhibits |
| 05 | In Conversation | Portrait in original colour, Q&A, pull quote |
| 06 | Last Stroke | One chart, one idea, next-issue line |
| 07 | Digital edition | Section tag, reading time and share actions on every article |

### 10.9.10 Regulatory Radar entries

Each entry has a number, regulator, date, topic, one-line summary and status tag. Sample entries from Issue 01:

| No. | Regulator | Topic | Summary | Status |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | MeitY | Data protection: consent and breach notices | Rules on notices and the 72-hour breach report | In force |
| 2 | SEBI | Listed entities: related-party approvals | Thresholds and audit-committee approval | Amended |
| 3 | RBI | Digital lending: borrower disclosures | Key fact statement for every loan | Consultation |
| 4 | CBIC | GST: invoice reporting window | Time limit to report e-invoices | Deadline |
| 5 | RBI · FEMA | Overseas investment: reporting forms | Revised forms and timelines | In force |
| 6 | SEBI | BRSR Core: value-chain disclosures | Phased assurance for top listed firms | Consultation |

Each entry links to the official notification. Dates and status are checked on the day of publication.

### 10.9.11 Other worked pages

| Page | Content |
|---|---|
| Cover-story opener | Headline "Growth and risk are one decision"; standfirst "Boards that keep strategy and risk in separate rooms end up managing neither. The fix is one conversation, held earlier."; pull quote "The risk register and the strategy deck should describe the same company." |
| By the Numbers | Figures: [x]% of deals hit a red flag after close; ₹[x] cr median deal value; [x] days median time from term sheet to close. Exhibit 1: "Deal value has [risen] in [x] of the last six years", mid-market deal value, ₹ thousand crore, FY21–FY26E. Exhibit 2: "[Sector] leads the mid-market by deal count", deals by sector, FY26E: BFSI, Manufacturing, Healthcare, Consumer, Technology. "Illustrative values. Source: [Deal database], company filings; KSA analysis." |
| In Conversation | Headline "Compliance should run like a utility". Standfirst: "[Guest name] on why the best-run companies treat filings, payroll and audits as a service, not a scramble." Four questions, from "Where does compliance break first in a growing company?" to "What would you tell a founder in year one?". Pull quote "If a deadline surprises you, the system has already failed." Credit "In conversation with [Full Name], Managed Services, KSA" |
| Last Stroke | "The cost of a compliance gap grows faster than the cost of closing it." Chart: cost of remediation, indexed, FY18–FY26, illustrative. Foot: "Next issue · [Month] 2026 · kayaksa.com/confluence" |
| Digital edition | Top bar: CONFLUENCE · This issue · Sections · Archive · Issue 01 · [Month] 2026 · Subscribe. Each article carries its section tag, reading time and a Share action |

## 10.10 The 24-point quality checklist

Before it leaves the studio. Twenty-four checks. If any answer is no, the piece is not ready, however close the deadline.

### 10.10.1 The checks

| No. | Group | Check |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Brand | Logo has 2X clear space and is above minimum size |
| 2 | Brand | The identifier signs off every page, slide and screen |
| 3 | Brand | Only palette colours; tints only from the system |
| 4 | Brand | Monogram used only where KAYAK will not fit, or for seals |
| 5 | Layout | Everything sits on the grid and the 8-point scale |
| 6 | Layout | One Beacon Saffron idea per view |
| 7 | Layout | One pattern per spread, slide or screen |
| 8 | Layout | Left aligned, ragged right; 60–75 characters a line |
| 9 | Data | Title states the insight; subtitle states the unit |
| 10 | Data | Zero baseline on bars; no pies, 3D or dual axes |
| 11 | Data | Direct labels; source and notes on every exhibit |
| 12 | Data | Density limits kept: 12 bars, 6 lines, 5 segments |
| 13 | Digital | Text passes WCAG AA; graphics pass 3:1 |
| 14 | Digital | Visible focus ring; targets 44 px on web, 48 px on mobile |
| 15 | Digital | Tokens used, never raw hex in code |
| 16 | Digital | Motion respects reduced-motion settings |
| 17 | Words | Plain, confident British English |
| 18 | Words | Numbers in Indian format for Indian readers (₹ 1,234 cr) |
| 19 | Words | No jargon the client would not use themselves |
| 20 | Words | Every claim traceable to a source |
| 21 | Production | Fonts embedded or outlined; images 300 dpi for print |
| 22 | Production | Colour profile: CMYK for print, sRGB for screen |
| 23 | Production | Files named KSA_Type_Topic_Version_Date |
| 24 | Production | Final read by a second pair of eyes |

### 10.10.2 How to run the checklist

- The author runs all 24 checks first and fixes every no.

- A second person runs the checks again and does the final read (check 24). The author cannot be the second pair of eyes.
- Every check applies to every piece. Where a check does not fit the medium (motion on a printed letter), record it as not applicable. Do not skip it in silence.
- The Brand lead decides any dispute about a check.

# 10.11 The asset kit

Start from the files, never from scratch.

| Kit | Contents | Folder |
|---|---|---|
| Logo package | All logo versions, SVG, PNG, PDF | KSA_Logo_Package |
| Icon library | 48 service icons + 2,160 industry icons | KSA_Monogram_and_Icons · KSA_Industry_Icons |
| Brand patterns | 11 patterns × 6 colourways, tiles and backgrounds | KSA_Brand_Patterns |
| Design tokens | CSS, JSON and chart themes | KSA_Design_Tokens |
| Templates | Letterhead, deck, social, reports | KSA_Brand_Applications · KSA_Letterhead_Word |
| Fonts | Archivo, Source Serif 4 (SIL OFL) | 05_Fonts |

## 10.11.1 Using the kit

- Take the newest version from the brand library each time. Do not reuse a local copy from an earlier job.
- Templates in the kit match register items: the Word letterhead (KSA-DG-02, DG-02_Letterhead_v1.0.dotx) and the presentation template (KSA-DG-03, DG-03_Deck_v1.0.potx).
- Both fonts are free under the SIL Open Font License. Install them from 05_Fonts so every machine renders the same type.
- Use these guidelines with the Brand Manual (logo, colour, type), the logo package (SVG · PNG · PDF), the icon libraries (48 + 2,160 icons), the brand patterns (11 × 6 colourways), the design tokens (CSS · JSON · charts) and the corporate deck (kayaksa.com).

## 10.11.2 File naming

| What | Pattern | Example |
|---|---|---|
| Working and delivered files | KSA_Type_Topic_Version_Date | KSA_Report_TransactionsOutlook_v1.0_2026-10-16 |
| Stationery and print artwork | KSA_[Item]_[Size]_[Variant]_v1.0 | KSA_Letterhead_A4_FullColour_v1.0 |
| Registered master files | [Code]_[Item]_v[Version] | ST-01_BusinessCard_v1.0.pdf |

# 10.12 Closing line

Clarity. Direction. One course.

KSA Design & Visual Guidelines · Version 1.0 · October 2026 · For internal and agency use.